The Household Diary Study

Mail Use & Attitudes in FY 2018



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Executive Summary

This report documents the findings of the United States Postal Service's Household Diary Study (HDS) for Fiscal Year (FY) 2018. The three main study purposes are to:

- Measure the mail sent and received by U.S. households,
- Provide a means to track household mail trends over time, and
- Make comparisons of mail use between different types of households.

The report examines these trends in the context of changes and developments in the wider markets for communications and package delivery.

Background

The Household Diary Study survey, fielded continuously since 1987, aims to collect information on household use of the mail and how that use changes over time. The survey collects household information on demographics, lifestyle, attitudes toward mail and advertising, bill payment behavior, and use of the Internet and other information technologies.

The FY 2018 report covers Government Fiscal Year 2018, with comparisons to 2016, 2017, and other years, as appropriate.

In FY 2018 mail sent or received by households represented 83 percent of all U.S. mail.

Overview

In 2018, U.S. households received 115.9 billion pieces of mail, and sent 7.8 billion, as seen in Table E.1. Mail sent or received by households constituted 83 percent of total mail in FY 2018. Fifty-eight percent of the mail households received was sent via Marketing Mail. Only 2 percent of household mail was sent between households; the rest was sent between households and non-households.

Table E.1:
Mail Received and Sent by Households
(Millions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	Received	Sent
First-Class Mail	39.0	7.3
Marketing Mail-Regular	55.8	—
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	11.9	—
Periodicals	5.6	—
Package & Shipping Services	4.9	0.5
Total	115.9	7.8
Household to Household	2.7	
Total Mail Received and Sent by Households *	121.0	
FY 2018 RPW Total	146.4	
Non-household to Non-household	25.4	
Unaddressed	0.6	—

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.
* Total (121.0) is less than received (115.9) plus sent (7.8) because household to household mail (2.7) is included in both categories.

Mail Markets

The Household Diary Study examines mail by the markets it serves. This design cuts across classes, but provides a foundation for understanding mail flows and the marketplace changes that affect them. Table E.2 shows the volume of household mail by market for 2016 through 2018.

Thirty one percent of household mail contains correspondence or transactions, a share that has declined continuously over the last ten years (compared to thirty-five percent in 2008). Correspondence mail volume fell 2.5 percent from 2017 and 1.8 percent from 2016. However, compared to the prior ten years, the runoff in correspondence was much more significant, falling 23 percent since 2008. In part, the decline in correspondence is a continuation of long-term trends but it is also strongly related to changing demographics and new technologies. Younger households traditionally send and receive fewer pieces of correspondence mail; they also tend to be early adopters of new and faster

communication technologies, such as those that grew out of the Internet age, like email and social media.

Table E.2:
Household Mail Volume Received and Sent by Market Served
(Billions of Pieces)

Market	2016	2017	2018
Correspondence	16.4	16.1	15.7
Transactions	24.5	23.0	22.4
Advertising	80.0	76.9	75.3
Periodicals	5.1	4.9	4.4
Packages	4.7	5.1	5.4
Unclassified	2.1	1.8	1.9
Total	128.4	123.8	121.0

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018.
Notes:

1. Correspondence and packages exclude double-counted pieces reported as both sent and received by households.

2. Advertising includes 4.1 billion pieces of First-Class advertising-enclosed mail but excluded from total.

3. Package volumes includes 0.3 billion pieces of CD/DVD rental reported in First-Class Mail letters in Tables E.1, 1.5, and 1.6.

In 2018, only about one quarter of household payments were made by mail.

Both correspondence and transaction mail have been impacted by electronic alternatives made possible by the Internet. With respect to transaction mail, online bill payments have grown rapidly over the last ten years and, combined with automatic deductions, currently account for the vast majority of household payments. As Table E.3 illustrates, the share of bills paid electronically increased from 41 percent in 2008 to 69 in 2018. On the other hand, the share of bills paid by mail fell from 54 percent in 2008 to 27 percent in 2018. The share of payments made in-person also declined, falling from 6 percent in 2008 to 4 percent in 2018.

Table E.3:
Bill Payment Methods

Shares	2008	2018
By Mail	54%	27%
Electronically	41%	69%
In Person	6%	4%
Total Bills Paid	**100%**	**100%**

The Internet also contributed to a decline in the number of bills households received through the mail. Unlike bill payments, however, migration of bills to the Internet has proceeded at a much slower pace. Between 2008 and 2018, the share of bills received online increased from 7 percent to only 23 percent, thus far leaving the majority of bills in the mail-stream.

In 2018, advertising mail (also referred to as Marketing Mail) represented 62 percent of all mail sent and received by households. As Table E.4 illustrates, 90 percent of all advertising mail received by households consisted of Marketing Mail (67.7 billion pieces). The remainder (7.6 billion pieces) consisted of First-Class Mail, either stand-alone advertising (3.5 billion pieces), or advertising-enclosed pieces that are sent along with other matter (4.1 billion pieces). The volume of stand-alone advertising has declined almost 60% over the past decade. As a share of total advertising, stand-alone First-Class Mail advertising fell from 9% percent in 2008 to only 5 percent in 2018.

Table E.4:
Advertising by Mail Class

Mail Classification	Volume *(Billions)*	Percent of Total Advertising
First-Class Advertising	7.6	10%
Marketing Mail-Commercial	55.8	74%
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	11.9	16%
Total Advertising Mail	**75.3**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Note: First-Class Advertising includes 4.1 billion pieces of advertising-enclosed pieces.

As Table E.2 shows, households received 4.4 billion Periodicals by mail in 2018, down from 4.9 billion pieces (or 10.2%) in 2017. According to Table E.5, magazines made up 73 percent of Periodicals. Newspapers represented 17 percent of total Periodicals, a steep decline from 35 percent in 1987. Over the past decade, readership and circulation levels for all types of periodicals declined as the Internet quickly turned into an inexpensive, and often free, source of news and information.

Table E.5:
Periodical Type Received

Mail Classification	Volume *(Billions)*	Percent of Total Periodicals
Magazines	3.2	73%
Newspaper	0.7	17%
Newsletters	0.3	7%
Unclassified	0.1	3%
Total Periodicals	**4.4**	**100%**

Source: Household Diary Study, FY 2018.
Notes:
Totals may not sum due to rounding.

In 2018, households received 4.9 billion packages and sent 0.5 billion (see Table E.6). Compared to 2017 and 2016, total packages sent and received increased about 6 percent and 8 percent respectively (see Table E.2), a growth, driven by rapidly rising eCommerce and online-shopping activity**.**

Table E.6:
Packages Received and Sent via the U.S. Postal Service
(Millions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	2018			
	Received		Sent	
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent
First-Class Mail	1,253	26%	210	43%
Expedited	612	13%	184	38%
Ground Parcels and Package	2,941	60%	85	18%
Unclassified	65	1%	13	3%
Total Packages	**4,871**	**100%**	**479**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Notes:
Totals may not sum due to rounding.
Expedited includes Priority Mail and Express Mail.

Chapter 1: Introduction – Volumes & Trends

The United States Postal Service Household Diary Study (HDS) Report documents the findings of the Fiscal Year (FY) 2018 study. The HDS measures the mail sent and received by U.S. households, tracks household mail trends, and compares mail use between different types of households.

> The Household Diary Study provides a means to track household mail trends over time.

The Survey

The Household Diary Study survey, fielded continuously since 1987, aims to collect information on household use of the mail and how that use changes over time. The survey collects household information on:

- Volumes and types of mail sent and received,
- Demographics,
- Attitudes toward mail and advertising,
- Bill payment behavior, and
- Use of the Internet and other information technologies.

These data are used for market research, forecasting, and strategic planning within the Postal Service.

The Survey Consists of Two Parts:

1) An **entry, or recruitment interview**, conducted by phone or Web, collects demographic and attitudinal information from about 8,500 households.
2) These households then receive a **mail diary**, which collects information on the mail the household sends and receives in a one-week period. Annually, about 5,200 households complete the diary.

The data generated by these two instruments are the basis of the analysis in this report.

The FY 2018 HDS report covers the period from October 2017 through September 2018, equivalent to the Government Fiscal Year (GFY) used by the Postal Service. Data from FY 2016 and FY 2017 are also reported on a GFY basis.

U.S. Postal Service Volumes

Serving a nation containing five percent of the world's population, the Postal Service delivers roughly 45 percent of the world's mail, according to the Universal Postal Union. The Postal Service delivered 146.4 billion pieces of mail in FY 2018—a decrease of 3.2 billion pieces, or 2.1 percent, from 2017.

In 2018, mail volumes continued to be negatively impacted by the migration of transaction, correspondence, and advertising mail to the Internet and other electronic alternatives. On the positive side, the Postal Service continued to experience strong growth in Package volume that was driven by the ongoing expansion of the eCommerce side of the economy.

Marketing Mail volume, consisting mostly of advertising material, decreased 1.4 percent (about 1.1 billion pieces) from 2017 to 2018, due in part to the growing competition from online advertising.

In 2018, First-Class Mail volume fell 3.6 percent (about 2.1 billion pieces), continuing a decline that began in the early 2000's, and was mostly driven by the migration of correspondence and transaction mail to electronic substitutes. First-Class Single-Piece letters and cards were again strongly impacted by households' migration from mail correspondence and bill payments to emails and electronic bill-payments, as volume fell 6% (about 1.1 billion pieces). Presort letters and cards (which also include most of the advertising material that is sent First-Class) fell 2.4 percent (900 million pieces), a decline that was also driven in large part by the electronic presentment of bills and statements.

The Postal Service estimates the revenues, volumes, and weight of mail pieces going through the postal network by using a combination of statistical sampling systems, mailing statements, and accounting data. These data are published in the Revenue, Pieces, and Weight (RPW) Reports. Table 1.1 presents the RPW volumes for FY 2018, along with data for FY 2017 and FY 2016.

Letters, flats, and parcels are defined as follows:

- L**etters** refer to pieces that are less than 11.5 inches wide by 6.125 inches tall and less than .25 inches thick.

- **Flats** consist of pieces that are greater than 11.5 inches wide, 6.125 inches tall, or .25 inches thick, but less than 12 by 15 by .75 inches.
- **Parcels** are pieces that are larger than 12 by 15 inches, or thicker than .75 inches.

Because of the difficulty involved in recording mail-piece characteristics in the Household Diary, these categories do not correspond precisely to the shape categories used by HDS respondents.

Table 1.1:
Total Mail Volume: FY 2016 2017, and 2018
(Billions of Pieces)

	2016	2017	2018
Market Dominant Mail:			
First-Class Mail:			
Single-Piece	19.7	18.5	17.5
Presort	39.9	38.8	37.9
Other	2.6	2.4	2.1
Total First-Class Mail	**62.3**	**59.8**	**57.5**
Marketing Mail:			
Letters	55.9	54.1	53.8
Flats	24.8	24.1	23.4
Parcels & Other	0.3	0.2	0.1
Total Marketing Mail	**80.9**	**78.4**	**77.3**
Periodicals	**5.6**	**5.3**	**5.0**
USPS and Free Mail	**0.5**	**0.4**	**0.3**
Package Services Mail	**0.6**	**0.6**	**0.6**
Total Market Dominant	**149.9**	**144.5**	**140.7**
Competitive Mail:	**4.5**	**5.1**	**5.7**
Total All Mail	**154.3**	**149.6**	**146.4**

Source: RPW Reports.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Mail Flows

Mail volume can be broken into four basic flows, based on origin and destination. These flows are:

1) Household to household,
2) Household to non-household,
3) Non-household to household, and
4) Non-household to non-household, which is calculated as the residual of total RPW mail volume and mail volume involving households based on HDS data.

Tables 1.2 and 1.3 show the total mail in each flow, and Table 1.4 shows pieces per household per week.

Table 1.2:
Total Domestic Mail Flows
(Billions of Pieces)

Sent By:	Received By:		
	Household	Non-household	Total Originating
Household	2.7	5.0	7.8
Non-household	113.2	25.4	138.6
Total Destinating	**115.9**	**30.5**	**146.4**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 1.3:
Total Domestic Mail Flows

Mail Flows	Billions of Pieces	Percent of Total Mail
Sent by Household	7.8	5%
Received by Household	115.9	79%
Total Household Mail*	**121.0**	**83%**
Non-Household to Non-Household	25.4	17%
Total Mail	146.4	100%

***Excludes 2.7 billion pieces sent from household to household**

Table 1.4:
Domestic Mail Flows per Household per Week

Sent By:	Received By:	
	Household	Non-household
Household	0.4	0.8
Non-household	17.1	N/A

Source: Household Diary Study, FY 2018.

Household Mail

As Table 1.3 shows, domestic mail to and from households represented 83 percent of total mail volume in 2018, equating to 18.3 pieces per week sent and received by U.S. households. Table 1.5 presents the volumes of mail sent and received by households as estimated from the HDS, in the categories households used to record their mail. Households received 115.9 billion pieces of mail and sent 7.8 billion. Both of these totals include the 2.7 billion pieces of mail that households sent to each other. The total mail received or sent by households in FY 2018 was 121.0 billion pieces.

Table 1.6 presents these data in two other forms, annual volumes per household and pieces per household per week. Many of the subsequent results in this report are presented in terms of pieces per household per week.

Table 1.5:
Mail Received and Sent by Households
(Billions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	Received	Sent
First-Class Mail	39.0	7.3
Marketing Mail Regular	55.8	—
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	11.9	—
Periodicals	4.4	—
Packages & Shipping Services	4.9	0.5
Total	**115.9**	**7.8**
Household to Household	2.7	
Total Mail Received and Sent by Households	121.0	
FY 2018 RPW Total	146.4	
Non-household to Non-household (Residual)	25.4	
Unaddressed	0.6	—

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 1.6:
Pieces Received and Sent per Household

Classification	Annual Pieces per Household	Pieces per Household per Week
Mail Received		
First-Class Mail	305	5.9
Marketing Mail Regular	437	8.4
Marketing Mail Nonprofit	93	1.8
Periodicals	35	0.7
Packages & Shipping Services	38	0.7
Total Mail Received	**909**	**17.5**
Mail Sent		
First-Class Mail:	57	1.1
Packages & Shipping Services	4	0.1
Total Mail Sent	**61**	**1.2**
Unaddressed	5	0.1

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Classes and Markets

- **First-Class Mail** is used to send transactional mail, correspondence, and advertising. Because it is limited to pieces weighing thirteen ounces or less, it primarily includes letters and cards.
- **Marketing Mail** is advertising mail. For the most part, Marketing Mail comprises letters and flats, although it contains a few postcards and packages as well.
- **Periodicals** are magazines and newspapers, and are predominantly flat-shaped.
- **Package and Shipping Services** is used to deliver merchandise, books, catalogs, and media. Most of this mail is parcel-shaped.

Table 1.7 crosswalks between classes of mail and the markets they serve.

Table 1.7:
Mail Received and Sent by Households

Class	Market (Billions of Pieces)						
	Correspondence	Transactions	Advertising	Periodicals	Packages	Unclassified	Total
First-Class Mail	15.7	22.4	7.6	-	0.3	1.8	43.7
Marketing Mail	-	-	67.7	-	0.1	-	67.7
Periodicals	-	-	-	4.4	-	-	4.4
Packages & Shipping Services	-	-	-	-	5.0	0.1	5.1
Total Mail Received and Sent by Households	15.7	22.4	75.3	4.4	5.4	1.9	121.0

Source: Household Diary Study, FY 2018
1. Correspondence and Packages exclude double-counted pieces reported as both sent and received by households.
2. Advertising includes 4.1 billion pieces of First-Class advertising-enclosed mail but excluded from total
3. First-Class Packages include 0.3 billion pieces of CD/DVD rentals sent to and received from Netflix and other vendors, reported in First-Class Mail letters in Tables E.1, 1.5, and 1.6.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding

Report Organization

The rest of the Household Diary Study report is organized around the markets the mail serves. Each chapter contains an analysis of the trends in the HDS data, as well as a discussion of how those trends affect and are affected by changes in the broader market. The following provides an overview of each chapter.

Chapter 2: Profile of Mail Usage gives an analysis of household demographics. This chapter examines demographic trends over time and their impact on the mail, and discusses attributing factors, such as access to technology and changing attitudes.

Chapter 3: Correspondence examines mail that is used solely or primarily to deliver (non-sales-related) communications, such as letters and greeting cards. This chapter includes analysis of both personal and business correspondence.

Chapter 4: Transactions reviews financial transactions in the mail and the impact of new technologies on that market. It analyzes household bill payment trends with a focus on technological and demographic change.

Chapter 5: Advertising Mail presents the trends in mail used to deliver sales-related messages. It contains information on household attitudes towards advertising by various media, treatment of advertising mail, and demographic determinants of advertising mail receipt.

Chapter 6: Periodicals examines magazines and newspapers delivered in the mail. It looks at how changing demographics are affecting the market for periodicals, and what the implications are for future volume.

Chapter 7: Packages analyzes household use of various types of packages.

In addition, there are three appendices to the report:

Appendix A contains a set of trend tables for major classes and types of mail

Appendix B documents the study methodology and discusses how the data were collected, weighted, and adjusted, and compares demographic data in the sample to that of the population as a whole.

Appendix C contains the instruments used to administer the survey.

Chapter 2: Profile of Mail Usage

Introduction

This chapter provides information on demographic trends and other factors affecting mail volume, thus providing a basis for assessing mail volume changes. The breakouts introduced provide the framework for much of the analyses in subsequent chapters.

The first section looks at growth in mail volume, population, households, and delivery points over recent decades. The next section examines the demographic characteristics of mail users, contrasting higher-mail-volume households with lower-volume households. The third section details the emerging demographic and technological trends that will affect the future of mail. The last section examines some of the factors affecting the use of post offices and mailboxes.

Mail Volume and Demographics

Total U.S. mail volume grew from 110 billion pieces in 1981 to 146.4 billion in 2018, an increase of 33 percent. This growth was closely related to the rates of both population growth and household formation. Over the same period, according to the U.S. Census Bureau, the adult population grew 43 percent and households grew about 55 percent. The number of places to which the Postal Service delivers grew even faster, rising 62 percent since 1981 (see the USPS annual reports). As Table 2.1 illustrates, however, volume decreased by about 2.0 percent per year since 2001 while U.S. population growth, household formation, and delivery points all increased by about one percent per year. With falling revenues and rising costs, the Postal Service sustained significant financial losses over the last several years, through 2018.

Total U.S. mail volume decreased by an about of 2.0 % per year between 2001 and 2018 while population, household formation, and delivery points increased by an average of 1.0% per year.

As Table 2.1 shows, the 1980s was a time of extraordinary mail volume growth (4.6%) that began in 1978 and continued through 1988. In 1984, mail volume grew more than ten percent. During this period, technology facilitated this growth. Construction of computerized databases and techniques for sorting large amounts of data created a fertile climate for direct mail marketing. Computerization of financial systems encouraged billing by mail and payments through the mail. These innovations in business processes were further encouraged by the expansion of postal rate discounts.

The Postal Service introduced work-sharing discounts, encouraging mailers to prepare the mail in ways that reduce the total system cost of creating and delivering the mail. Mailers could take advantage of these discounts by sorting the mail in advance. The Postal Service would receive the mail presorted to the individual ZIP codes and/or to the carrier routes associated with those ZIP codes.

In the late 1980s and early 1990s, mail volume growth barely kept pace with household growth. The demand for mail was hurt by a recession and two very large rate increases.

Table 2.1:
Mail Volume and Demographics
Average Annual Growth, 1981-2018

	1981-1990	1991-2000	2001-2010	2011-2018
Total Mail Volume	4.6%	2.3%	-2.1%	-2.0%
Delivery Points	1.7%	1.5%	1.0%	0.7%
Adult Population	1.5%	1.3%	1.2%	1.1%
Households	1.4%	0.9%	1.2%	1.0%

Source: U.S. Postal Service, U.S. Census Bureau.

The latter half of the 1990s saw rapid growth in mail volume, spurred by a strong economy and rates that increased by less than inflation. The Postal Service also realigned the incentives built into its price structure. It reduced the incentives mailers had for presorting mail and encouraged them to prebarcode their mail. By 2002, the majority of letters the Postal Service received had qualifying barcodes on them. This restructuring of the rates took advantage of the extensive automation of mail preparation and sorting that occurred in the previous decade.

During the 1990s, the U.S. economy rapidly embraced information technology and integrated the Internet into its business processes. An economic recession followed that began in March 2001. The 2001 terrorist attacks on the World Trade Center and the Pentagon led to large-scale disruptions of those mail services dependent on air transport, such as First-Class, Priority, and Express Mail. When air service was restored, Priority Mail was no longer allowed on commercial passenger flights. Soon afterwards, lethal anthrax was sent through the mail, which resulted in five deaths and a number of serious injuries. These terrorist attacks, combined with the economic recession, caused mail volume to decline 2.2 percent in 2002, which was, at the time, the largest annual decline since World War II. In 2003, Marketing Mail volume recovered to a new high, but total First-Class volume continued to decline. Work-shared First-Class Mail fell for the first time ever. Since 2003, Marketing Mail volume grew along with the economy, reaching new highs and exceeding First-Class Mail for the first time in 2005. Total First-Class volume, on the other hand, continued to decline, in part due to the diversion of payments, bills, and statements to electronic alternatives. Additionally, Marketing Mail was increasingly used as a low-cost alternative to First-Class advertising.

The economic recession that began in December 2007 and ended in June 2009 had a severe impact on the mail. Total mail volume plunged 12.8 percent in 2009—the largest decline since the Great Depression. In July 2009, the recession was officially over but was followed by a slow recovery that continued well into 2018. As a result, total mail volume declined an additional 17 percent, cumulatively, from 2009 to 2018. Marketing Mail and First-Class Mail both contributed to the overall decline in mail volume, falling 5 and 31 percent respectively.

Between 2001 and 2018, total mail volume fell 29 percent. During the same time period, both the adult population and households increased 21 percent, and the Postal Service added 15 percent more delivery points to its network.

Growing delivery points accompanied by declining mail volumes have become an ongoing source of pressure on postal costs.

The Postal Service depends on mail volume growth to fund universal service. The number of addresses the delivery network serves increases as the number of American businesses and households increases. When mail volume falls, as was the case between 2001 and 2018, the Postal Service's ability to fund delivery service is hindered by the growing costs of delivering a fewer mail pieces.

Characteristics of Higher- and Lower-Volume Households

Tables 2.2 and 2.3 show the demographic characteristics of households according to the amount of mail received. It is apparent that household mail use is strongly correlated with both income and education. For example, households receiving 12 or less pieces of mail per week earned an average of only $38,570 annually; in contrast, those receiving 36 to 44 pieces per week earned an average of $92,572 annually. Note, however, the similar correlation between mail receipt and Internet access, which is also related to income and education. Therefore, households that make the most use of the mail are the households with the greatest opportunity to use alternatives to the mail.

Table 2.2:
Characteristics of Higher- and Lower-Mail-Volume Households

Mail Received *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Households *(Millions)*	Median Annual Household Income	Households w/ Internet Access *(Percent)*	Total Bills Paid *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Bills Paid by Internet *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Mail Sent *(Pieces per Household per week)*
45 or more	4.0	$98,656	95%	3.2	1.0	3.5
36-44	5.7	$92,572	92%	2.9	1.2	2.7
30-35	8.5	$89,268	94%	3.0	1.3	2.0
24-29	14.5	$79,080	94%	2.8	1.2	1.6
18-23	22.8	$71,058	91%	2.6	1.1	1.4
12-17	29.4	$61,465	91%	2.4	1.1	1.0
Less than 12	42.6	$38,570	87%	1.9	0.9	0.5
Total	127.6	$61,171	90%	2.4	1.1	1.2

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Mail received includes USPS and Non-USPS mail.

Table 2.3:
Education of Higher- and Lower-Mail-Volume Households

Mail Received *(Pieces per Household per week)*	Households *(Millions)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household			
		Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate
45 or more	4.0	4%	21%	16%	58%
36-44	5.7	2%	21%	20%	55%
30-35	8.5	5%	23%	23%	47%
24-29	14.5	5%	28%	19%	46%
18-23	22.8	8%	29%	22%	40%
12-17	29.4	8%	27%	23%	41%
Less than 12	42.6	11%	28%	23%	38%
Total	**127.6**	**8%**	**27%**	**22%**	**42%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Percentages may not total 100 percent due to heads of households who did not answer the educational attainment question.
Percentages in this table are row percentages.
Excludes households not receiving any mail delivery at their home address (using mailbox only).

Demographic Characteristics of U.S. Households

This section presents breakouts of households by demographic categories that influence the volume of mail sent and received. It looks at both traditional and newly emerging factors. The following chapters will show how mail volume varies with these household characteristics.

Income, Education, and Age

Traditionally, mail use was largely determined by household income, education, and age. As Table 2.4 shows, income and education are strongly correlated with each other, as expected.

The relationship between income and age, shown in Table 2.5, is somewhat more complicated. Up to retirement, household income and age are fairly closely related. After retirement, households earn substantially less. However, by that point, mail behavior is pretty well set, and older households continue to receive similar amounts of advertising and periodicals, and pay similar amounts of bills, even though their income declines.

Table 2.4:
Households by Income and Education
(Percent of Households)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Total
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	17%	36%	25%	21%	24%
$35 to $65	8%	32%	22%	38%	22%
$65 to $100	5%	25%	21%	49%	19%
Over $100	3%	16%	18%	64%	21%
Don't know/ Refused	6%	23%	25%	42%	15%
Total	**8%**	**27%**	**22%**	**42%**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 2.5:
Households by Income and Age
(Percent of Households)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household				Total
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	Don't Know/ Refused	
Under $35	24%	28%	48%	0%	24%
$35 to $65	22%	28%	49%	1%	22%
$65 to $100	21%	36%	43%	0%	19%
Over $100	17%	47%	36%	0%	21%
Don't know/ Refused	14%	31%	48%	7%	15%
Total	**20%**	**34%**	**45%**	**1%**	**100%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Household Size

The majority of U.S. households include either one or two adults, but households with three or more adults make up 17 percent of the total. Once considered the norm, nuclear families—two adults and at least one child—now account for about one-quarter of US households. Over the years, the changing composition of households impacted the amount and kinds of mail sent and received by households, generating more and different kinds of advertising mail, as well as affecting transaction mail trends (bills tend to be tied to households as much as to individuals).

Table 2.6:
Households by Number of Adults
(Millions of Households)

Number of Adults	
One	33.1
Two	73.2
Three or more	21.3
Total Households	**127.6**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 2.7:
Households by Size
(Millions of Households)

Household Size	
One person	28.3
Two	51.0
Three	20.5
Four	16.5
Five or more	11.3
Total Households	127.6

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Total may not sum due to rounding.

Internet Access

Access to the Internet and use of Broadband have a large and growing impact on mail use. Bills, statements, and bill payments still represent a significant number of pieces sent and received by households. However, electronic activity in this area is diverting mail once used for these purposes. On the other hand, online shopping adds package and catalog delivery to the Postal Service mail stream.

Table 2.8 shows that 90 percent of households have Internet access (either Broadband or Dial-up) and almost all of those households now have Broadband access. The highest levels of Internet and Broadband access are within households with incomes over $100,000 (each with 98 percent), as seen in Figure 2.1a. In comparison, households with incomes below $35,000 are less likely to have access to the Internet and Broadband (75 and 74 percent, respectively). As shown in Figure 2.1 b, age is also an important determinant of households having Internet access. Younger households (heads of households younger than 35 years old) are more likely to have access to both the Internet and Broadband (94 and 93 percent, respectively). Older households (heads of households older than 55 years of age), on the other hand, are less likely to have access to the Internet and Broadband (83 and 80 percent, respectively).

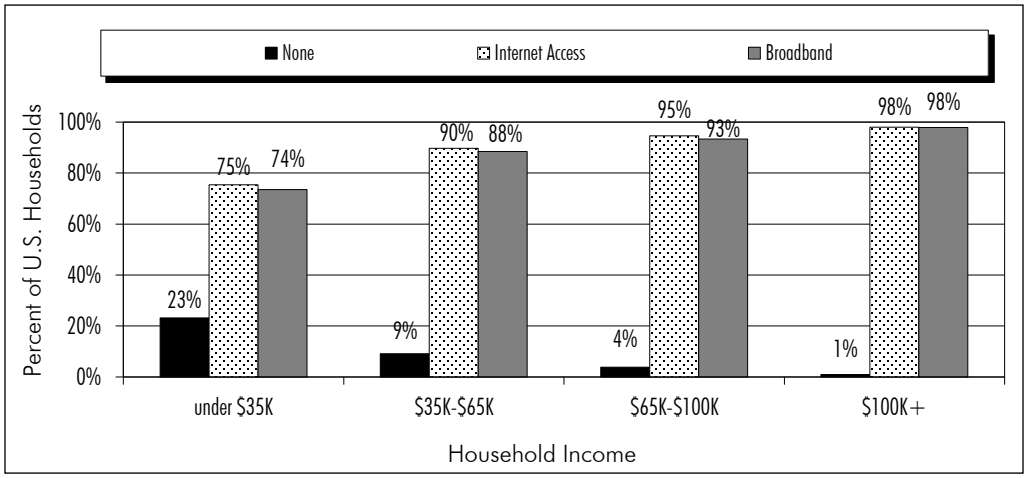
Table 2.8:
Households by Type of Internet Access
(Millions of Households)

Type of Internet Access	
Broadband	113.4
Dial-up	0.8
None	10.4
Others	3.0
Total Households	127.6

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note:
Totals may not sum due to rounding.
Others category include respondents with internet access but did not specify the type, missing answers and don't know/refuse answer.

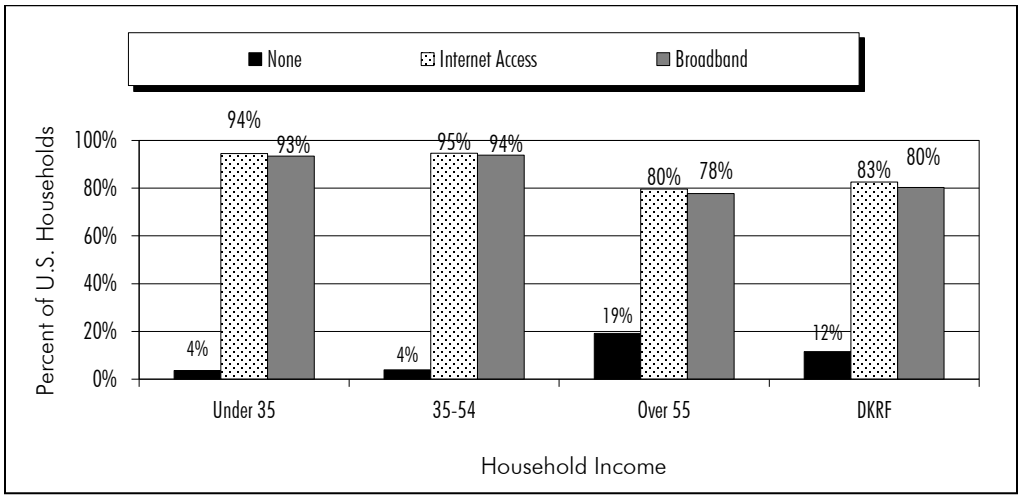
Figure 2.2 shows the trend in Broadband connections. The rapid growth of Broadband has greatly expanded the scope of electronic diversion of the mail. The Internet's fast, always-on connection makes it a stronger alternative medium for the delivery of entertainment, information, and communication. As more households use Broadband, the more that bill payments, bill and statement presentment, periodicals, and even advertising mail, will be affected.

Figure 2.1a:
Internet Access by Income and Type



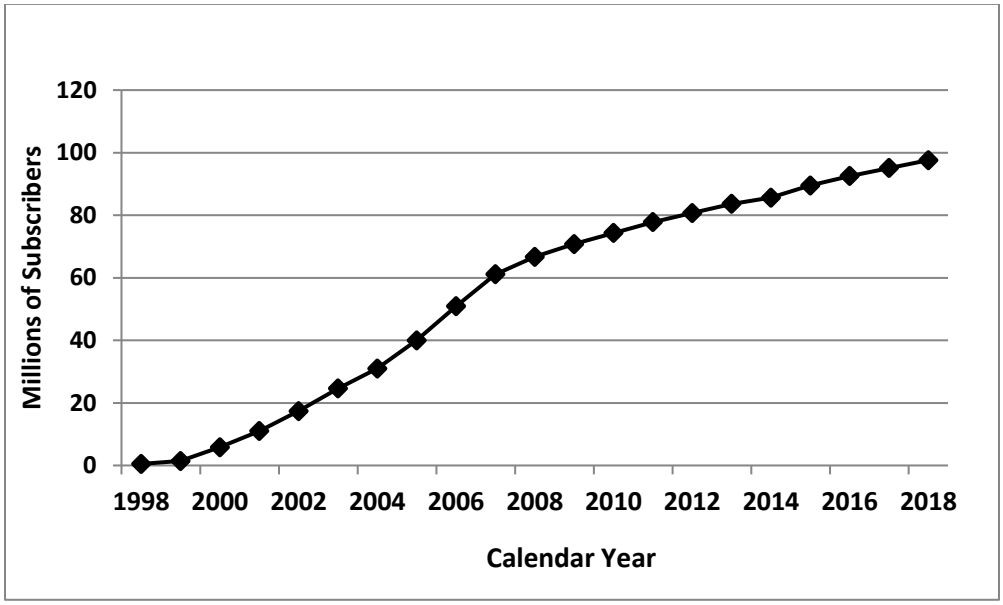
Source: HDS Recruitment Data, FY 2018.
Note: Sum of Internet Access and None does not equal 100 percent due to missing responses and access outside the home only.

Figure 2.1b:
Internet Access by Age and Type



Source: HDS Recruitment Data, FY 2018.
Note: Sum of Internet Access and None does not equal 100 percent due to missing responses and access outside the home only.

Figure 2.2:
Broadband Subscribers



Source: Leichtman Research Group.

Use of the Post Office

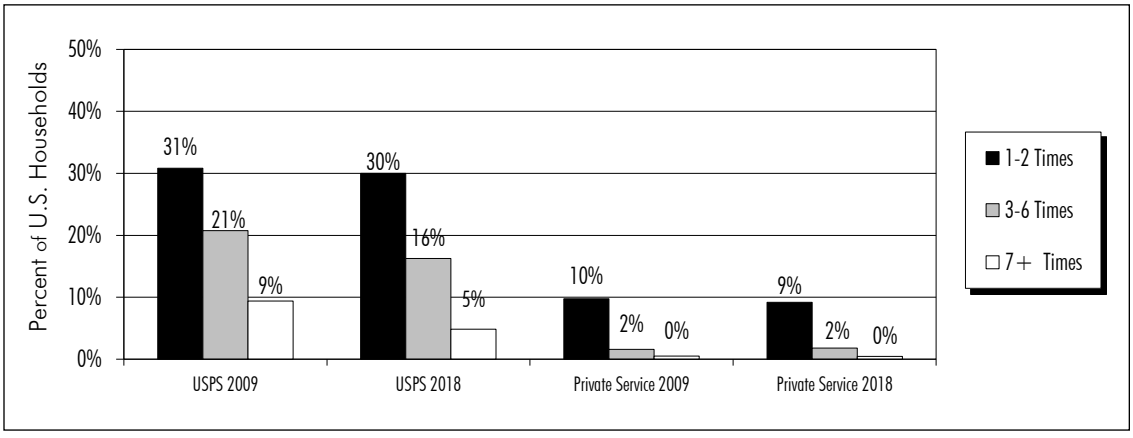
The Postal Service currently owns and operates 34,772 post office locations (including branches) throughout the U.S.

As shown in Figure 2.3, in spite of a declining frequency of visits over the past several years, the use of post offices for mailing services continues to dominate the mail service industry. Fifty one percent of all U.S. households patronize a post office at least once a month, while just 11 percent visit a private mailing company. Over 21 percent of all households in the U.S. visit the post office three or more times a month.

Even with the continued availability of mail-related products and services through alternative modes (such as Internet orders), in-person visits to postal facilities remain strong.

A rented mailbox is one alternative that households use to manage their mail. In 2018, 2.9 percent of all households in the U.S. rented mailboxes from the Postal Service, and 1.2 percent rented a box from a private company. Post office box use, however, declined since the start of the millennium, with 2.9 percent of U.S. households renting a post office box from the Postal Service in 2018, compared to 10 percent in 2001.

Figure 2.3:
Household Visits to Post Office in Past Month



Source: HDS Recruitment Data, FY 2009 and 2018

Chapter 3: Correspondence

Introduction

This chapter examines correspondence mail among households and between households and businesses, including letters, greeting cards, invitations, and announcements. In several cases, this chapter, and several following it, examines comparisons in data between 2016 and 2018, providing an illustration of mail trends over time.

Correspondence Mail Volume

Total correspondence sent and received represents almost 13.0 percent of all household mail volumes, as shown in Table E.2. Table 3.1 provides a recent history of total correspondence volumes, showing a 4.3 percent decline from 2016 to 2018. Personal correspondence, which is essentially household to household mail, fell 3.3 percent from 2016 to 2018, continuing a long, declining trend which started several years ago. As an example, in 1987, households reported receiving 1.6 pieces of personal correspondence each week. By 2018, personal correspondence received declined 69 percent, to just 0.5 pieces per household per week.

In large part, this decline stemmed from competition from an ever-changing landscape of communication technologies, such as affordable long-distance telephone service and, more recently, e-mail, social networking, and cellular communications—all of which provide an alternative to personal letters and business inquiries. Such advances in technological communications completely transformed the marketplace, and continue to have an impact on personal correspondence.

Correspondence Mail and Household Characteristics

The following tables break down correspondence mail sent and received by households using the demographic categories developed in Chapter 2.

Income, Education, and Age

Tables 3.2 and 3.3 on the following page show that both household income and educational attainment have a strong effect on correspondence sent and received by households. In some cases, the volume of correspondence sent and received by households with the highest income or the highest education is almost two times the volume that is sent and received by households with the lowest income or the lowest education.

Table 3.1:
First-Class Correspondence Mail Sent and Received by Sector

Sector	Volume *(Millions of Pieces)*			Change, 2016-2018
	2016	2017	2018	
Household to household	3,157	3,141	3,061	-3.0%
Non-household to household	11,987	11,894	11,714	-2.3%
Household to non-household	1,236	1,086	901	-27.2%
Total	16,380	16,121	15,675	-4.3%
Sector	**Pieces per Household per Week**			**Share of 2018 Total**
	2016	2017	2018	
Household to household	0.5	0.5	0.5	19.5%
Non-household to household	1.8	1.8	1.8	74.7%
Household to non-household	0.2	0.2	0.1	5.7%
Total	2.5	2.5	2.4	100%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018.
Notes: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Table 3.2:
Correspondence Mail Received by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	1.7	1.9	1.6	1.3	1.7
$35 to $65	1.8	2.3	2.1	1.8	2.0
$65 to $100	3.1	2.6	2.4	2.5	2.5
Over $100	4.1	2.2	2.8	2.9	2.8
Average	2.0	2.2	2.1	2.4	2.2

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Excludes Don't Know/Refused.

Table 3.3:
Correspondence Mail Sent by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	.2	.4	.4	.4	.4
$35 to $65	.4	.6	.5	.5	.5
$65 to $100	.5	.6	.7	.9	.7
Over $100	.3	.4	.7	.9	.8
Average	.3	.5	.5	.8	.6

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Excludes Don't Know/Refused.

Tables 3.4 and 3.5 show that age also has a significant effect on correspondence mail sent and received by households. Regardless of their income, younger households both send and receive fewer pieces of correspondence mail. Young adults have traditionally sent and received less mail than older adults, but the Internet age widened the gap between age groups.

Table 3.4:
Correspondence Mail Received by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 34	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	.9	1.8	1.9	1.7
$35 to $65	1.2	1.6	2.6	2.0
$65 to $100	1.7	2.3	3.1	2.5
Over $100	1.8	2.6	3.5	2.8
Average	1.4	2.1	2.7	2.2

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 3.5:
Correspondence Mail Sent by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 34	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	.3	.2	.5	.4
$35 to $65	.4	.4	.7	.5
$65 to $100	.5	.7	.9	.7
Over $100	.5	.7	1.1	.8
Average	.4	.5	.7	.6

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Household Size

As would be expected, household size has a positive effect on correspondence mail. Tables 3.6 and 3.7 show that the jump from one person to two people is associated with a considerable increase in correspondence mail. Further increases in size have less significant effects. Table 3.7 shows that these increases are generally due to the presence of an additional adult in the household.

Table 3.6:
Correspondence Mail Received and Sent
by Household Size
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	Received	Sent
One person	1.5	.4
Two	2.4	.7
Three	2.3	.6
Four	2.5	.6
Five or more	3.0	.6
Total	2.2	.6

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 3.7:
Correspondence Mail Received and Sent
by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	Received	Sent
One	1.5	.4
Two	2.4	.7
Three or more	2.8	.6
Average	2.2	.6

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Internet Access

Table 3.8 shows that households with Internet access (Broadband or Dial-up) tend to receive more correspondence mail than households without such service. The explanation for this somewhat counterintuitive result is the high correlation among income, educational attainment, and the presence of an Internet connection in the home. As Table 3.9 shows, households with Internet access have a greater income and education than those without a connection. Such correlations could be a warning sign for mail, since more volume goes to households that are vulnerable to diversion. Correspondence mail sent by households is not affected much by household Internet access.

Table 3.8:
Correspondence Mail Received and Sent by Type of Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	Received	Sent
Broadband	2.3	.6
Dial-up	1.9	.8
None	1.6	.4
Others	1.7	.4
Average	2.2	.6

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 3.9:
Income and Education by Type of Internet Access

Type of Internet Access	Median Income	% w/ College Degree
Broadband	65,355	45%
Dial-up	33,650	28%
None	27,343	14%
Others	51,441	33%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Personal Correspondence

In FY 2018, personal correspondence accounted for an average of 0.5 pieces of mail per week, which is unchanged from both 2017 and 2016. Table 3.10 shows the total volumes and average number of pieces by personal correspondence type.

Except for small increases in greeting cards, other types of personal correspondence declined compared to 2016, a result of continuing migration to the Internet. Online correspondence has become households' preferred method of communication, as it provides several convenient electronic alternatives to letter writing (e.g.: social networks, e-mails, e-cards,). Each year, the rise of these new virtual technologies continues to change the way friends and family stay in touch.

Table 3.10:
Personal Correspondence Sent and Received

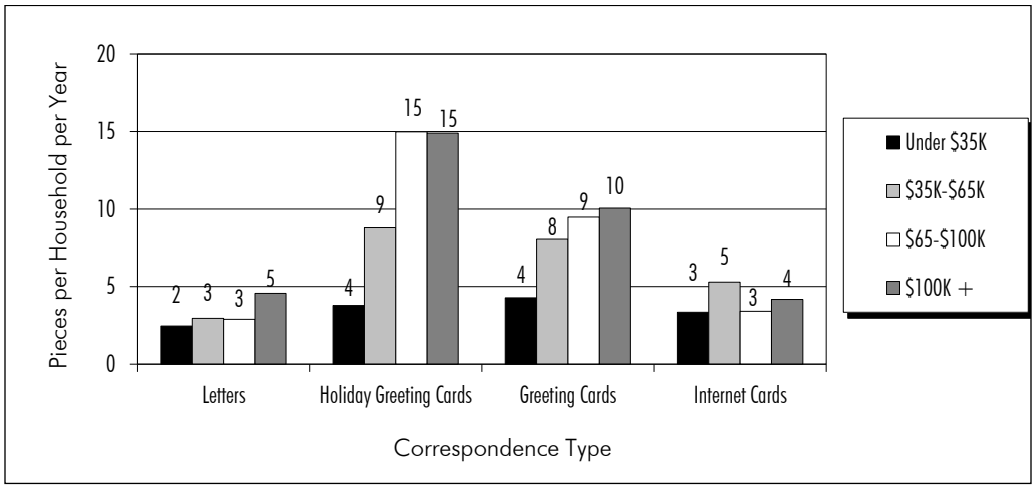
Correspondence Type	Volume *(Millions of Pieces)*			Change, 2016-2018
	2016	2017	2018	
Personal Letters	493	516	436	-11.6%
Holiday Greeting Cards	1,283	1,288	1,332	3.8%
Non-Holiday Greeting Cards	960	981	989	3.0%
Invitations/Announcements	407	339	297	-27.0%
Other Personal	14	18	8	-45.2%
Total	**3,157**	**3,141**	**3,061**	**-3.0%**
Correspondence Type	**Pieces per Household per Week**			**Share of 2018 Total**
	2016	**2017**	**2018**	
Personal Letters	.1	.1	.1	14.2%
Holiday Greeting Cards	.2	.2	.2	43.5%
Non-Holiday Greeting Cards	.1	.1	.1	32.3%
Invitations / Announcements	.1	.1	.0	9.7%
Other Personal	.0	.0	.0	0.3%
Total	**.5**	**.5**	**.5**	**100.0%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding

Figure 3.1 shows the major categories of personal correspondence by income. Personal correspondence sent by households seems to follow a pattern of higher-income households being more likely to send letters, holiday cards, and non-holiday greeting cards than lower-income households.

The largest disparity between high- and low-income households is in the volume of holiday greeting cards sent. Households with incomes between $65,000 and greater than $100,000 sent an average of 15 holiday greeting cards in FY 2018, compared to the 4 cards sent by households with incomes lower than $35,000. Internet card use is growing very slowly and volume remains relatively minor compared to physical cards.

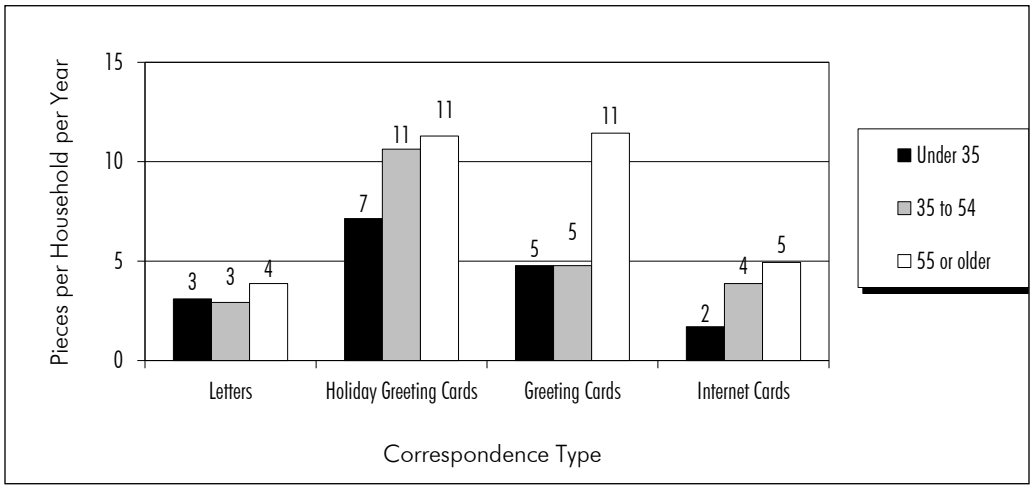
Figure 3.1:
Personal Correspondence Sent by Income Group
(Pieces per Household per Year)



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

The number of letters and greeting cards sent seems to follow a pattern where, as the age of the head of household increases, the more greeting cards are sent. Figure 3.2 illustrates this point. Because social media can be used to send greetings at no cost, it could at least partly explain why the number of internet cards sent by younger heads of household is not higher than reported.

Figure 3.2:
Personal Correspondence Sent by Age Cohort
(Pieces per Household per Year)



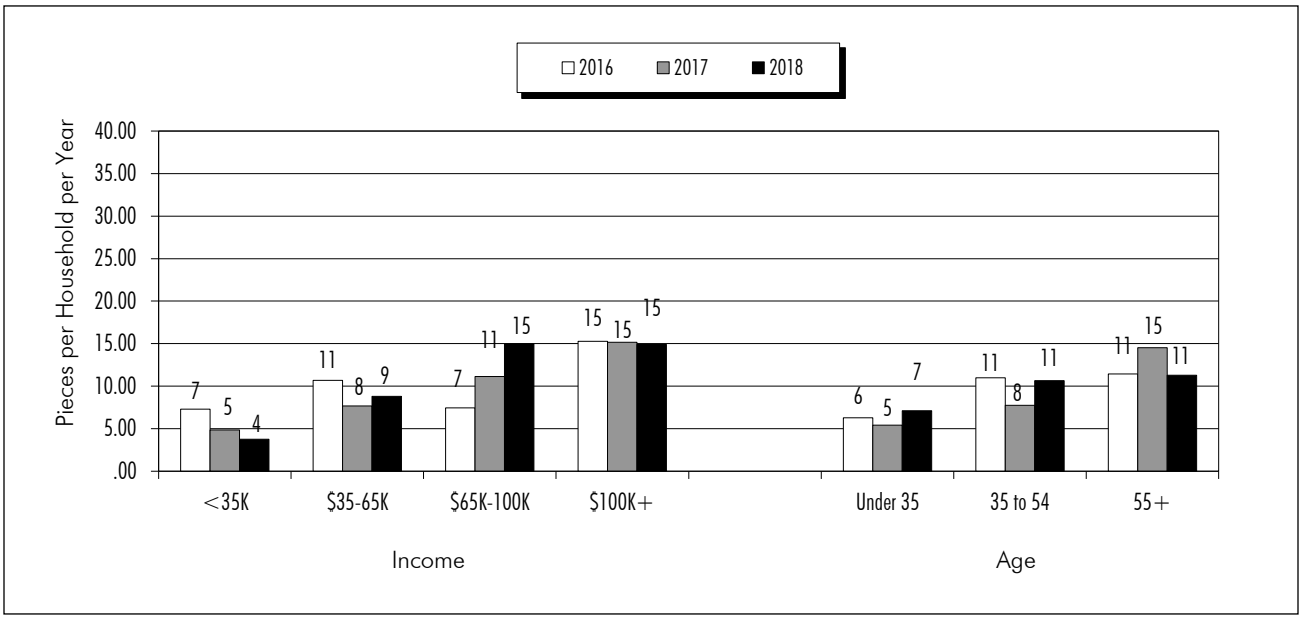
Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Figure 3.3 shows the relationship between holiday greeting cards sent and income over a period of three years. In FY 2018, as in prior years, higher-income households sent the most holiday greeting cards. On average, households with incomes greater than $100,000 sent about the same number of cards each year. Households with lower incomes however sent less holiday greeting cards in FY 2018 compared to FY 2016.

When examined by age, the number of holiday greeting cards sent by households where the head of

household is older increased in FY 2017 but declined in FY 2018. Households where the head of household is younger the number of cards sent in FY2018 was lower than in prior years.

Figure 3.3:
Holiday Greetings Sent by Age and Income, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018



Source: HDS Diary data, Diary Sample only, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018.

As shown in Table 3.11, Internet access has a mixed effect on personal correspondence use. Households with Internet access sent more holiday greeting cards and non-holiday cards than households without Internet access. The number of personal letters was the same for both types of households. The higher volume of greeting cards sent by households with Internet access is partly due to their higher average income compared to households without Internet access.

Table 3.11:
Personal Correspondence by Type of Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Correspondence Type	No Internet Access	Internet Access
Personal Letters	.06	.06
Holiday Greeting Cards	.06	.21
Non-Holiday Greeting Cards	.14	.15
Total	**.25**	**.43**

Source: HDS Diary Sample FY 2018.

Business Correspondence

This section of the report provides data on correspondence types between households and non-households (primarily businesses but also government and social organizations). In addition to correspondence mail, households and businesses exchange bill payments, statements, and advertising (discussed in Chapters 4 and 5). Table 3.12 outlines volumes by types of correspondence for 2016 through 2018. Although some individual categories of business correspondence fluctuated more significantly than others, in general, the volume of correspondence received by households declined slightly over the three-year period, with a net decrease of 2.2% from 2016 to 2018.

Correspondence received from the non-household sector accounts for 75 percent of all correspondence sent and received by households (see Table 3.1).

Invitations and announcements represent 44 percent of business and government correspondence received by households. Other Business/Government includes mostly tax, DMV, and Social Security related

correspondence. Announcements are also the main component of social correspondence received by households; in 2018 they represented 52 percent of all social mail received. Other social correspondence consists mostly of political materials, newsletters and greeting cards.

Table 3.12:
Business Correspondence Type (Sent and Received) by Sector (Millions of Pieces)

Business Correspondence Type	2016	2017	2018	Change, 2016–2018
Business/Government/Social Received by Households				
Invitation/Announcement	5,051	5,055	4,767	-5.6%
Holiday Greeting from Business	341	335	313	-8.2%
Other Business/Government	5,497	5,492	5,655	2.9%
Total Business/Government Received	**10,889**	**10,881**	**10,736**	**-1.4%**
Announcement	535	487	512	-4.3%
Other Social	562	526	466	-17.1%
Total Social Received	**1,098**	**1,013**	**978**	**-10.8%**
Total Received	**11,987**	**11,894**	**11,714**	**-2.3%**
Business/Government/Social Sent from Households				
Inquiry	51	72	39	-23.7%
Other Business/Government	1,029	892	732	-28.9%
Total Business/Government Sent	**1,080**	**965**	**771**	**-28.6%**
Letter	9	11	18	113.2%
Inquiry	4	1	3	-15.5%
Other Social	145	109	109	-24.7%
Total Social Sent (Social includes social, political & nonprofit.)	**157**	**121**	**130**	**-17.0%**
Total Sent	**1,236**	**1,086**	**901**	**-27.2%**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018.
Notes: Totals may not sum due to rounding

Chapter 4: Transactions

Introduction

This chapter examines the volumes and trends in transactions mail: the bills, statements, payments, donations, rebates, and orders sent and received by households. Information is presented on household bill payment trends, which is of particular interest as the availability of electronic alternatives affects traditional transactions mail.

Transactions Mail Volume

Transactions sent and received constitute 19 percent of all household mail volumes (as seen in Table E.2) and 46 percent of all First-Class Mail sent and received by households; as such, they represent a major component of the mail stream.

As Table 4.1 shows, total transaction volume sent and received by households fell 8.6 percent compared to 2016. Most categories contributed to the decline, as volumes were eroded by a continuous growth in Internet usage for a variety of transaction types.

Although many businesses use electronic funds transfer (EFT) or other electronic technologies to settle transactions, households still receive a majority of their recurring bills through the Postal Service. However, as households become more comfortable with electronic the use of electronic transactions, the transition to online bill presentments will likely gain more momentum.

As of FY 2018, the Internet has had the most significant impact on bill payments, as it provides several convenient alternatives for making payments. Payments can now be made on computers, on mobile devices, or other electronic devices. Migration to the Internet was the main cause behind the 8.6 percent drop in mail payments between FY 2016 and FY 2018 shown in Table 4.1. The growth in electronic payments is also evident in Table 4.1, where bills paid by mail are shown to be far fewer than the total number of bills received (according to Table E-3 of the Executive Summary, only 27 percent of all household bills were paid by mail).

Table 4.1:
Transactions Mail Sent and Received (cont.)

Transaction Type	Volume (Millions of Pieces)			Change, 2016-2018
	2016	2017	2018	
Business				
Bills	13,472	12,569	12,445	-7.6%
Bill Payments	3,753	3,347	3,100	-17.4%
Statements	3,994	4,056	3,931	-1.6%
Payments (to HH)	895	896	740	-17.3%
Orders	189	189	157	-17.2%
Rebates	128	135	134	4.4%
Other Transactions	891	798	789	-11.4%
Total Business	**23,323**	**21,990**	**21,296**	**-8.7%**
Social/Charitable				
Request for Donation	524	501	547	4.4%
Donations	286	260	251	-12.2%
Bills	122	73	81	-33.9%
Confirmations	256	207	229	-10.6%
Total Social/Charitable	**1,189**	**1,042**	**1,108**	**-6.8%**
Total Transactions	**24,511**	**23,032**	**22,405**	**-8.6%**

Table 4.1:
Transactions Mail Sent and Received (cont.)

Transaction Type	Pieces per Household per Week			Share 2018
	2016	2017	2018	
Business				
Bills	2.1	1.9	1.9	55.5%
Bill Payments	0.6	0.5	0.5	13.8%
Statements	0.6	0.6	0.6	17.5%
Payments (to HH)	0.1	0.1	0.1	3.3%
Orders	0.03	0.03	0.02	0.7%
Rebates	0.020	0.021	0.020	0.6%
Other Transactions	0.1	0.1	0.1	3.5%
Total Business	3.6	3.4	3.2	95.1%
Social/Charitable				
Request for Donation	0.1	0.1	0.1	2.4%
Donations	0.0	0.04	0.04	1.1%
Bills	0.02	0.01	0.01	0.4%
Confirmations	0.04	0.03	0.03	1.0%
Total Social/Charitable	0.2	0.2	0.2	4.9%
Total Transactions	3.7	3.5	3.4	100.0%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018.
Historical data was restated as a result of improvements to the 2011 survey questionnaires, which restated previously unclassified mail.
The increase in the newly created insurance related category is also related to the changes to the questionnaires.

Transactions Mail and Household Characteristics

The following tables break down transactions mail sent and received by households based on the demographic categories introduced in Chapter 2.

Income, Education, and Age

As seen in Tables 4.2 and 4.3, household income and educational attainment influence the amount of transactions mail sent and received. In most cases, income has a much greater impact on transactions mail received than sent. The basis for this relationship is that higher-income households are more likely to be Internet households and more likely to pay bills through electronic means. The tables also show that, on average, income has a greater impact on transactions mail than education (in general, better-educated households tend to have more financial accounts, insurance policies, and credit cards—all generators of transactions mail volume). Looking across each income category, the impact of education becomes less evident. While in some cases, volume decreases as education level increases, in other cases volume increases or remains unchanged.

Table 4.2:
Transactions Mail Received by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	2.2	2.5	1.9	1.9	2.2
$35 to $65	3.4	3.3	2.8	2.1	2.7
$65 to $100	3.8	3.6	3.0	2.7	3.1
Over $100	3.9	3.6	3.8	3.1	3.3
Average	2.8	3.2	2.8	2.7	2.8

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 4.3:
Transactions Mail Sent by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.2	0.6	0.3	0.3	0.4
$35 to $65	0.6	1.1	0.4	0.5	0.7
$65 to $100	1.4	0.6	0.4	0.5	0.5
Over $100	0.8	0.6	0.7	0.5	0.5
Average	0.4	0.7	0.5	0.5	0.5

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Tables 4.4 and 4.5 show that age has a strong effect on transactions mail, independent of income. Across all income categories, younger households send and receive less transactions mail. In part, this is because such households are less likely to own their home and have fewer insurance policies, investments, and the like. However, it is also the case that these households are more active users of electronic alternatives for traditionally mail-based transactions. This is particularly evident for transactions mail sent by households (primarily bill payments) in which the heads of household aged under 35 years sent only a small fraction of the mail sent by households where the head of household is 50 or older.

Across all income categories, younger households send and receive less transactions mail.

Table 4.4:
Transactions Mail Received by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	1.2	2.2	2.7	2.2
$35 to $65	1.3	2.6	3.4	2.7
$65 to $100	1.9	3.0	3.7	3.1
Over $100	1.8	3.1	4.3	3.3
Average	1.5	2.8	3.5	2.8

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 4.5:
Transactions Mail Sent by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.1	0.3	0.6	0.4
$35 to $65	0.1	0.4	1.1	0.7
$65 to $100	0.2	0.3	0.9	0.6
Over $100	0.2	0.4	0.9	0.5
Average	0.2	0.3	0.8	0.5

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Household Size

In terms of household size, Table 4.6 shows that the increase from a one-person household to a two-person household adds 1.0 piece of transactions mail per week received and 0.3 pieces per week sent, but larger household sizes have a much smaller effect on volume.

Table 4.6:
Transactions Mail Received and Sent by Household Size
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	Received	Sent
One person	2.0	.4
Two	3.0	.7
Three	3.1	.5
Four	3.0	.4
Five or more	3.4	.4
Average	2.8	.5

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

For transactions mail received, Table 4.7 shows that each additional adult adds about 1.0 piece of mail received per week. However, additional adults do not generate any additional pieces of mail sent.

Table 4.7:
Transactions Mail Received and Sent
by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults in Household	Received	Sent
One	2.0	.4
Two	2.9	.6
Three or more	3.8	.7
Average	2.8	.5

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Internet Access

Table 4.8 shows that households with Internet access (Broadband or Dial-up) receive more transactions mail than households without Internet service, even though having an Internet connection at home should make transactions more susceptible to electronic diversion. This apparent contradiction is explained in large measure by the fact that household Internet access is strongly correlated with income and education (see Table 4.9).

Table 4.8 also shows that the number of transactions sent by households with Broadband is lower than for households without any Internet access. The convenience of using the Internet provides a strong motivation for households to move financial transactions online.

Table 4.8:
Transactions Mail Received and Sent by Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	Received	Sent
Broadband	2.9	.5
Dial-up	3.1	1.4
None	2.5	.7
Others	2.7	.5
Average	2.8	.5

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 4.9:
Income and Education by Type of Internet Access

Type of Internet Access	Median Income	% w/ College Degree
Broadband	65,355	45%
Dial-up	33,650	28%
None	27,343	14%
Others	51,441	33%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Bill Payment

As mentioned, households use a variety of methods to pay bills. Historically, they were paid in person, via phone, or by mail. However, the Internet and other emerging technologies have created several electronic alternative to paying bills by mail. The major types of electronic methods include payments made via the Internet (with a computer or a mobile phone), automatic deductions from bank or credit card accounts, and payments over the phone.

The Household Diary Study measures bill payments made by all methods. Table 4.10 shows five-year changes (2018 versus 2013) in the percentage of households that paid bills by each method and the average number of bills paid per month for each method. About 59 percent of households paid at least one bill by mail in 2018 (this implies that 41 percent of households no longer paid any bills by mail). Other popular bill payment methods were online, using a mobile phone or a computer (68 percent of households paid at least one bill online) and automatic deductions from bank accounts (54 percent of households). In 2018, households paid an average of 2.9 bills per month by mail, a decline of 36 percent from 4.5 in 2013. The share of household payments that were made by mail in FY 2018 was 28 percent—the lowest percentage to-date.

In 2018, households paid 55 percent more payments using the Internet (4.5) than by mail (2.9). Additionally, more payments were made using the Internet (4.5) than by all other electronic methods combined (2.8).

> In 2018, households paid 55 percent more bills using the Internet than by mail.

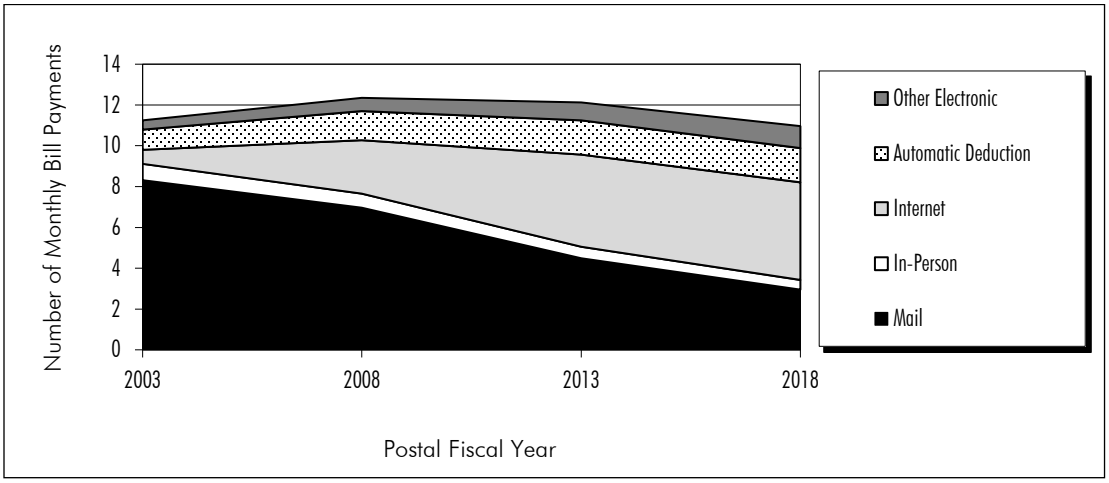
Table 4.10:
Bill Payment by Method, FY 2013 vs. 2018

Bill Payment Method	2013			2018		
	Average Number of Bills Paid per Month	Share of Bills Paid	Percent of Households Using Method	Average Number of Bills Paid per Month	Share of Bills Paid	Percent of Households Using Method
Mail	4.5	37%	74%	2.9	28%	59%
Using Internet	4.5	37%	61%	4.8	44%	68%
Automatic Deduction	1.7	14%	55%	1.7	16%	54%
Credit Card	0.5	4%	22%	0.6	6%	25%
Telephone	0.4	3%	18%	0.5	4%	18%
In-person	0.6	5%	27%	0.5	4%	23%
Total	12.2	100%	—	10.6	100%	—
Total Electronic	7.1	59%	81%	7.2	68%	86%

Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018.
Historical data for payments by mail was restated as a result of improved 2011 survey questionnaires which restated previously unclassified mail pieces.

As Figure 4.1 illustrates, electronic payment methods have accounted for a rapidly growing share of household bill payments over time. Since 2003, the average number of bills paid electronically increased by a multiple of 4, largely at the expense of the mail, which fell 65 percent over that time period.

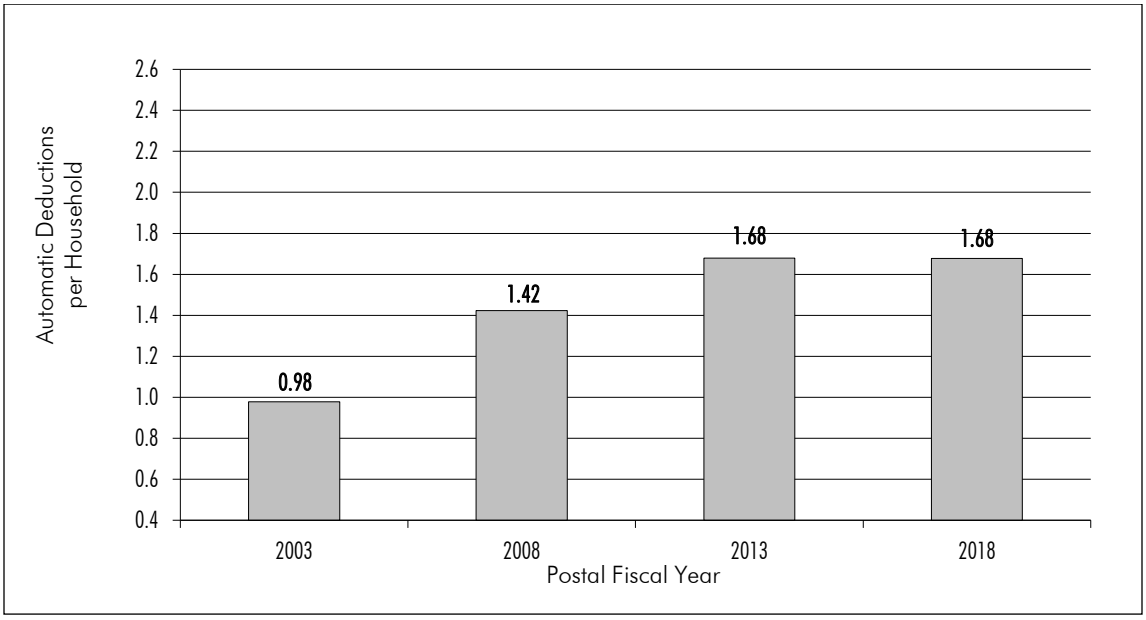
Figure 4.1:
Monthly Average Household Bill Payment by Method



Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2003-2018.
Note: Other Electronic includes telephone.

Figure 4.2 shows that automatic deductions increased by more than two-thirds (71%) since 2003. Over time, however, the increasing popularity of the Internet has provided sufficient motivation for many households to transition from automated deductions to online bill payments, in a way similar to the electronic diversion of payments by mail. As a result, the growth in automatic deductions has slowed significantly and reached a plateau since FY 2013.

Figure 4.2:
Average Monthly Automatic Deductions per Household

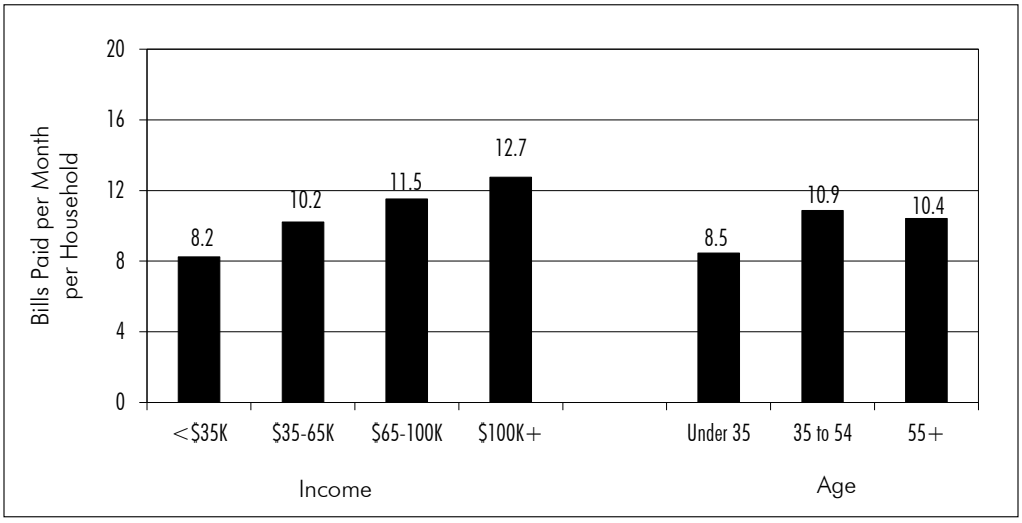


Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2003-2018.

The Household Diary Study has consistently found that the average number of bills paid by mail per month varies by age and income, as does the choice of method used for bill payment. Figure 4.3 shows the total average number of bills paid per month for each income and age group.

Not surprisingly, the number of bills paid per month is positively related to household income. Households with incomes above $100,000 paid an average of 12.7 bills per month in FY 2018, compared to 8.2 bills paid by households with incomes below $35,000. Age has a similar relationship with bill payment levels; younger households (where the head of household was aged 35 or younger) paid fewer bills (8.5 bills par month) than households where the head of household was between the ages of 35 and 54 (10.9 bills per month). For older households (where the head of household was aged 55 or older), the number in bills paid per month (10.4) was slightly lower than for heads of household 35 to 54 years old because they tend to moderate their spending, thus reducing the amount of bills they pay.

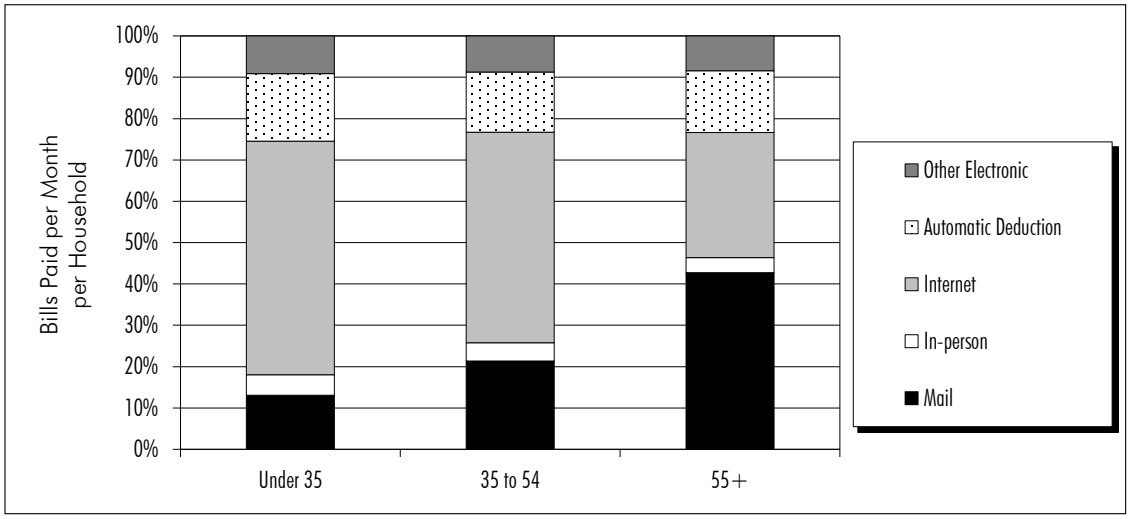
Figure 4.3:
Average Bills Paid per Month by Income and Age



Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2018.

As mentioned, the choice of payment method also varies with age. As Figure 4.4 shows, younger households paid the majority of their bills electronically and were much more likely to pay bills using the Internet than by any other method. In 2018, households where the head of household was aged 35 or younger paid 56 percent of their bills using the Internet and only 13 percent by mail. Older heads of household, on the other hand, continued to pay the majority of their bills by mail (43 percent). They also paid 30 percent on the Internet and 15 percent by automatic deductions.

Figure 4.4:
Bill Payment Method by Age



Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Other Electronic includes telephone.

Bills and Statements Received

Table 4.11 shows the overall volume of bills and statements received. In FY 2018, households received a total of 16.4 billion pieces of bills and statements in the mail, representing about 42 percent of total First-Class Mail received). Bills received (12.5 billion pieces) originated primarily from credit card companies (3.8 billion), utilities (2.3 billion), medical and other professional businesses (1.6 billion), telephone/cable companies (1.5 billion), and insurance companies (1.3 billion).

Statements received (3.9 billion pieces) were predominantly sent by the financial sector (mainly banks, with 2.1 billion pieces).

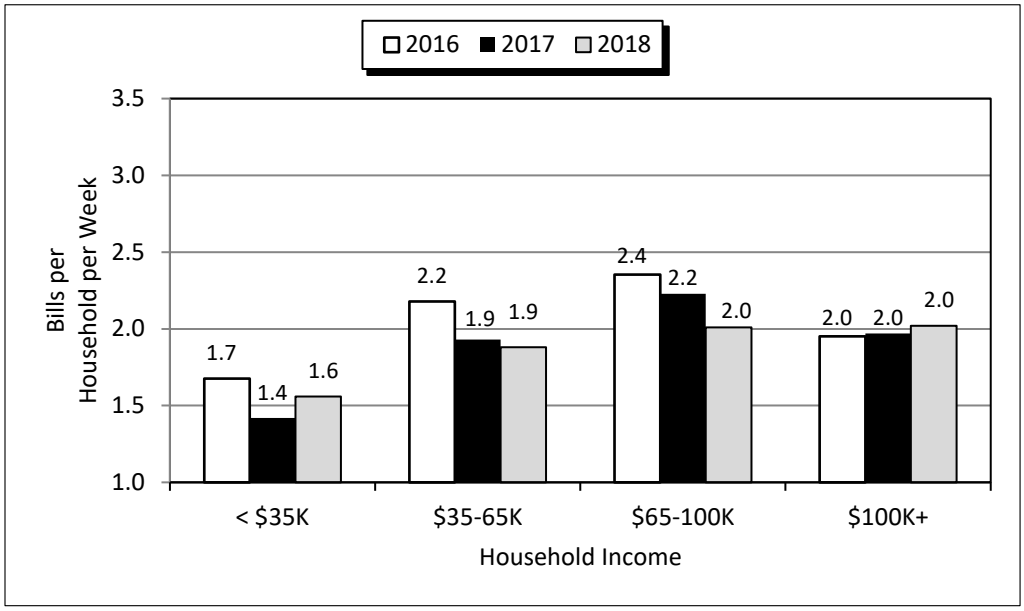
Table 4.11:
Bill and Statement Volumes by Industry

Industry	Volumes	
	Bills ***(Millions)***	**Statements** ***(Millions)***
Financial		
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	704	2,118
Credit Card	3,760	0
Insurance Company	1,252	246
Real Estate/Mortgage	244	98
Other Financial	112	1,141
Total Financial	**6,071**	**3,603**
Merchants		
Department Store	33	1
Publisher	160	3
Mail Order Company	32	2
Other Merchants	139	16
Total Merchants	**364**	**22**
Service		
Telephone/Cable Company	1,461	32
Utility Company	2,247	21
Medical and Other Professional	1,591	101
Other Service	352	28
Total Service	**5,652**	**183**
Manufacturers	14	5
Government	328	73
Social/Nonprofit	0	32
Other/Don't Know/Refused	17	15
Total – All Industries	**12,445**	**3,931**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Social/Nonprofit bill and statement volumes were not collected separately.

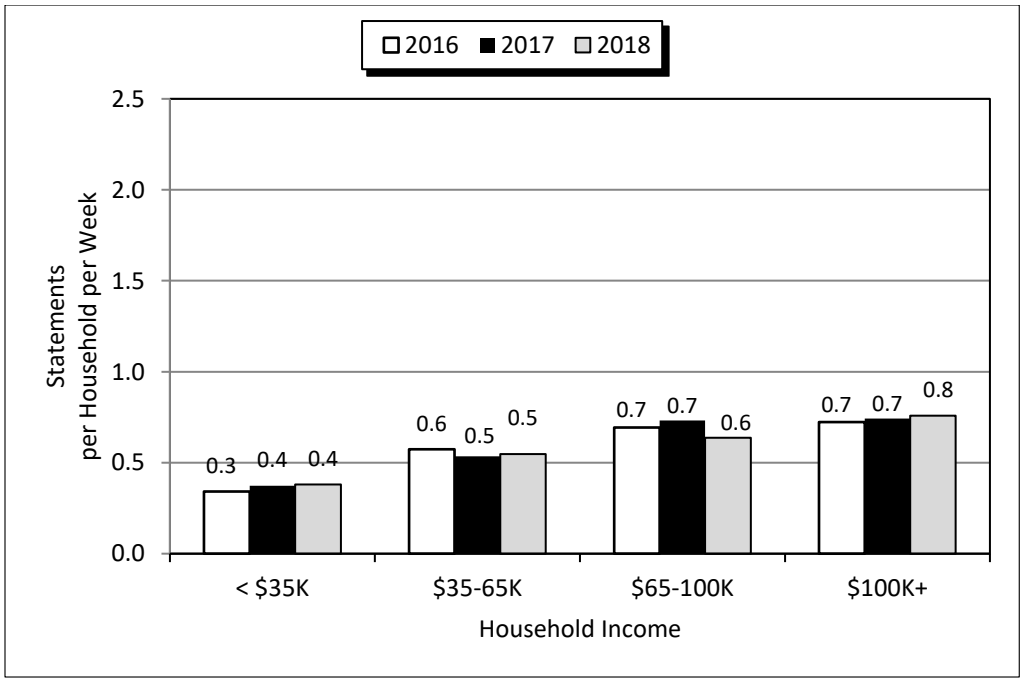
Figures 4.5a and 4.5b, show number of bills and statements received by mail, by income group. Generally, higher income households received more bills and statements because they typically have more financial accounts. Between 2016 and 2018, there was a general, diversion-driven decline in the number of bills received for most income categories. This was not always the case for statements in part because many households prefer paper copies, mainly for purposes of record keeping.

Figure 4.5a:
Bills Received by Mail Per Week by Income



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018. Amounts are rounded.

Figure 4.5b:
Statements Received by Mail Per Week by Income



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018. Amounts are rounded.

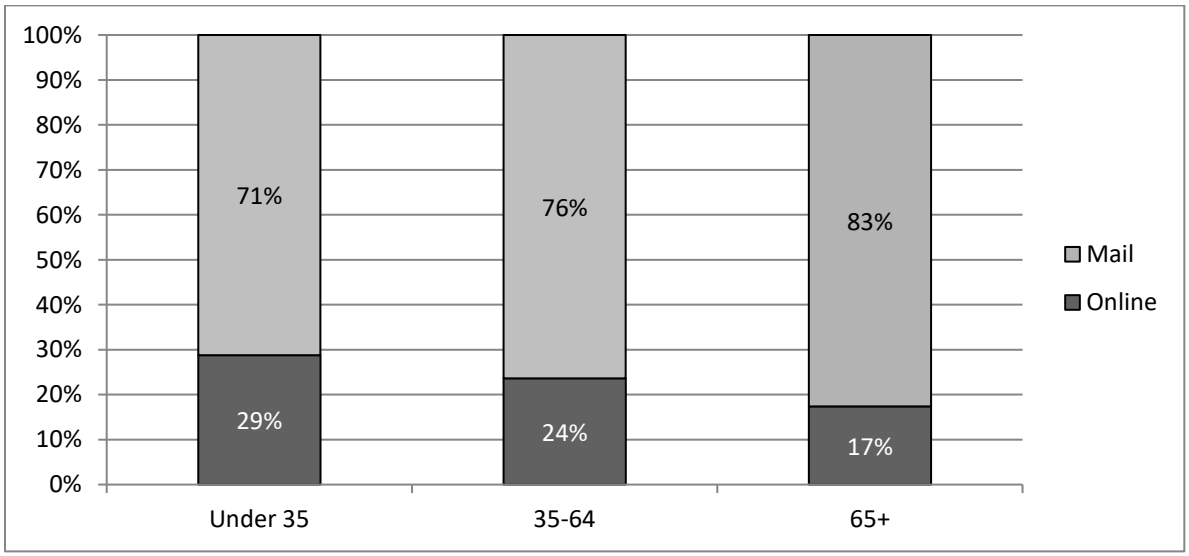
Table 4.12 compares the average number of bills received by mail per month to the average number received via the Internet. As was the case between 2017 and 2016, in 2018 there was another slight decrease in the total number of monthly bills received by households. Total bills received by households fell from 11.2 per month in 2016 to 10.7 in 2018. These declines can, at least in part, be attributed to an increase in the number of billers authorized to make automatic, recurring charges to credit card, checking, and other types of household account, without having to produce a bill. Table 4.12 also shows that the number of bills presented by mail declined from 9.0 per month in 2016 to 8.2 in 2018, reflecting a gradual impact of electronic diversion as bills slowly migrate to the Internet. In fact, bills received online increased from 2.2 to 2.5 over the two-year period, partly offsetting the decrease in the number of bills received by mail.

Table 4.12:
Average Monthly Bills Received by Method

Method	2016	2017	2018
Mail	9.0	8.3	8.2
Internet	2.2	2.4	2.5
Total	**11.2**	**10.8**	10.7
Share Received by Internet	19%	22%	23%

Figure 4.6, shows the 2017 shares of bills received by each presentment method, by age cohort. As expected, younger heads of household tend to convert to electronic presentments more quickly than older heads of household. Households where the head is under 35 years of age received 29 percent of their bills online; the other 71 percent was received by mail. Households over 65 years old, on the other hand, received only 17 percent of their bills online and the vast majority (83 percent) was received by mail.

Figure 4.6:
Shares of Bills Received by Methods and by Age



Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 2018

Chapter 5: Advertising Mail

Introduction

This chapter examines advertising mail, which is any advertising, promotional, or sales material sent through the Postal Service. Advertising mail can be sent as First-Class or Marketing Mail.

The Advertising Market

According to Pivotal Research Group, American businesses spent about $228 billion in 2018 advertising their products and services, an 8.6 percent increase from 2017, following a 2.9 percent spending increase in 2017 over 2016. Of this total advertising spending, 8.3 percent was spent on direct mail, the third largest spending medium after the Internet (46.1 percent) and TV (27.6 percent) (note that Pivotal's spending estimates for direct mail include only postage costs).

As in prior years, direct mail was one of the leading media choices of advertisers in 2018 (third after Internet and TV). However, in spite of a robust increase in total advertising spending, a large increase in Internet advertising left fewer funds available for more traditional advertising methods such as direct mail. As shown in Table 5.1, direct mail spending increased only 1.0 percent compared to 2017 while Internet advertising increased 20.9 percent, the only other media category to show spending growth; spending in all other media fell compared to 2017. Other's fluctuations from one year to the next are seasonalities due to the elections and the Olympics.

Table 5.1:
U.S. Advertising Spending Growth by Medium, 2016-2018
(Percent Growth from Prior Year)

Medium	2016	2017	2018
Direct Mail	-1.7%	-6.1%	1.0%
TV	1.1%	-2.2%	-1.7%
Radio	-2.9%	-2.3%	-2.2%
Newspapers	-12.1%	-15.4%	-18.5%
Magazines	-8.7%	-13.3%	-17.3%
Internet	21.8%	21.4%	20.9%
Other	27.6%	-27.7%	47.9%
Total	**6.8%**	**2.9%**	**8.6%**

Source: Pivotal Research Group—estimates.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

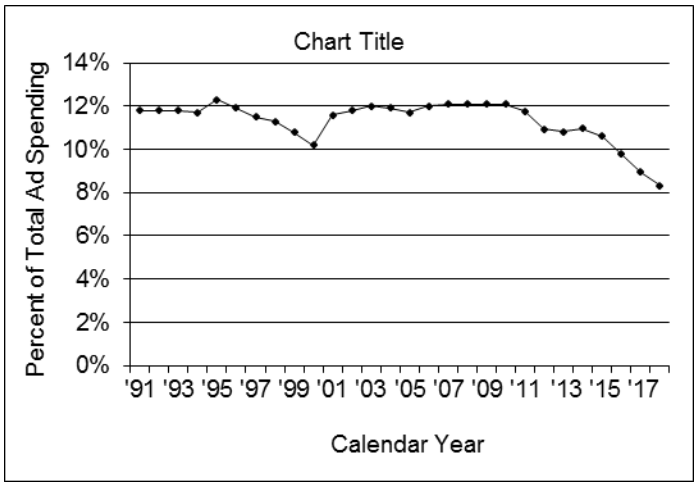
*Other fluctuations are due to political/Olympic advertising

Direct mail continues to be one of the more popular advertising choices. It is a highly efficient and versatile method for communicating with consumers. Direct mail can be targeted to the interests of individual customers, and used both to locate new customers and maintain relationships with existing customers. Direct mail allows for a variety of different types of advertising: letters, postcards, catalogs, and free samples. It can be sent as First-Class or Marketing Mail, allowing advertisers to trade off expeditious, personalized First-Class mailings against cost-savings from Marketing Mail.

Importantly, the effectiveness of direct mail is readily measurable, more so than for most other media. Businesses can track the response rate to a mailing far more precisely than for a television commercial or magazine advertisement. This feature alone gives advertising mail a key advantage over other media.

Figure 5.1 shows that, according to Pivotal's estimate of postage costs, after averaging 12% for over two decades, the share of direct mail spending started declining in 2012 and reached 8% by 2018.

Figure 5.1:
Direct Mail as a Share of Total Advertising, 1991-2018



Source: U.S. Postal Service calculations based on Pivotal Research Group data.

Advertising Mail Volumes

In 2018, advertising mail represented 62 percent of all household mail. Households received 75.3 billion pieces of advertising mail, down 6.0 percent from 2016, driven by an 8.4 percent decline in First-Class advertising and a 5.7 percent decline in Marketing Mail advertising.

As shown in Table 5.2, First-Class advertising mail accounted for 7.6 billion pieces (10 percent of all advertising mail received by households). Of this volume, 3.5 billion pieces were advertising-only, while the other 4.1 billion pieces were secondary advertising pieces. The latter, also referred to as advertising-enclosed mail, are not included in the total volume count for advertising because the primary piece (be it a bill, statement, or correspondence mailing) is already included in the First-Class Mail total.

In 2018, First-Class advertising-only mail fell 8.4 percent compared to 2016, continuing a decline which began in 2007, just prior to the Great Recession. Weak economic conditions that followed the recession encouraged mailers to rely more heavily on Marketing Mail advertising - a cheaper alternative to First-Class Mail.

Advertising mail represented 62 percent of all mail received by households in 2018

About 90 percent (67.7 billion pieces) of all advertising mail received by households in 2018 was sent via Marketing Mail. Compared to 2016, Marketing Mail fell 5.7 percent, driven by slow economic growth and increasing migration of advertising dollars from traditional media like direct mail to internet advertising.

Marketing Mail accounted for 90 percent of total household advertising mail.

Table 5.2:
Advertising Mail Received by Households by Mail Classification
(Volume in Billions of Pieces)

Mail Classification	Volume *(Billions of Pieces)*			Change 2016-2018
	2016	2017	2018	
First-Class Advertising	8.3	7.8	7.6	-8.4%
Advertising Only	3.8	3.7	3.5	-8.4%
Secondary Advertising	4.5	4.1	4.1	-8.4%
Marketing Mail	71.8	69.1	67.7	-5.7%
Regular and ECR	60.2	57.5	55.8	-7.3%
Nonprofit	11.6	11.7	11.9	2.7%
Unsolicited Packages	0.05	0.05	0.04	-9.5%
Total Advertising	80.1	77.0	75.3	-6.0%
Unaddressed Mail	1.1	1.0	1.0	-8.7%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018.
Notes: Totals may not sum due to rounding. Unaddressed Mail is not included in totals.

Table 5.3:
Advertising Mail by Mail Classification
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Mail Classification	Pieces per HH per Week			Share of Total
	2016	2017	2018	
First-Class Advertising	1.3	1.2	1.1	10.1%
Advertising Only	0.6	0.6	0.5	4.7%
Secondary Advertising	0.7	0.6	0.6	5.4%
Marketing Mail	11.0	10.5	10.2	89.9%
Regular and ECR	9.2	8.8	8.4	74.1%
Nonprofit	1.8	1.8	1.8	15.8%
Unsolicited Periodicals/Packages	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.1%
Total Advertising	12.2	11.7	11.4	100.0%
Unaddressed Mail	0.2	0.2	0.1	1.3%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding. Unaddressed Mail is not included in totals.

Advertising Mail and Household Characteristics

Income, Education, and Age

Given that advertising mail is used to sell goods and services, it is not surprising that the amount of ad mail received by a household is closely tied to income and education.

The relationship between advertising mail and household income is quite strong, as seen in Table 5.4. Households with incomes of $100,000 or more receive about twice as many pieces of advertising mail as households with income of less than $35,000 (14.7 vs. 7.4 pieces per week).

Table 5.4 also shows that education plays a key role in the amount of advertising mail households receive. For example, households headed by someone without a high school degree receive 9.0 pieces per week while households headed by a college graduate receive 12.5 pieces per week (higher income households without a high school diploma likely represent successful entrepreneurs who receive large volumes of business-related ad mail).

The role that education plays in advertising mail is two-fold. First, direct mail is a written type of communication, and education may play some role in its relative effectiveness compared to television or radio advertising. Second, education is not only tied to current household income, but also to future household income. A college graduate who currently has a relatively low income may, in a few years, earn a much higher income.

Table 5.4:
Advertising Mail Received by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income (Thousands)	Education of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School graduate	Some College or Technical School	College graduate	
Under $35	7.3	7.5	7.2	7.6	7.4
$35 to $65	10.4	11.9	11.0	9.9	10.8
$65 to $100	9.9	13.0	12.5	12.6	12.6
Over $100	14.7	12.9	14.4	15.2	14.7
Average	9.0	10.7	10.7	12.5	11.4

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

As Table 5.5 illustrates, households headed by an older person receive more advertising mail than those headed by someone younger. For every income group, advertising mail received increases as the age of the head of the household increases. In part, this is because age is correlated with other characteristics such as marriage, home ownership, and the presence of children in the household.

Moreover, the older a person is, the longer his or her buying history and the more businesses with which the person has a relationship that advertising mail can help maintain. Those households with incomes greater than $100,000 and with a head of household aged 55 and older received the greatest number of advertising mail pieces, with 18.9 pieces per week.

The amount of advertising mail received increases as income, education, and age increase.

Table 5.5:
Advertising Mail Received by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 34	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	4.2	6.4	9.6	7.4
$35 to $65	6.4	8.6	13.9	10.8
$65 to $100	8.1	11.1	15.9	12.6
Over $100	9.4	13.3	18.9	14.7
Average	6.6	10.4	14.1	11.4

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Household Size

Tables 5.6 and 5.7 show advertising mail received increases as the household size and number of adults in the household increase. Table 5.6 shows that, while this is evident by looking at changes in household sizes from one to two household members (where mail pieces increase 41 percent), additional members over two do not increase the number of advertising pieces received.

Table 5.6:
Advertising Mail Received by Size of Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	
One person	9.0
Two	12.7
Three	11.5
Four	11.0
Five or more	11.4
Average	11.4

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

When looking at changes in the number of adults in the household, there is a slightly more continuous increase in the number of advertising mail pieces received as the number of adults increases. Households with two adults receive 40% more advertising mail than those with only one adult. Households with three or more adults receive 3 percent more advertising mail than a household with two adults. These results stem from the likelihood that households with more than one adult are also two (or more) -income households.

Table 5.7:
Advertising Mail Received by Number of Adults
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	
One	8.7
Two	12.2
Three or more	12.6
Average	11.4

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Internet Access

Finally, Table 5.8 shows that there is a direct relationship between advertising mail received and Internet access. Despite all the attention paid to online and e-mail advertising, households with Internet access receive more advertising mail than those without access.

To a large degree, this reflects other household characteristics. As Table 5.9 shows, Internet access is closely tied to income and education. However, advertising mail is sent even when new advertising media are available. As Table 5.8 may demonstrate, the Internet is often used to target potential customers through direct mail advertising. Conversely, direct mail can also be used as a complement to the Internet by directing potential customers to specific company websites.

Table 5.8:
Advertising Mail Received by Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	
Broadband	11.5
Dial-up	12.3
None	9.6
Others	10.6
Average	11.4

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 5.9:
Income and Education by Type of Internet Access

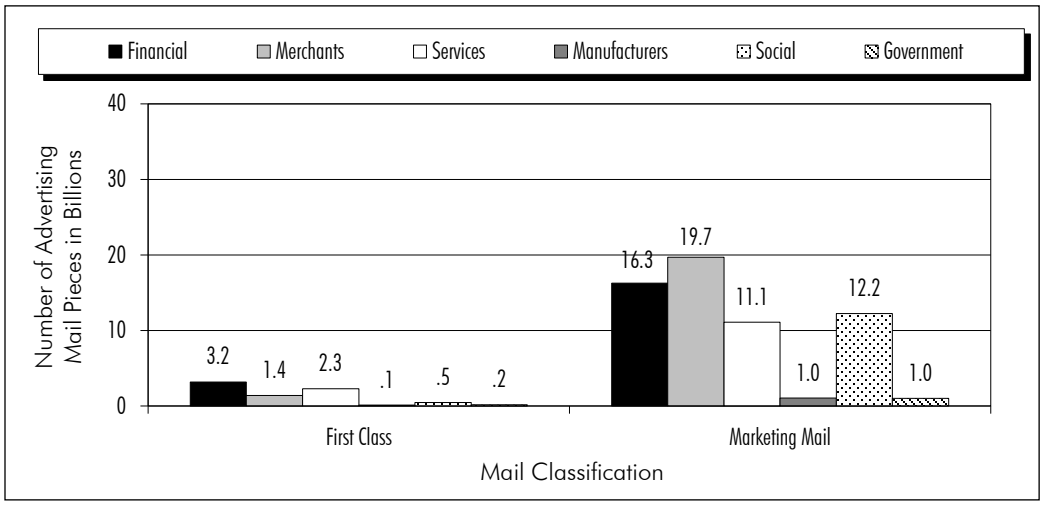
Type of Internet Access	Median Income	% w/ College Degree
Broadband	65,355	45%
Dial-up	33,650	28%
None	27,343	14%
Others	51,441	33%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Senders of Advertising Mail

Figure 5.2 provides data on the senders of advertising mail to households. Merchants continue to send the largest volumes; in 2018, they sent 32 percent of Marketing Mail advertising mail and 18 percent of First-Class advertising mail. Financial firms are the second largest sender of both Marketing Mail and First-Class Mail advertising (27 and 42 percent respectively).

Figure 5.2:
Advertising Volumes for First-Class and Marketing Mail Advertising by Sender Type



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018

Attitudes toward Advertising

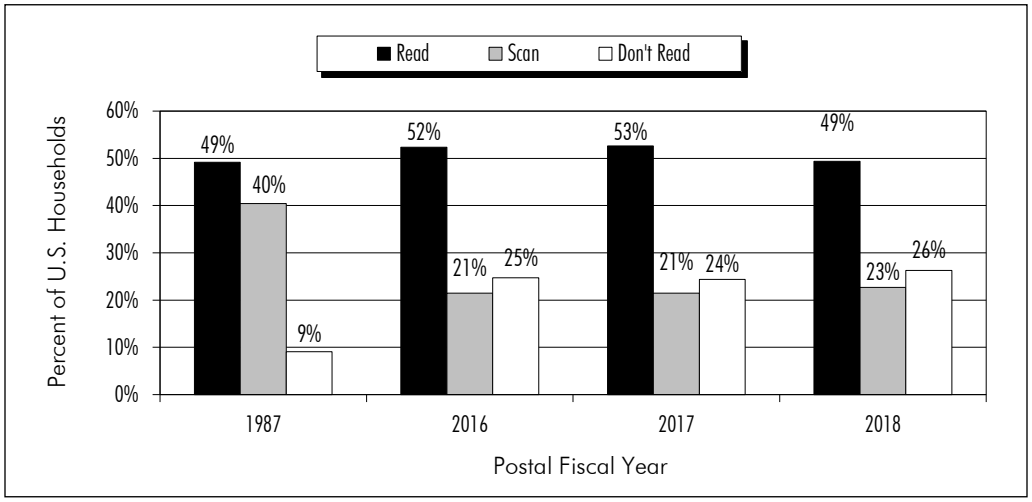
With $228 billion spent in the United States on advertising, few households would probably wish they received more.

Whether they wish to receive more or not, most households either read or at least scan their advertising mail. Figure 5.3 shows that, in 2018, 49 percent of households read their advertising mail, while an additional 23 percent scanned their mail. Twenty-six percent of households report they do not usually read their advertising mail, a substantial increase from the nine percent who did not usually read advertising mail in 1987.

However, given the large increase in advertising mail volumes since then, it is clear that U.S. households read more advertising mail now than in the past.

> Seventy two percent of households either read or scan advertising mail received.

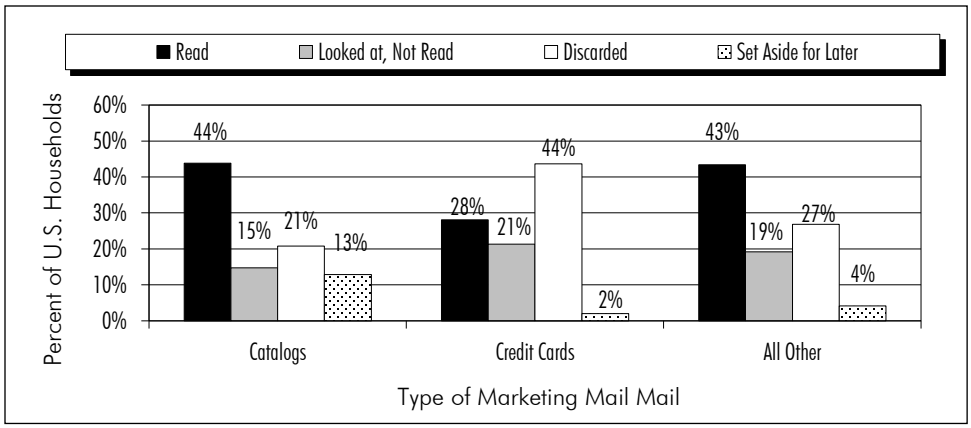
Figure 5.3:
Advertising Mail Behavioral Trends, FY 1987, 2016, 2017, and 2018



Source: HDS Recruitment Sample, FY 1987, 2016, 2017, and 2018.
Note: Percentages do not include those who did not provide a response.

Interestingly, the survey shows that not all advertising is treated equally. Figure 5.4 shows that catalogs attract more attention than credit card advertising, as they are usually more interesting to read. Forty-four percent of households read catalogs, and only 21 percent discard them without reading them. By contrast, 28 percent of households read credit card advertising and 44 percent discard them without reading them.

Figure 5.4:
Treatment of Marketing Mail Advertising by Type

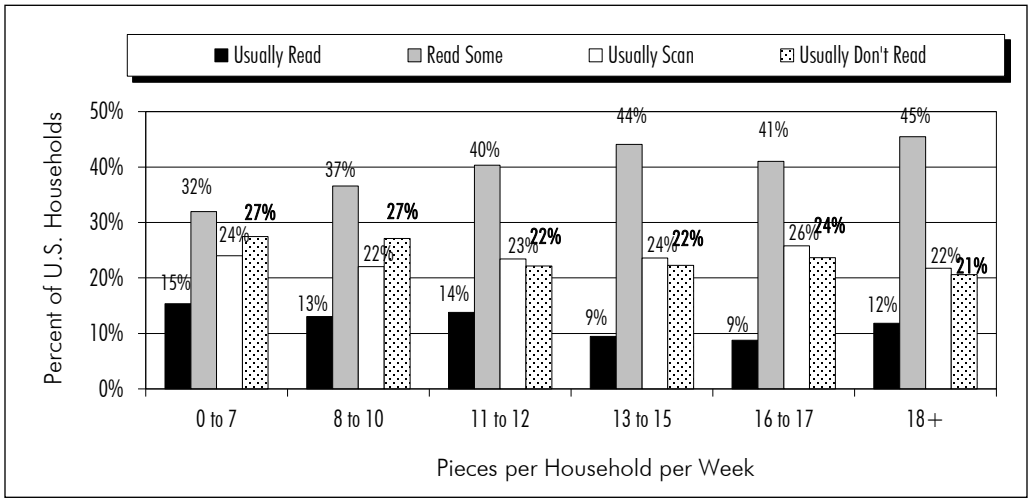


Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Note: Percentages do not include those who did not provide a response.

Another interesting result is found in Figure 5.5. Household behavior toward advertising mail is dependent on how much advertising mail the household receives. For example, among households that receive zero to seven pieces of advertising mail per week, 15 percent usually read all the mail and 32 percent only read some of it. Among households that receive 16 to 17 pieces per week, only 9 percent usually read all the mail and 41% only read some of it.

Thus, households that receive more advertising mail than others appear to be "turned off" by the high volume. However, Figure 5.5 also shows that about 50 percent of households usually read all or some of their mail, a percentage that is unaffected by volume received. Additionally, the percent of households that usually don't read their advertising mail is about the same regardless of how much mail the household receives.

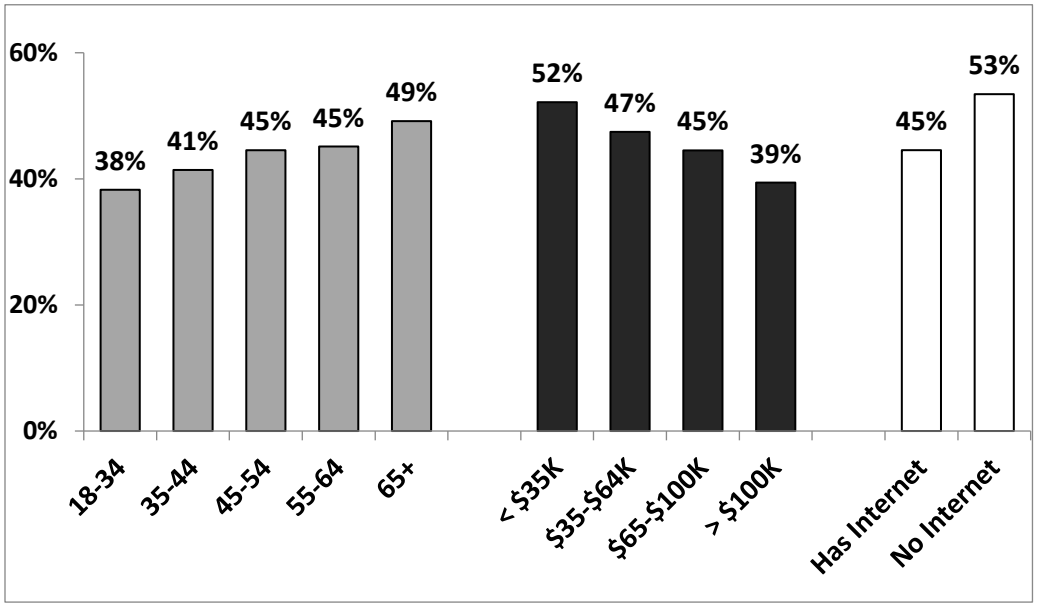
Figure 5.5:
Treatment of Advertising Mail by Number of Marketing Mail Pieces Received per Week



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Finally, as Figure 5.6 illustrates, household demographics can have a substantial impact on advertising mail's reading rates. Lower income households tend to read more advertising mail, probably because they typically receive less mail than their wealthier counterparts. With respect to age, because older heads of households generally read more than younger ones, they also tend to read more advertising mail. Finally, Figure 5.6 shows that households with an Internet connection read almost as much advertising mail as households without one. This is probably because internet households tend to be wealthier and more educated, both of which are associated with high reading rates.

Figure 5.6:
Advertising Mail Reading Rates by Household Demographics - FY 2018



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Effectiveness of Advertising Mail

Ultimately, advertisers send direct mail because it works—household members read and respond to it. Table 5.10 presents the intended response of households to advertising mail. Households report they intend to respond to about 13 percent of First-Class advertising mail and 11 percent of Marketing Mail. While these intended response rates are usually higher than actual response rates, the data demonstrate the impact that direct mail can have on household purchasing behavior. Table 5.10 also shows that households say they may respond to another 13 percent of First-Class advertising and 15 percent of Marketing Mail advertising. This is not to say that a similar mail piece may receive a higher response rate if mailed via Marketing Mail; it is more likely the result of a different mix of advertising material in Marketing Mail. For example, catalogs, which typically enjoy a high response rate (linked to the high read rate shown in Figure 5.4), are routinely mailed Marketing Mail but are infrequently mailed First-Class. Credit card advertising pieces, on the other hand, have the lowest response rate (linked to the lowest read rate shown in Figure 5.4) and are often mailed First-Class.

Figure 5.7 presents the total number of intended responses to advertising mail by income. As illustrated earlier in Tables 5.4 and 5.5, higher-income households received more advertising mail. Figure 5.6 combines the data on the amount of advertising mail received by household income with the household's intended response to the mail. The result is the average number of intended responses per week for each income level. For example, households with incomes greater than $150,000 report they intend to respond to 1.3 pieces of advertising mail per week, and they may respond to another 2.0 pieces per week. Other high-income households also indicated they will respond to more than one piece of advertising mail per week, as do some of the lower-income households (except for those with income lower than $35,000).

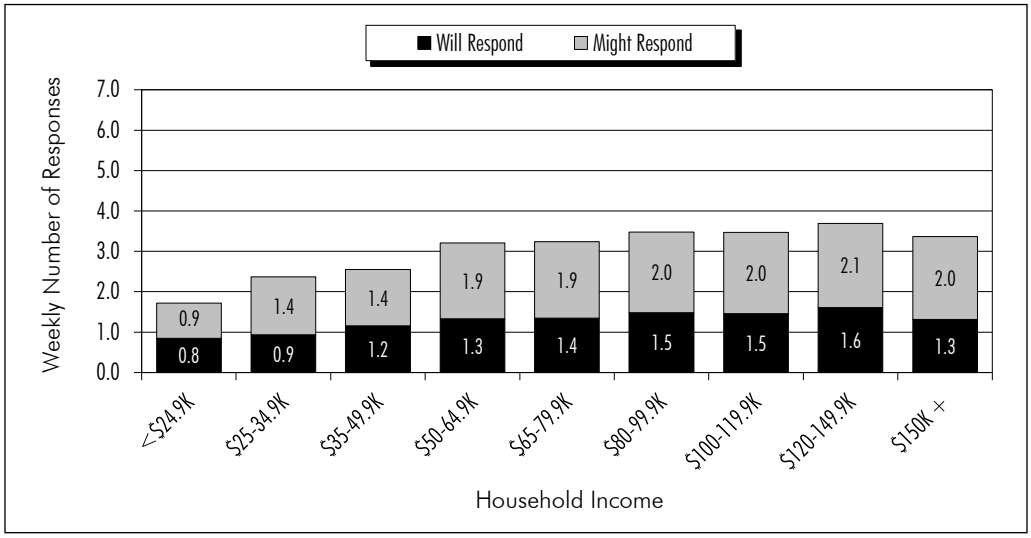
While intended responses do not always lead to actual responses, the data presented in Table 5.10 and Figure 5.7 help explain why direct mail is a popular choice of advertisers in America. Although there is no completely equivalent measure for intended response to Internet ads, the click-through rate (the percentage of online visitors who viewed an ad and also clicked on it) is widely used as an indicator of consumers' interest in online ads. As such, it is somewhat comparable to mail ads' read rates. Based on published reports, the average click-through rate for Internet advertising is less than 3 percent. Overall read rates for mail ads, on the other hand, have averaged about 50 percent (as shown earlier in Figure 5.5).

Table 5.10:
Intended Response to Advertising Mail by Class
(Percentage of Pieces)

Response	First-Class	Marketing Mail
Yes	13%	11%
Maybe	13%	15%
No	64%	67%
No Answer	10%	7%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Figure 5.7:
Weekly Number of Intended Responses by Income



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Chapter 6: Periodicals

Introduction

This chapter examines periodicals sent to households. Periodical Mail consists of newspapers or magazines regularly sent to households, usually as part of a subscription. This chapter analyzes only periodicals delivered by the Postal Service to households. Newspapers or magazines delivered by a local carrier or purchased at a newsstand or store are not included in Household Diary Study data. The volumes examined here are only a portion of the total periodicals volume, since some of periodicals are received by non-households, such as doctors' offices or other businesses.

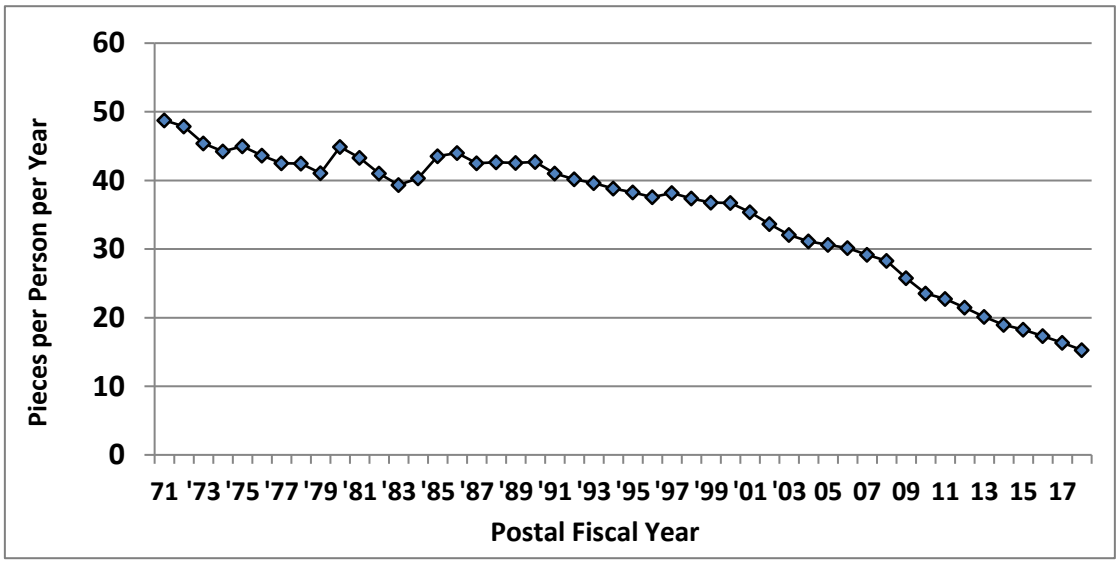
Periodicals have declined since the 1990's as the Internet became the main substitute for hard-copy publications.

The Periodicals Market

Historically, Periodical Mail volume has not kept pace with population growth, as seen in Figure 6.1. Since the early 1990s, as demographics and technology changed, people began to read less printed materials. Periodicals reached a peak volume in 1990 at 10.7 billion pieces, but have declined each year since then, with the exception of FY 2000. In that year, the periodical industry was temporarily buoyed by an influx of advertising revenue during the dot-com boom.

After the recession that began in 2001, periodicals volume slipped not only because of reduced subscriptions, but also because of the number of publications that ceased operation as their sources of advertising revenue dried up. Since then, in addition to a general demographic shift away from reading, periodicals volume continued to decline as the Internet became an increasingly preferred substitute for hard-copy publications. Since 2008, the decline was further aggravated by the impact of the severe recession and the slow recovery that followed.

Figure 6.1:
Periodicals Mail Volume per Person, 1971-2018
(Annual Pieces per Person)



Source: U.S. Postal Service RPW Reports, U.S. Census Bureau.

Advertising's Impact on Periodicals

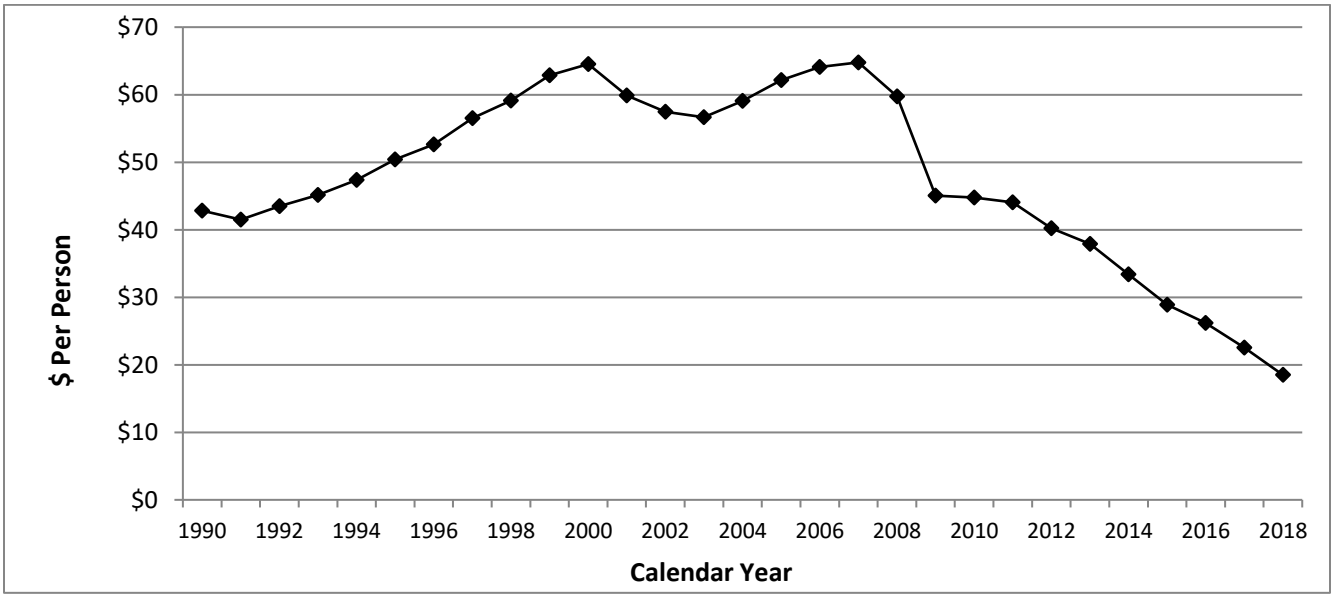
Advertising spending translates into advertising revenue, and the key determinant of periodicals profitability is advertising revenue.

Advertising is a form of business investment. As with other investments, when the economy takes a turn for the worse, advertising tends to slow. By 2000, total advertising as a percent of Gross Domestic Product (GDP) rose to a historically high level; when the high-tech bubble burst, advertising crashed. In 2002, albeit at a slower pace, total advertising spending resumed its growth, and, after six years of economic expansion, reached a new record high. After 2007, however, advertising spending suffered its largest decline in history and, by 2009, fell more than 20 percent. Since 2009, total advertising spending increased 34 percent, aided by a recovering economy. Magazine advertising, on the other hand, continued to decline albeit at a slower pace than during the recession.

Figure 6.2 shows the sharp decline in real per capita advertising spending for magazines that started in 2001 due to the recession. Annual spending growth resumed in 2004 but only lasted two years. The Great Recession, which started in 2007, sent magazine advertising plummeting to the lowest level in decades, drastically shrinking the revenues and profitability of the magazine industry. Since 2009, after the Great Recession, spending continued to fall every year, reaching less than $ 20 per person annually by 2018, a 59% decrease from 2009.

Pivotal Research Group projects that total advertising spending will continue to grow. As the economy continues to grow, it typically would encourage advertising spending, which would bode well for magazines and volume for the Postal Service, as the mail remains the primary distribution channel. The Internet, however, has absorbed a growing share of total advertising spending, leaving sharply smaller budgets for periodicals. With the Internet providing a more convenient and cheaper alternative channel for information, and entertainment, periodical are expected to continue declining, regardless of the state of the economy.

Figure 6.2:
Real Per-Capita Magazine Advertising Spending, 1990-2018



Source: Pivotal Research Group, U.S. Census Bureau.

Household Periodicals Volume

As shown in Table E.2 of the Executive Summary, periodicals represent 3.6 percent of all household mail volumes. Table E.2 also shows that the volume of periodicals declined 10 percent compared to 2017. In FY

2018, households received 4.4 billion periodicals, compared to 4.9 billion in FY 2017.

Table 6.1 shows the breakdown of periodicals received by households. Seventy-three percent of all periodicals received by households were magazines. In contrast, in 1987, the share of magazines was only 59 percent.

In 2018, households received an average of 25 magazines annually. The most common type of magazine was monthly, accounting for 67 percent of total magazines. Newspapers made up 16 percent of total periodicals volume, down from a share of 35 percent in 1987. The number of newspapers received per household each year declined from 31 in 1987 to only 6 in 2018, while magazines declined from 52 to 25 pieces annually.

The decline in newspapers captured in the Household Diary Study mirrors the behavior seen in overall newspaper circulation.

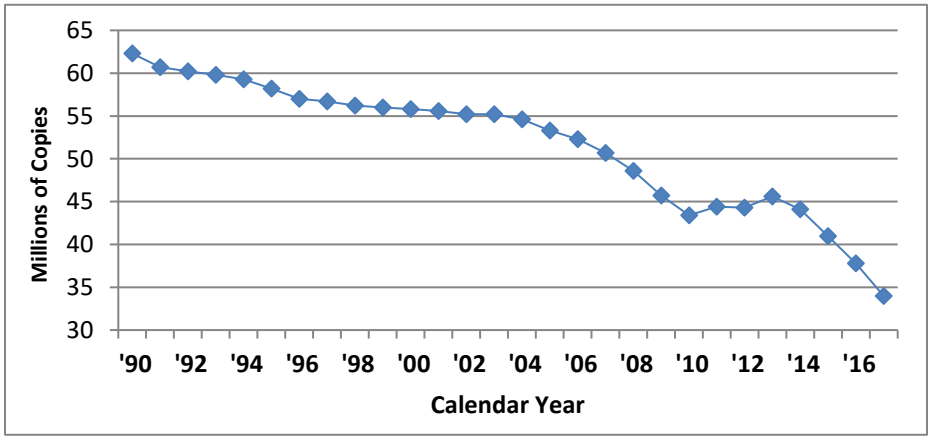
As shown in Figure 6.3, newspaper circulation in general has declined 45% since 1990. Of course, on a per capita basis, the decline is even more pronounced.

Table 6.1:
Periodical Type by Year
(Pieces per Household per year)

Periodical Type	1987	2016	2017	2018
Magazines	**52**	**30**	**28**	**26**
Weekly	16	6	5	4
Monthly	31	19	19	17
Other	5	5	5	4
Newspapers	**31**	**6**	**7**	**6**
Daily	10	2	3	2
Weekly	16	3	4	3
Other	5	1	1	1
Newsletters	3	**2**	**2**	**3**
Unclassified	2	**2**	**1**	**1**
Total Periodicals	**88**	**41**	**39**	**35**

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 1987, 2016, 2017 and 2018.
Note: Totals may not sum due to rounding.

Figure 6.3:
Newspaper Circulation, 1990-2017*



Source: Newspaper Association of America.
Data only available through 2017.

Declining newspaper circulation is not the only contributor to falling newspapers volumes received via mail. With current technology and alternate delivery systems, national newspapers, such as the *Wall Street Journal* and *The New York Times*, deliver their papers to prime urban and suburban household customers before breakfast. Local printing/ distribution and morning delivery mean these copies of these publications no longer move through the mail.

Periodicals Mail and Household Characteristics

Income, Education, and Age

Table 6.2 shows that as income and education increase, periodicals volume tends to increase. Households in which the head of the household has a college education receive the most periodicals, averaging 0.7 per week. Similarly, households with an income above $100,000 receive an average of 0.9 periodicals per week, over twice what households earning less than $35,000 receive.

Households with incomes above $100,000 receive over twice as many periodicals as households earning less than $35,000.

Table 6.3 shows periodicals volume by age and income. The higher the income and age of the household, the higher the volume of periodicals received. For households whose heads are under 34 years old and with incomes less than $35,000, the average is only 0.2 pieces per week. Households with income above $100,000 and whose heads are over 55 receive the most periodicals, with 1.3 pieces per week.

Table 6.2:
Periodicals by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Educational Attainment of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.2	0.5	0.4	0.4	0.4
$35 to $65	0.4	0.7	0.6	0.6	0.6
$65 to $100	0.5	0.8	0.7	0.7	0.7
Over $100	0.2	0.8	0.8	1.0	0.9
Average	0.3	0.7	0.6	0.7	0.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 6.3:
Periodicals by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 34	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.2	0.3	0.6	0.5
$35 to $65	0.2	0.4	0.9	0.7
$65 to $100	0.3	0.5	1.1	0.7
Over $100	0.5	0.7	1.3	1.2
Average	0.3	0.5	0.9	0.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Household Size

Table 6.4 and Table 6.5 show that as households increase in size from one to two persons, periodicals volume almost doubles. Households with more than two persons on average receive about the same number of periodicals as one-person households. In households with two adults, periodicals volume is twice as high as in one-person households. The presence of additional adults beyond two almost doubles the number of periodicals received.

Table 6.4:
Periodicals by Size of Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	
One person	0.5
Two	0.9
Three	0.6
Four	0.6
Five or more	0.6
Average	0.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 6.5:
Periodicals by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	
One	0.4
Two	0.8
Three or more	0.7
Average	0.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Internet Access

As shown in Table 6.6, wired households received slightly more periodicals through the mail, largely due to the typically higher income of those households. In general, however, households' access to Broadband tend to receive most periodical content electronically, rather than by mail. The now widespread adoptions of e-readers likely contributed further to the reduction in the number of periodicals moving through the mail.

Table 6.6:
Periodicals by Type of Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

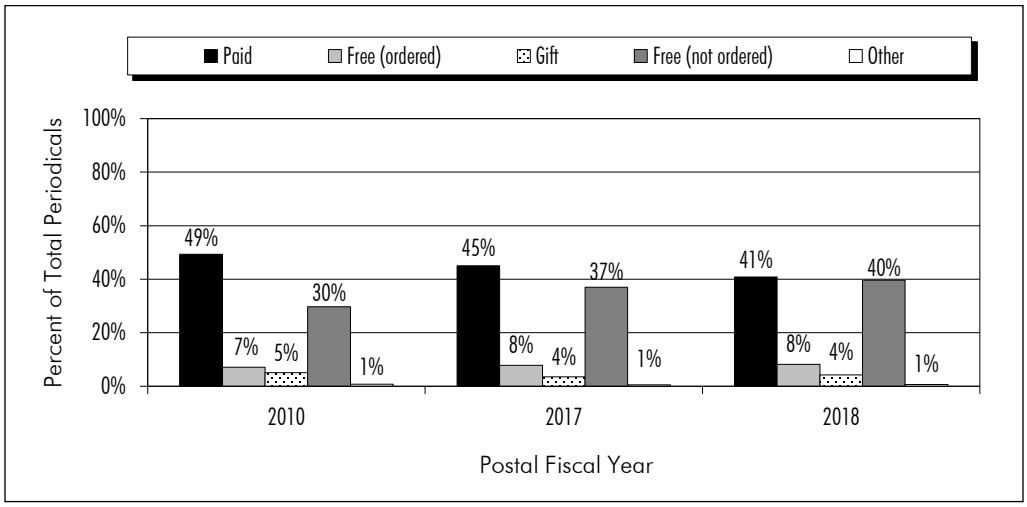
Type of Internet Access	
Broadband	0.7
Dial-up	0.7
None	0.6
Others	0.5
Average	0.7

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Subscription Type

Figure 6.5 provides an overview of subscription types for FY 2010, FY 2017, and FY 2018. As shown, the distribution of subscription types has remained relatively stable over the last two years and similar to the 2010 distribution. In 2018, a household member ordered and paid for 41 percent of total periodicals sent to households. An additional 48 percent were free—either ordered by a household member or delivered to the household without a freestanding order, for example, as a prerogative of membership in a professional, fraternal, or religious organization.

Figure 6.5:
Subscription Type by Year



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2010, 2017, and 2018.
Note: Percentages do not add to 100 due to the exclusion of periodicals not classified by subscription type.

Examining periodical volumes by sender type shows that commercial organizations sent by far more than any individual member organization (79%). Member organizations are professional affiliations; charitable, religious, and veterans' organizations, educational groups, and unions. As shown in Table 6.7, member organizations, when combined, account for 20 percent of total periodicals received by households.

Table 6.7:
Periodicals by Sender Type

Sender Type	Annual Pieces per Household	Percent of Periodicals Received by HH
Commercial Organization	27.3	79%
Professional Organization	2.9	8%
Religious Organization	1.5	4%
Educational Organization	1.3	4%
Union	0.6	2%
Charitable Organization	0.4	1%
Veterans' Organization	0.4	1%
Unclassified	0.3	1%
Total	**34.7**	**100%**

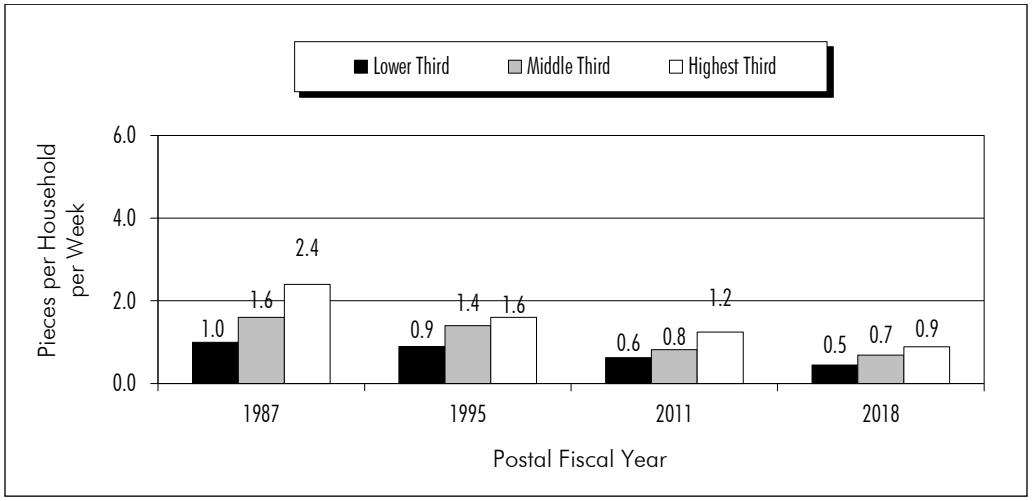
Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Volume Drivers

A number of factors influence a household's receipt of periodicals. Several of these variables are demographic, while others are more behavioral in nature. Income seems to influence volume strongly, since periodicals are usually received through a paid subscription.

Typically, higher-income households subscribe to more magazines and newspapers. In 2018, the number of periodicals per household maintained a distribution across income categories that was similar to prior periods, since 1987 (Figure 6.6).

Figure 6.6:
Number of Periodicals Received per Week by Households by Income Group



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 1987, 1995, 2011, and 2018.

Chapter 7: Packages

Introduction

This chapter discusses packages sent and received by households. Packages can be mailed via the U.S. Postal Service at a variety of rates; for example, packages can be sent as Priority Mail, First-Class Mail, Media Mail, or Standard Post; documents are usually sent as First-Class Mail, Priority Mail, or Express Mail, while product samples are generally sent as Marketing Mail.

The Package Market

The package delivery market is an important segment of the economy. There are three major segments of the package market:

- Overnight air,
- Two- and three-day air, and
- Ground.

The U.S. Postal Service is a major player in the two- and three-day air segment but provides services in all: Priority Mail Express in the overnight segment, Priority and First-Class Mail in the two- and three-day segment, and Parcel Select and Package Services in the ground segment.

Postal Service Package Volume

Compared to other mail, like letters and flats, the number of packages captured in the Household Diary Study is small, as most people do not receive packages on a regular basis. The interpretation of the results should be conducted with this in mind.

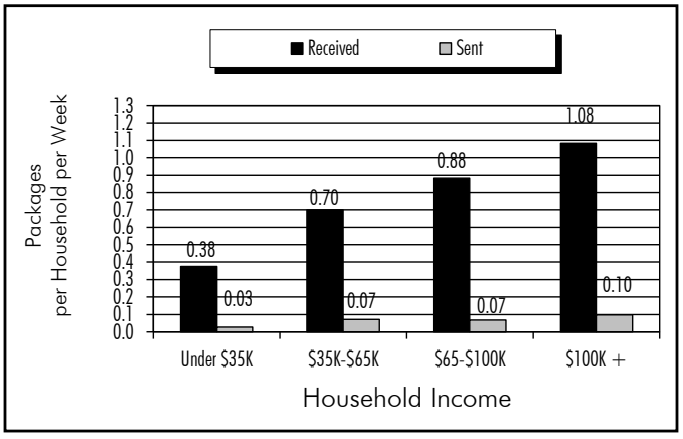
Packages and Household Characteristics

Income, Education, and Age

According to the HDS, high-income households received more packages than their less affluent counterparts in FY 2018, as shown in Figure 7.1.

In fact, households in the highest income bracket received more than twice as many packages as were received by households with incomes below $35,000. The age of the heads of household was another factor influencing the number of packages received. As shown in Table 7.1, heads of household in the mid age range (35 to 54 years old) received more packages than both the younger and older age groups. This may be the case because heads of household in the 35 to 54 age group typically have more disposable income. When it comes to sending packages, Table 7.2 shows that those in the over 55 years old range sent more packages than other age groups. Within each income category, however, the age of heads of households did not show a consistent relationship with the number of packages sent or received.

Figure 7.1:
Postal Service Sent and Received Packages by Household Income
(Pieces per Household per Week)



Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.
Base: Packages Sent and Received by Households and Delivered by U.S. Postal Service.

Table 7.1:
Postal Service Received Packages by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of Head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.38	0.37	0.38	0.38
$35 to $65	0.66	0.74	0.69	0.70
$65 to $100	0.80	0.98	0.85	0.89
Over $100	1.21	1.09	1.01	1.08
Average	0.73	0.84	0.71	0.76

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 7.2:
Postal Service Sent Packages by Income and Age
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Age of head of Household			Average
	Under 35	35 to 54	Over 55	
Under $35	0.05	0.01	0.03	0.03
$35 to $65	0.01	0.05	0.11	0.07
$65 to $100	0.06	0.06	0.08	0.07
Over $100	0.08	0.11	0.09	0.10
Average	0.05	0.06	0.07	0.06

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

The Household Diary Study indicates that households whose heads have college degrees tend to receive and send more packages on average than households with lower educational attainment. These results are shown in Tables 7.3 and 7.4.

Table 7.3:
Postal Service Received Packages by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Education of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.23	0.36	0.46	0.43	0.38
$35 to $65	0.87	0.57	0.73	0.75	0.70
$65 to $100	0.42	0.76	0.96	0.95	0.88
Over $100	0.66	0.91	1.21	1.11	1.08
Average	0.45	0.58	0.77	0.92	0.76

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 7.4:
Postal Service Sent Packages by Income and Education
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Income *(Thousands)*	Education of Head of Household				Average
	Less than High School	High School Graduate	Some College or Technical School	College Graduate	
Under $35	0.00	0.02	0.05	0.04	0.03
$35 to $65	0.09	0.12	0.02	0.05	0.07
$65 to $100	0.00	0.06	0.09	0.07	0.07
Over $100	0.00	0.06	0.08	0.11	0.10
Average	0.02	0.06	0.05	0.08	0.06

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Household Size

The Household Diary Study shows that larger households and those with more adults tend to receive and, in most cases, send more packages than smaller households, as shown in Table 7.5 and 7.6.

Table 7.5:
Postal Service Received and Sent Packages
by Size of Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Household Size	Received	Sent
One person	0.50	0.05
Two	0.76	0.07
Three	0.74	0.05
Four	1.06	0.04
Five or more	1.00	0.15
Average	0.76	0.06

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 7.6:
Postal Service Received and Sent Packages
by Number of Adults in Household
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Number of Adults	Received	Sent
One	0.50	0.04
Two	0.84	0.06
Three or more	0.90	0.10
Average	0.76	0.06

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Internet Access

Access to the Internet seems to play an important part in determining the number of packages received by households. Table 7.7 shows the number of packages sent and received by households with and without Internet access. In FY 2018, households with Broadband access received and sent more than twice as many packages as households without Internet access. This relationship reflects the correlation between Internet access, higher income, and higher education households. Access to online shopping is also very important, as it generates more packages sent and received.

In FY 2018, households with Internet access received and sent more than twice as many packages as households without Internet access.

Table 7.7:
Received and Sent Packages
by Household Internet Access
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Type of Internet Access	Received	Sent
Broadband	0.81	0.07
Dial-up	0.36	0.00
None	0.28	0.02
Others	0.48	0.84
Average	0.76	0.06

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Table 7.8 shows the impact that households' online shopping activity has on the volume of packages they send and receive; survey findings show that the difference can be quite significant. On average, online-shopping households sent more than four times and received more than double the number of packages sent and received by not-online shoppers.

Table 7.8:
Received and Sent Packages
by Household Online Shopping Behavior
(Pieces per Household per Week)

Shopping Online?	Received	Sent
YES	0.85	0.09
NO	0.27	0.02

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2018.

Household Package Contents

As shown in Table 7.9, packages received by households most often contain clothing, pharmaceuticals, household products, and books —a sign that online purchases and mail-order retail are the primary drivers of household package volume..

Households also send more music, videos and clothes, than other types of content. This is primarily due to the high volume of household packages sent during the holiday season; however, this may also be evidence of the growing use of online sales and auction portals, such as eBay.

Table 7.9:
Contents of Postal Service Sent and Received Packages

Contents	Volume (Millions of Pieces)					
	2016		2017		2018	
	Sent	Received	Sent	Received	Sent	Received
Clothing/Footwear/Shoes	113	1,067	96	1,150	141	1,301
Health/Medical/Dental/Vision products	18	606	22	617	9	662
Household/Kitchen/Lawn and garden products	11	461	9	567	18	582
Book(s)	48	425	18	406	24	463
Cosmetics/Beauty products/Toiletries	1	268	7	360	7	327
Music/Video	179	352	190	330	138	287
Electronic equipment	26	214	17	250	17	285
Toys	14	227	9	176	15	218
Food Products	0	175	0	159	4	190
Computer hardware, software, or accessories	17	137	16	164	9	141
Photos/Film	1	36	2	59	1	62
Travel products or information	14	56	2	65	6	60
Checkbooks	0	18	0	32	0	25
Other Contents	75	960	49	931	57	973
Total Packages	494	4,373	432	4,678	425	5,042

Table 7.9:
Contents of Postal Service Sent and Received Packages (cont.)

Contents	Percent of Pieces					
	2016		2017		2018	
	Sent	Received	Sent	Received	Sent	Received
Clothing/Footwear/Shoes	23%	24%	22%	25%	33%	26%
Health/Medical/Dental/Vision products	4%	14%	5%	13%	2%	13%
Household/Kitchen/Lawn and garden products	2%	11%	2%	12%	4%	12%
Book(s)	10%	10%	4%	9%	6%	9%
Cosmetics/Beauty products/Toiletries	0%	6%	2%	8%	2%	6%
Music/Video	36%	8%	44%	7%	33%	6%
Electronic equipment	5%	5%	4%	5%	4%	6%
Toys	3%	5%	2%	4%	4%	4%
Food Products	0%	4%	0%	3%	1%	4%
Computer hardware, software, or accessories	3%	3%	4%	4%	2%	3%
Photos/Film	0%	1%	1%	1%	0%	1%
Travel products or information	3%	1%	0%	1%	1%	1%
Checkbooks	0%	0%	0%	1%	0%	1%
Other Contents	15%	22%	11%	20%	13%	19%
Total Packages	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Source: HDS Diary Sample, FY 2016, 2017, and 2018.
Notes:
Contents questions are multiple response; as such, total packages does not equal the sum for each column.
Does not include contents for which no answer was given (DK/RF).
Music/Video packages include 0.4 billion pieces of CD/DVDs sent and received, reported in First-Class Mail letters in Tables E.1, 1.5, and 1.6

Appendix A: Annual Trends

Table A8-1
First Class Mail Received by Type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2000 - 2018 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
Correspondence																			
Personal	7,211	7,456	7,154	6,457	6,561	5,870	6,079	5,610	5,646	5,225	4,855	4,301	4,266	3,895	3,603	3,249	3,157	3,141	3,061
Greeting Cards	4,052	4,472	4,456	3,816	4,014	3,586	3,935	3,571	3,652	3,368	3,278	3,083	3,069	2,767	2,562	2,251	2,243	2,269	2,320
Letter from Friend or Relative	1,769	1,839	1,629	1,467	1,385	1,227	1,138	1,116	1,046	956	837	701	693	652	592	588	493	516	436
Other Personal	1,391	1,145	1,070	1,174	1,161	1,057	1,006	923	948	901	740	517	505	477	449	410	421	356	305
Business/Government	9,678	10,501	11,081	10,530	10,552	10,965	10,142	10,631	10,061	9,504	9,234	10,596	10,691	10,251	10,644	10,650	10,889	10,881	10,735
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	4,336	5,052	5,546	6,608	6,901	6,640	5,969	6,340	5,693	4,493	4,297	4,403	4,748	4,518	4,905	5,116	5,051	5,055	4,767
Tax-Related (Docs, information, forms)	0	0	0	0	0	354	383	513	570	613	526	1,001	991	998	1,062	983	1,174	1,095	1,156
Insurance	1,159	1,241	1,390	1,291	1,330	1,438	1,410	1,154	1,156	1,430	1,450	2,498	2,308	2,326	2,468	2,283	2,221	2,337	2,369
Other Bus/Gov	4,183	4,208	4,145	2,631	2,321	2,532	2,380	2,624	2,642	2,969	2,961	2,695	2,644	2,409	2,209	2,268	2,442	2,394	2,442
Social	2,581	2,570	2,664	2,692	2,336	2,387	2,274	2,579	2,380	2,066	1,905	1,384	1,355	1,350	1,161	1,105	1,098	1,013	979
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	1,674	1,753	2,084	2,446	2,049	1,866	1,793	2,232	1,674	1,382	1,351	752	773	723	645	608	535	487	512
Other Social	907	817	580	247	287	520	481	348	706	683	554	632	582	627	516	497	563	526	467
Total	19,470	20,527	20,899	19,680	19,449	19,222	18,495	18,820	18,087	16,795	15,995	16,281	16,311	15,497	15,408	15,004	15,144	15,036	14,775
Transactions																			
Bills	12,465	13,035	13,586	13,732	13,708	13,561	13,367	13,222	13,148	12,429	11,274	11,347	10,824	10,815	10,412	10,219	9,852	9,124	8,761
Financial Statements	5,780	7,205	6,492	6,109	6,152	6,272	6,643	6,809	6,294	6,387	5,418	4,655	4,744	4,285	4,514	4,204	3,994	4,056	3,931
Credit Card Statement/Bill	2,948	4,423	4,279	4,304	3,924	4,311	4,969	4,980	4,830	4,687	4,091	3,834	4,023	3,454	3,690	3,623	3,742	3,518	3,765
Request for donation	947	875	797	729	634	636	708	733	754	617	660	755	687	652	609	596	524	501	547
Payment/Check/Credit	1,481	1,679	1,635	1,618	1,552	1,437	1,439	1,418	1,324	1,378	1,194	1,009	993	1,055	998	1,039	895	896	740
Other	893	540	605	504	512	588	544	752	778	677	626	1,307	1,230	1,252	1,131	1,200	1,276	1,140	1,152
Total	24,514	27,758	27,393	26,997	26,483	26,805	27,669	27,914	27,128	26,175	23,263	22,906	22,501	21,512	21,355	20,881	20,283	19,236	18,896
Advertising (Ads Only)	9,471	11,153	11,045	10,221	9,259	10,782	10,344	9,034	8,257	6,648	6,115	5,448	5,021	4,240	3,925	3,593	3,826	3,713	3,504
CD/DVD/Video Games [1]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	640	806	937	942	1,040	543	466	374	312	217	212	170
DK/RF [2]	3,350	1,073	1,192	1,972	2,080	1,974	2,915	2,449	2,971	2,569	3,748	2,598	2,828	2,426	1,768	1,610	1,811	1,637	1,613
Total First-Class Received	56,805	60,512	60,529	58,869	57,270	58,783	59,423	58,856	57,250	53,123	50,063	48,272	47,204	44,142	42,830	41,400	41,280	39,833	38,958

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

Note: Transaction and Correspondence definitions redefined to match calculation in HDS main report.

[1] CD/DVD/Video Games not collected as a separate category prior to 2007.

[2] Combination of Correspondence and Transactions (Purpose is unknown)

Table A8-2
Shares of First Class Mail Received by Type
Years 2000 - 2018 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
Correspondence																			
Personal	13%	12%	12%	11%	11%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%	9%	9%	9%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%
Greeting Cards	7%	7%	7%	6%	7%	6%	7%	6%	6%	6%	7%	6%	7%	6%	6%	5%	5%	6%	6%
Letter from Friend or Relative	3%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Other Personal	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Business/Government	17%	17%	18%	18%	18%	19%	17%	18%	18%	18%	18%	22%	23%	23%	25%	26%	26%	27%	28%
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	8%	8%	9%	11%	12%	11%	10%	11%	10%	8%	9%	9%	10%	10%	11%	12%	12%	13%	12%
Tax-Related (Docs, information, forms)	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	3%	3%
Insurance	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	3%	5%	5%	5%	6%	6%	5%	6%	6%
Other Bus/Gov	7%	7%	7%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	5%	6%	6%	6%	6%	5%	5%	5%	6%	6%	6%
Social	5%	4%	4%	5%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%
Notice/ Announcement/ Business Invitation	3%	3%	3%	4%	4%	3%	3%	4%	3%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Other Social	2%	1%	1%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total	34%	34%	35%	33%	34%	33%	31%	32%	32%	32%	32%	34%	35%	35%	36%	36%	37%	38%	38%
Transactions																			
Bills	22%	22%	22%	23%	24%	23%	22%	22%	23%	23%	23%	24%	23%	24%	24%	25%	24%	23%	22%
Financial Statements	10%	12%	11%	10%	11%	11%	11%	12%	11%	12%	11%	10%	10%	10%	11%	10%	10%	10%	10%
Credit Card Statement/Bill	5%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	8%	8%	8%	9%	8%	8%	9%	8%	9%	9%	9%	9%	10%
Request for donation	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Payment/Check/Credit	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%
Other	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%
Total	43%	46%	45%	46%	46%	46%	47%	47%	47%	49%	46%	47%	48%	49%	50%	50%	49%	48%	49%
Advertising (Ads Only)	17%	18%	18%	17%	16%	18%	17%	15%	14%	13%	12%	11%	11%	10%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%
CD/DVD/Video Games[1]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	0%
DK/RF[2]	6%	2%	2%	3%	4%	3%	5%	4%	5%	5%	7%	5%	6%	5%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%
Total First-Class Received	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Transaction and Correspondence definitions redefined to match calculation in HDS main report.

[1] CD/DVD/Video Games not collected as a separate category prior to 2007.

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

Table A8-3
First Class Mail Sent by type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2000 - 2018 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
Correspondence																			
Personal	6,680	7,135	7,154	6,457	6,561	5,870	6,232	5,811	5,646	5,225	4,234	3,547	3,631	3,647	3,160	3,274	2,810	2,475	2,540
Greeting Cards	3,818	4,561	4,223	3,958	4,332	4,010	4,294	3,887	3,648	3,496	2,834	2,572	2,705	2,652	2,261	2,263	2,138	1,819	1,850
Letter to Friend or Relative	1,915	1,740	1,974	1,561	1,513	1,071	1,240	1,250	1,021	1,120	798	636	667	675	561	678	461	410	468
Other Personal	947	833	957	938	715	789	699	675	978	609	602	340	259	320	338	332	211	246	221
Business/Government	2,317	2,081	2,218	1,700	1,747	1,744	1,652	1,679	1,600	1,550	1,094	1,209	1,195	1,106	1,067	1,185	1,080	965	771
Social	515	387	368	351	420	375	382	453	483	361	263	209	183	163	176	148	157	121	130
Total	9,512	9,603	9,740	8,508	8,728	7,989	8,266	7,944	7,729	7,136	5,591	4,965	5,009	4,916	4,403	4,607	4,047	3,561	3,441
Transactions																			
Bill Payment[2]	8,037	9,697	9,705	10,104	9,801	8,970	8,734	8,365	6,995	6,494	5,632	5,517	5,098	4,513	4,470	4,383	3,753	3,347	3,100
Orders/Rebate request	853	734	774	739	734	769	612	560	537	454	279	359	321	247	249	224	189	189	157
Donations	578	572	574	536	598	560	524	550	657	521	345	355	391	330	332	288	286	260	251
Total	9,468	11,002	11,054	11,379	11,133	10,300	9,869	9,475	8,189	7,469	6,257	6,231	5,810	5,089	5,051	4,894	4,228	3,796	3,508
CD/DVD/Video Games[1]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	540	774	932	700	758	380	360	318	218	174	168	130
DK/RF[3]	361	211	241	171	167	234	253	426	395	251	208	112	134	126	119	139	143	118	189
Total First-Class Sent	19,341	20,816	21,035	20,057	20,029	18,523	18,387	18,384	17,087	15,788	12,755	12,066	11,333	10,492	9,891	9,859	8,592	7,643	7,268

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

[1] CD/DVD/Video Games not collected as a separate category prior to 2007.

[2] Payments were restated 2000-2009

[3] Combination of Correspondence and Transactions (Purpose is unknown)

Table A8-4
Shares of First Class Mail Sent by type
Years 2000 - 2018 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
Correspondence																			
Personal	35%	34%	34%	32%	33%	32%	34%	32%	33%	33%	33%	29%	32%	35%	32%	33%	33%	32%	35%
Greeting Cards	20%	22%	20%	20%	22%	22%	23%	21%	21%	22%	22%	21%	24%	25%	23%	23%	25%	24%	25%
Letter to Friend or Relative	10%	8%	9%	8%	8%	6%	7%	7%	6%	7%	6%	5%	6%	6%	6%	7%	5%	5%	6%
Other Personal	5%	4%	5%	5%	4%	4%	4%	4%	6%	4%	5%	3%	2%	3%	3%	3%	2%	3%	3%
Business/Government	12%	10%	11%	8%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	10%	9%	10%	11%	11%	11%	12%	13%	13%	11%
Social	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Total	49%	46%	46%	42%	44%	43%	45%	43%	45%	45%	44%	41%	44%	47%	45%	47%	47%	47%	47%
Transactions																			
Bill Payment[2]	42%	47%	46%	50%	49%	48%	47%	46%	41%	41%	44%	46%	45%	43%	45%	44%	44%	44%	43%
Orders	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	2%	3%	3%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Donations	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%
Total	49%	53%	53%	57%	56%	56%	54%	52%	48%	47%	49%	52%	51%	49%	51%	50%	49%	50%	48%
CD/DVD/Video Games[1]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	3%	5%	6%	5%	6%	3%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%
DK/RF	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	2%	3%
Total First-Class Sent	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

[1] CD/DVD/Video Games not collected as a separate category prior to 2007.

[2] Payments were restated 2000-2009

Table A8-5a
Bills and Statements Received
Pieces in Millions by Sender Type
Years 2000 - 2018 (Diary Data)

Payee	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
Financial																			
Credit Card	2,916	3,803	3,664	3,791	3,601	4,007	3,838	3,601	3,619	4,687	4,091	3,834	4,023	3,454	3,690	3,623	3,742	3,536	3,760
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	4,182	4,931	4,973	4,724	4,829	4,941	5,406	5,463	4,933	4,951	4,216	3,703	3,517	3,474	3,531	3,264	3,015	2,963	2,821
Insurance Company[1]	1,181	1,202	1,469	1,359	1,299	1,353	1,464	1,703	1,701	1,602	1,368	1,668	1,661	1,725	1,719	1,740	1,667	1,706	1,498
Real Estate/Mortgage	281	396	383	430	416	498	437	494	433	428	376	317	313	390	374	318	397	357	342
Other Financial	2,010	2,354	1,955	1,592	1,746	1,686	1,852	1,968	1,842	1,774	1,578	1,543	1,654	1,331	1,401	1,426	1,353	1,282	1,253
Total Financial	10,570	12,686	12,444	11,897	11,890	12,486	12,996	13,228	12,529	13,442	11,628	11,064	11,168	10,376	10,716	10,370	10,175	9,844	9,674
Merchants																			
Department Store	736	783	766	709	707	659	756	792	980	161	129	32	63	59	54	49	38	62	34
Publisher	629	609	578	533	499	553	490	489	409	387	300	327	290	275	202	210	158	147	163
Mail Order Company	385	352	292	223	284	159	200	216	157	137	139	101	88	71	77	94	65	49	34
Other Merchants	458	484	468	517	544	525	555	591	620	370	221	163	171	164	148	136	164	142	164
Total Merchants	2,207	2,229	2,103	1,981	2,035	1,895	2,001	2,086	2,166	1,055	790	623	612	569	482	488	424	399	395
Services																			
Telephone /Cable Company	2,701	3,189	3,278	3,505	3,291	3,260	3,318	3,016	2,967	2,670	2,287	2,436	2,367	2,134	2,050	1,821	1,730	1,637	1,493
Utility Company	2,031	2,494	2,555	2,618	2,702	2,602	2,566	2,657	2,730	2,591	2,444	2,494	2,329	2,416	2,304	2,433	2,335	2,387	2,268
Medical and Other Professional	1,900	2,023	2,014	2,221	2,099	2,079	2,200	2,224	2,108	2,269	2,299	2,069	1,936	1,947	2,026	1,846	1,953	1,576	1,692
Other Service	672	656	647	620	525	594	554	479	512	456	393	404	402	387	352	369	376	310	372
Total Service	7,304	8,362	8,494	8,965	8,617	8,534	8,637	8,376	8,317	7,986	7,423	7,403	7,035	6,884	6,731	6,469	6,395	5,911	5,826
Manufacturers	89	99	103	102	87	81	128	156	183	64	59	51	26	21	47	46	27	26	18
Government	604	978	835	920	838	872	907	844	793	718	671	501	530	520	470	493	386	389	401
Social	248	225	271	195	190	190	228	202	193	184	173	159	191	159	127	136	149	100	113
Other/Don't Know/Refused	171	84	108	86	128	86	80	120	91	54	38	35	29	25	45	43	32	29	31
Total – All Industries	21,194	24,664	24,357	24,146	23,785	24,144	24,978	25,011	24,272	23,503	20,783	19,836	19,591	18,554	18,617	18,046	17,589	16,698	16,457

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

Table A8-6
Shares of Bills Paid by Method
Years 2000 - 2018 (Recruitment Data)

Method	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
Mail	81%	80%	75%	74%	69%	67%	62%	60%	54%	50%	47%	44%	40%	37%	34%	31%	27%	30%	27%
Internet using a Computer	2%	4%	4%	7%	10%	12%	15%	18%	25%	28%	29%	31%	31%	33%	35%	34%	34%	31%	31%
Internet using Mobile Phone	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	2%	2%	3%	4%	7%	8%	10%
Internet using Other Device	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	1%	2%	3%	6%	5%	3%	3%
Auto Deduction from Bank	8%	8%	9%	9%	10%	11%	11%	11%	11%	12%	13%	13%	14%	14%	14%	14%	15%	15%	15%
In Person	8%	7%	8%	7%	6%	6%	6%	5%	6%	5%	5%	5%	5%	5%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%
Credit Card	N/A	N/A	2%	2%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	4%	4%	4%	5%	5%	6%
Telephone	1%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	4%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Total Electronic [1]	11%	13%	17%	20%	25%	28%	32%	35%	41%	45%	48%	51%	55%	58%	62%	65%	69%	66%	69%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

[1] Includes bills paid by Internet, Auto Deduction from Bank Account, Credit Card, and Telephone

Table A8-7
Shares of Households using Method of Paying Bills
Years 2000 - 2018 (Recruitment Data)

Method	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
Mail	95%	94%	95%	95%	95%	94%	92%	93%	89%	87%	84%	79%	78%	74%	71%	69%	68%	63%	59%
Internet using a Computer	4%	8%	12%	16%	23%	28%	33%	37%	43%	48%	51%	54%	54%	59%	61%	60%	62%	56%	55%
Internet using Mobile Phone	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	7%	11%	11%	15%	22%	22%	26%
Internet using Other Device	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	2%	5%	7%	12%	12%	8%	8%
Auto Deduction from Bank Account	34%	35%	43%	45%	51%	54%	53%	56%	49%	48%	52%	50%	55%	55%	54%	54%	61%	52%	54%
In Person	33%	29%	33%	34%	32%	31%	35%	31%	30%	26%	29%	28%	31%	27%	24%	24%	25%	22%	23%
Credit Card	N/A	N/A	15%	17%	19%	22%	24%	23%	19%	16%	19%	18%	21%	22%	20%	21%	27%	23%	25%
Telephone	4%	7%	9%	10%	11%	14%	15%	13%	12%	12%	13%	16%	18%	18%	16%	17%	19%	18%	18%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

Table A8-8
Type of Payments made by Mail
Pieces in Millions by Payee Type
Years 2000 - 2018 (Diary Data)

Payee	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
Financial																			
Credit Card	1,811	2,085	2,072	2,222	2,094	1,910	1,791	1,654	1,484	1,306	1,185	1,111	1,085	861	889	871	791	719	674
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	534	674	718	718	677	692	579	621	516	441	399	376	333	236	271	319	257	180	198
Insurance Company	608	650	735	713	762	668	687	645	552	549	486	478	407	389	410	383	343	304	291
Real Estate/Mortgage	261	286	285	293	334	330	313	302	219	225	228	219	168	182	157	175	129	153	98
Other Financial	119	112	81	94	50	65	79	78	72	42	37	26	27	36	31	35	43	26	18
Total Financial	3,334	3,807	3,892	4,041	3,916	3,666	3,449	3,301	2,843	2,564	2,336	2,210	2,020	1,704	1,758	1,783	1,562	1,382	1,280
Merchants																			
Department Store	341	330	395	344	312	359	289	269	276	120	105	66	67	57	59	59	55	51	12
Publisher	355	354	382	353	328	267	286	238	241	204	151	157	159	179	112	104	83	72	68
Mail Order Company	212	240	206	183	170	149	178	124	95	86	82	52	50	52	52	47	53	47	35
Other Merchants	169	184	151	167	154	136	184	176	156	130	91	95	115	75	90	56	62	60	55
Total Merchants	1,077	1,108	1,134	1,047	964	911	937	806	768	540	429	369	391	362	313	266	253	230	170
Services																			
Telephone /Cable Company	1,400	1,828	1,780	2,023	1,846	1,633	1,670	1,499	1,046	1,036	880	884	777	653	593	544	470	402	393
Utility Company	1,020	1,444	1,357	1,453	1,591	1,363	1,324	1,317	1,057	1,140	952	920	912	818	780	785	633	628	539
Medical and Other Professional	434	559	565	634	660	605	613	675	639	636	543	537	520	476	542	520	421	340	360
Other Service	382	385	375	378	343	329	335	316	255	227	203	247	212	192	189	190	171	156	163
Total Service	3,236	4,216	4,078	4,488	4,440	3,931	3,942	3,807	2,997	3,038	2,577	2,588	2,421	2,139	2,104	2,039	1,695	1,525	1,456
Manufacturers	17	41	25	51	36	28	21	25	30	12	7	9	10	6	8	9	12	10	5
Government	214	315	331	300	328	322	262	333	275	262	238	140	141	122	136	127	116	110	92
Social	98	59	116	61	4	29	24	0	0	0	0	106	71	97	63	65	54	60	55
Other/Don't Know/Refused	59	146	129	116	113	83	99	94	82	77	46	96	45	84	90	93	60	28	43
Total – All Industries	8,037	9,693	9,705	10,104	9,801	8,970	8,734	8,365	6,995	6,494	5,632	5,517	5,098	4,513	4,470	4,383	3,753	3,347	3,100

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

Note: Payments were restated 2000-2009.

Table A8-9
Type of Payments made by Mail
Percent of Bill Payments by Payee Type
Years 2000 - 2018 (Diary Data)

Payee	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
Financial																			
Credit Card	23%	22%	21%	22%	21%	21%	21%	20%	21%	20%	21%	20%	21%	19%	20%	20%	21%	21%	22%
Bank, S&L, Credit Union	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	8%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%	5%	6%	7%	7%	5%	6%
Insurance Company	8%	7%	8%	7%	8%	7%	8%	8%	8%	8%	9%	9%	8%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%
Real Estate/Mortgage	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	4%	4%	3%	3%	4%	4%	3%	4%	4%	4%	3%	5%	3%
Other Financial	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total Financial	41%	39%	40%	40%	40%	41%	39%	39%	41%	39%	41%	40%	40%	38%	39%	41%	42%	41%	41%
Merchants																			
Department Store	4%	3%	4%	3%	3%	4%	3%	3%	4%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	0%
Publisher	4%	4%	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Mail Order Company	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Other Merchants	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%
Total Merchants	13%	11%	12%	10%	10%	10%	11%	10%	11%	8%	8%	7%	8%	8%	7%	6%	7%	7%	5%
Services																			
Telephone /Cable Company	17%	19%	18%	20%	19%	18%	19%	18%	15%	16%	16%	16%	15%	14%	13%	12%	13%	12%	13%
Utility Company	13%	15%	14%	14%	16%	15%	15%	16%	15%	18%	17%	17%	18%	18%	17%	18%	17%	19%	17%
Medical and Other Professional	5%	6%	6%	6%	7%	7%	7%	8%	9%	10%	10%	10%	10%	11%	12%	12%	11%	10%	12%
Other Service	5%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	3%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	4%	5%	5%	5%
Total Service	40%	44%	42%	44%	45%	44%	45%	46%	43%	47%	46%	47%	47%	47%	47%	47%	45%	46%	47%
Manufacturers	0%	0%	0%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Government	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	4%	3%	4%	4%	4%	4%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%	3%
Social	1%	1%	1%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	2%	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	2%	2%
Other/Don't Know/Refused	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%
Total – All Industries	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

Table A8-10
Share of Households by Internet Access type
Years 2000 - 2018 (Recruitment Data)

Type of Access	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
None	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	29%	28%	28%	23%	22%	21%	22%	19%	17%	14%	13%	12%	11%	11%	8%
Total Internet Access	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	71%	72%	72%	77%	78%	79%	78%	81%	83%	86%	87%	88%	89%	89%	92%
Dial-up	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	38%	35%	28%	20%	13%	8%	6%	3%	3%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Cable Modem					14%	16%	20%	25%	27%	30%	34%	38%	41%	44%					
Other Broadband					6%	5%	5%	4%	6%	6%	10%	14%	14%	17%	85%	86%	88%	88%	90%
DSL					10%	13%	18%	26%	30%	31%	25%	23%	23%	20%					
Other/DK/RF					3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	3%	4%	3%	2%	3%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

Note: All types of Broadband services are combined beginning in 2014

Table A8-11
Number of Purchases Made over the Internet over the past month
Percent of Households
Years 2000 - 2018 (Recruitment Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
All Households																			
None	86%	89%	78%	75%	71%	70%	60%	57%	56%	53%	53%	49%	48%	44%	42%	42%	39%	35%	32%
1	6%	4%	8%	9%	10%	11%	9%	9%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%	8%	7%	7%	6%	6%
2	3%	3%	5%	6%	8%	8%	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%	11%	9%	10%	10%	10%	10%	9%	9%
3-5	3%	3%	6%	7%	8%	8%	14%	15%	16%	17%	17%	19%	19%	20%	23%	22%	22%	27%	24%
6-10	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%	3%	5%	6%	6%	7%	8%	8%	10%	10%	11%	12%	13%	15%	18%
More than 10	0%	0%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%	3%	3%	4%	5%	5%	6%	7%	7%	7%	9%	8%	12%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Households that Made 1+ purchases																			
1	42%	36%	37%	38%	36%	35%	23%	20%	19%	18%	16%	15%	16%	15%	13%	12%	12%	9%	8%
2	23%	26%	25%	23%	26%	25%	24%	23%	23%	22%	21%	22%	18%	18%	18%	17%	16%	14%	13%
3-5	24%	28%	26%	26%	28%	27%	35%	35%	36%	37%	36%	37%	36%	37%	39%	38%	37%	42%	35%
6-10	7%	7%	8%	9%	8%	8%	13%	15%	15%	15%	16%	16%	18%	18%	19%	21%	21%	23%	26%
More than 10	3%	3%	3%	4%	3%	4%	5%	7%	8%	9%	10%	10%	12%	12%	11%	12%	14%	13%	18%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

Table A8-12
Advertising Volume
Pieces in Millions
Years 2000 - 2018 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
First-Class Advertising	16,875	19,556	18,797	18,012	16,748	18,631	17,998	16,888	16,445	14,482	12,793	12,710	11,437	9,709	8,987	8,370	8,292	7,802	7,594
Advertising Only	9,471	11,153	11,045	10,221	9,259	10,782	10,344	9,034	8,257	6,648	6,115	5,448	5,021	4,240	3,925	3,593	3,826	3,713	3,504
Secondary Advertising	7,404	8,402	7,752	7,791	7,489	7,849	7,653	7,854	8,187	7,834	6,678	7,262	6,416	5,469	5,062	4,776	4,466	4,089	4,090
Marketing Ads [1]	60,496	72,174	71,088	74,205	78,119	83,498	86,874	83,411	82,994	70,631	72,157	77,043	73,241	73,999	71,513	71,371	71,538	68,890	67,447
Total Ads	77,370	91,729	89,885	92,217	94,867	102,130	104,872	100,299	99,438	85,113	84,950	89,753	84,678	83,709	80,501	79,741	79,830	76,692	75,041
First-Class Ads Share of Total Ads	22%	21%	21%	20%	18%	18%	17%	17%	17%	17%	15%	14%	14%	12%	11%	10%	10%	10%	10%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

Table A8-13A
Advertising Mail By Sender Type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2000 - 2018 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
First-Class Ads [1]																			
Financial	6,633	8,020	8,223	7,615	7,218	8,685	7,948	6,696	6,003	5,418	4,632	4,651	4,231	3,366	3,394	3,378	3,214	3,150	3,174
Merchants	4,753	5,219	4,369	4,225	3,923	4,096	3,956	3,681	3,621	2,438	2,422	2,172	2,186	1,832	1,817	1,594	1,517	1,387	1,395
Services	3,848	4,628	4,704	4,671	4,309	4,368	4,541	4,904	5,134	5,285	4,472	4,767	4,068	3,496	2,931	2,668	2,712	2,579	2,267
Manufacturers	328	418	395	418	408	409	373	469	476	329	262	212	165	190	148	153	202	174	115
Government	262	306	285	283	281	415	427	349	334	307	296	289	219	264	210	138	169	145	161
Social	891	900	723	694	564	599	675	704	695	659	611	587	549	538	458	421	438	343	450
Other	159	64	98	107	44	59	78	84	181	46	98	31	20	24	28	17	41	25	32
Total	16,875	19,556	18,797	18,012	16,748	18,631	17,998	16,888	16,445	14,482	12,793	12,710	11,437	9,709	8,987	8,370	8,292	7,802	7,594
Standard Ads [2]																			
Financial	8,156	12,641	13,397	13,961	16,306	19,367	19,909	17,921	17,502	12,786	14,767	18,401	15,355	15,715	15,363	15,643	17,121	16,525	16,236
Merchants	23,645	29,709	28,707	27,623	27,904	28,896	30,243	29,750	28,690	25,319	24,709	25,086	23,874	22,895	23,145	21,880	21,571	20,692	19,703
Services	6,194	9,099	8,213	8,932	9,082	9,953	9,622	10,944	11,626	10,359	10,705	11,184	10,673	11,605	11,319	11,857	11,886	11,346	10,959
Manufacturers	846	1,220	1,102	1,401	1,399	1,643	1,537	1,529	1,488	1,474	1,464	1,586	1,534	1,600	950	1,238	1,323	1,250	1,028
Government	1,053	1,089	1,192	973	1,166	1,283	1,626	1,408	1,575	1,043	1,042	951	1,064	991	888	920	946	907	1,014
Social	11,911	10,632	10,759	12,722	13,135	13,695	14,198	13,791	13,936	12,347	12,336	12,698	13,469	13,945	12,732	12,629	11,945	11,653	12,216
From Multiple Organizations	4,500	6,149	6,211	7,143	7,365	7,363	8,222	7,067	7,345	6,690	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,103	5,839
Other	4,190	1,634	1,508	1,450	1,763	1,299	1,516	1,002	832	613	649	459	568	656	526	389	563	415	453
Total	60,496	72,174	71,088	74,205	78,119	83,498	86,874	83,411	82,994	70,631	72,157	77,043	73,241	73,999	71,513	71,371	71,538	68,890	67,447
Total Ads																			
Financial	14,789	20,661	21,619	21,576	23,524	28,052	27,857	24,617	23,505	18,204	19,399	23,052	19,586	19,081	18,758	19,021	20,335	19,674	19,410
Merchants	28,398	34,928	33,075	31,848	31,828	32,992	34,199	33,431	32,311	27,757	27,130	27,258	26,060	24,727	24,962	23,474	23,088	22,079	21,098
Services	10,043	13,728	12,917	13,603	13,391	14,321	14,164	15,848	16,761	15,644	15,177	15,952	14,741	15,101	14,250	14,525	14,598	13,925	13,226
Manufacturers	1,174	1,638	1,497	1,819	1,807	2,051	1,909	1,998	1,963	1,803	1,726	1,798	1,699	1,790	1,098	1,391	1,525	1,424	1,143
Government	1,315	1,395	1,477	1,255	1,448	1,698	2,053	1,757	1,909	1,351	1,338	1,241	1,283	1,256	1,098	1,059	1,115	1,052	1,175
Social	12,802	11,532	11,483	13,416	13,698	14,294	14,873	14,495	14,631	13,006	12,947	13,285	14,018	14,482	13,190	13,050	12,383	11,995	12,666
From Multiple Organizations	4,500	6,149	6,211	7,143	7,365	7,363	8,222	7,067	7,345	6,690	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,103	5,839
Other	4,349	1,698	1,606	1,557	1,807	1,358	1,594	1,086	1,013	659	748	491	587	680	554	406	603	439	484
Total	77,370	91,729	89,885	92,217	94,867	102,130	104,872	100,299	99,438	85,113	84,950	89,753	84,678	83,709	80,501	79,741	79,830	76,692	75,041

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

[1] Includes Secondary Advertising

Table A8-13A2
Advertising ONLY (no secondary) Mail By Sender Type
Pieces in Millions
Years 2000 - 2018 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
First-Class Ads [1]																			
Financial	3,450	4,205	4,712	4,188	3,798	4,899	4,468	3,410	2,857	1,902	1,655	1,517	1,411	1,160	1,121	1,163	1,195	1,312	1,222
Merchants	3,608	4,010	3,374	3,219	2,975	3,115	3,058	2,735	2,572	2,056	2,028	1,777	1,703	1,411	1,493	1,222	1,153	1,065	1,103
Services	1,742	2,279	2,336	2,168	1,910	1,998	2,047	2,222	2,090	2,217	1,966	1,601	1,503	1,204	988	951	1,078	1,066	911
Manufacturers	287	358	355	371	377	382	334	382	353	290	245	183	133	150	123	106	183	141	95
Government	113	132	138	123	144	299	323	205	190	156	172	138	64	150	56	26	51	36	39
Social	163	123	57	53	18	42	44	18	19	0	0	215	191	157	134	119	150	87	129
Other	107	46	73	100	35	46	69	63	176	28	48	17	15	8	9	7	17	7	4
Total	9,471	11,153	11,045	10,221	9,259	10,782	10,344	9,034	8,257	6,648	6,115	5,448	5,021	4,240	3,925	3,593	3,826	3,713	3,504
Standard Ads [2]																			
Financial	8,156	12,641	13,397	13,961	16,306	19,367	19,909	17,921	17,502	12,786	14,767	18,401	15,355	15,715	15,363	15,643	17,121	16,525	16,236
Merchants	23,645	29,709	28,707	27,623	27,904	28,896	30,243	29,750	28,690	25,319	24,709	25,086	23,874	22,895	23,145	21,880	21,571	20,692	19,703
Services	6,194	9,099	8,213	8,932	9,082	9,953	9,622	10,944	11,626	10,359	10,705	11,184	10,673	11,605	11,319	11,857	11,886	11,346	10,959
Manufacturers	846	1,220	1,102	1,401	1,399	1,643	1,537	1,529	1,488	1,474	1,464	1,586	1,534	1,600	950	1,238	1,323	1,250	1,028
Government	1,053	1,089	1,192	973	1,166	1,283	1,626	1,408	1,575	1,043	1,042	951	1,064	991	888	920	946	907	1,014
Social	11,911	10,632	10,759	12,722	13,135	13,695	14,198	13,791	13,936	12,347	12,336	12,698	13,469	13,945	12,732	12,629	11,945	11,653	12,216
From Multiple Organizations	4,500	6,149	6,211	7,143	7,365	7,363	8,222	7,067	7,345	6,690	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,103	5,839
Other	4,190	1,634	1,508	1,450	1,763	1,299	1,516	1,002	832	613	649	459	568	656	526	389	563	415	453
Total	60,496	72,174	71,088	74,205	78,119	83,498	86,874	83,411	82,994	70,631	72,157	77,043	73,241	73,999	71,513	71,371	71,538	68,890	67,447
Total Ads																			
Financial	11,606	16,846	18,108	18,149	20,104	24,266	24,377	21,331	20,359	14,688	16,423	19,918	16,766	16,875	16,485	16,805	18,316	17,836	17,458
Merchants	27,253	33,719	32,081	30,842	30,880	32,011	33,301	32,484	31,262	27,375	26,737	26,863	25,577	24,306	24,638	23,102	22,724	21,757	20,806
Services	7,937	11,378	10,549	11,100	10,992	11,951	11,669	13,166	13,716	12,576	12,671	12,785	12,176	12,810	12,307	12,808	12,964	12,412	11,870
Manufacturers	1,133	1,578	1,457	1,772	1,776	2,025	1,871	1,911	1,841	1,764	1,709	1,768	1,668	1,751	1,073	1,344	1,506	1,391	1,123
Government	1,166	1,221	1,331	1,095	1,311	1,582	1,949	1,613	1,765	1,199	1,215	1,089	1,128	1,142	944	947	997	943	1,052
Social	12,074	10,756	10,816	12,775	13,153	13,737	14,243	13,809	13,955	12,347	12,336	12,914	13,660	14,101	12,866	12,748	12,095	11,739	12,345
From Multiple Organizations	4,500	6,149	6,211	7,143	7,365	7,363	8,222	7,067	7,345	6,690	6,484	6,678	6,704	6,591	6,590	6,815	6,183	6,103	5,839
Other	4,297	1,680	1,581	1,550	1,798	1,345	1,585	1,064	1,008	641	698	476	583	664	535	396	579	421	457
Total	69,966	83,327	82,133	84,426	87,378	94,281	97,218	92,445	91,251	77,279	78,272	82,491	78,262	78,239	75,438	74,965	75,364	72,603	70,951

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

[1] Excludes Secondary Advertising

Table A8-14
Advertising Mail By Sender Type
Percent of Pieces
Years 2000 - 2018 (Diary Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
First-Class Ads [1]																			
Financial	39%	41%	44%	42%	43%	47%	44%	40%	37%	37%	36%	37%	37%	35%	38%	40%	39%	40%	42%
Merchants	28%	27%	23%	23%	23%	22%	22%	22%	22%	17%	19%	17%	19%	19%	20%	19%	18%	18%	18%
Services	23%	24%	25%	26%	26%	23%	25%	29%	31%	36%	35%	38%	36%	36%	33%	32%	33%	33%	30%
Manufacturers	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	3%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Government	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	3%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Social	5%	5%	4%	4%	3%	3%	4%	4%	4%	5%	5%	5%	5%	6%	5%	5%	5%	4%	6%
Other	1%	0%	1%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	1%	0%	1%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Standard Ads [2]																			
Financial	13%	18%	19%	19%	21%	23%	23%	21%	21%	18%	20%	24%	21%	21%	21%	22%	24%	24%	24%
Merchants	39%	41%	40%	37%	36%	35%	35%	36%	35%	36%	34%	33%	33%	31%	32%	31%	30%	30%	29%
Services	10%	13%	12%	12%	12%	12%	11%	13%	14%	15%	15%	15%	15%	16%	16%	17%	17%	16%	16%
Manufacturers	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Government	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%
Social	20%	15%	15%	17%	17%	16%	16%	17%	17%	17%	17%	16%	18%	19%	18%	18%	17%	17%	18%
From Multiple Organizations	7%	9%	9%	10%	9%	9%	9%	8%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	9%	10%	9%	9%	9%
Other	7%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%
Total Ads																			
Financial	19%	23%	24%	23%	25%	27%	27%	25%	24%	21%	23%	26%	23%	23%	23%	24%	25%	26%	26%
Merchants	37%	38%	37%	35%	34%	32%	33%	33%	32%	33%	32%	30%	31%	30%	31%	29%	29%	29%	28%
Services	13%	15%	14%	15%	14%	14%	14%	16%	17%	18%	18%	18%	17%	18%	18%	18%	18%	18%	18%
Manufacturers	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%
Government	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	2%
Social	17%	13%	13%	15%	14%	14%	14%	14%	15%	15%	15%	15%	17%	17%	16%	16%	16%	16%	17%
From Multiple Organizations	6%	7%	7%	8%	8%	7%	8%	7%	7%	8%	8%	7%	8%	8%	8%	9%	8%	8%	8%
Other	6%	2%	2%	2%	2%	1%	2%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%	1%
Total	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

[1] Includes Secondary Advertising

Table A8-15
Treatment Of Advertising Material By Household Income
Percent of Households
Years 2000 - 2018 (Recruitment Data)

	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018
Usually Read - Total	15%	13%	13%	13%	15%	15%	15%	17%	17%	17%	20%	22%	22%	20%	20%	19%	18%	16%	16%
Under $25K	51%	41%	36%	41%	34%	33%	33%	34%	31%	39%	44%	44%	42%	40%	42%	41%	41%	37%	32%
$25 - $ 49.9	28%	28%	26%	27%	30%	29%	29%	29%	27%	25%	26%	22%	23%	24%	26%	26%	25%	31%	30%
$50 - $64.9	10%	13%	13%	12%	14%	14%	13%	13%	16%	12%	11%	10%	12%	13%	10%	12%	10%	10%	11%
$65 +	10%	19%	25%	21%	22%	24%	25%	24%	26%	24%	19%	24%	24%	23%	22%	21%	24%	22%	27%
Usually Scan - Total	40%	38%	37%	38%	38%	38%	36%	33%	30%	29%	27%	26%	25%	21%	21%	22%	22%	22%	24%
Under 25K	36%	27%	22%	25%	23%	21%	21%	19%	18%	20%	26%	24%	22%	23%	22%	25%	23%	21%	18%
$25 - $ 49.9	33%	30%	26%	27%	28%	26%	26%	26%	25%	25%	26%	21%	21%	24%	28%	23%	23%	22%	26%
$50 - $64.9	14%	14%	17%	17%	16%	17%	15%	16%	14%	14%	14%	12%	13%	13%	14%	12%	13%	13%	11%
$65 +	17%	30%	35%	31%	33%	35%	37%	40%	43%	41%	35%	43%	44%	40%	37%	40%	41%	44%	45%
Read Some - Total	27%	29%	30%	31%	32%	32%	32%	31%	32%	34%	35%	32%	34%	36%	37%	36%	35%	36%	34%
Under 25K	32%	24%	18%	19%	18%	18%	17%	17%	16%	19%	24%	22%	22%	21%	17%	19%	18%	18%	14%
$25 - $ 49.9	35%	28%	26%	26%	24%	23%	26%	23%	23%	22%	23%	21%	22%	23%	25%	23%	23%	22%	25%
$50 - $64.9	14%	12%	16%	17%	17%	17%	16%	15%	15%	14%	14%	12%	14%	13%	14%	13%	13%	12%	13%
$65 +	18%	36%	40%	38%	41%	42%	41%	45%	45%	45%	40%	46%	42%	43%	45%	45%	46%	48%	49%
Usually Don't Read - Total	17%	20%	19%	18%	16%	15%	17%	19%	20%	20%	18%	21%	20%	23%	21%	23%	25%	25%	27%
Under 25K	39%	30%	25%	25%	22%	22%	18%	20%	19%	20%	28%	25%	29%	25%	19%	21%	18%	19%	15%
$25 - $ 49.9	31%	25%	23%	25%	22%	22%	25%	22%	21%	21%	20%	22%	19%	19%	20%	23%	20%	21%	23%
$50 - $64.9	13%	12%	15%	15%	14%	16%	16%	14%	14%	14%	13%	13%	12%	10%	12%	12%	14%	10%	12%
$65 +	17%	33%	37%	35%	42%	40%	41%	44%	45%	45%	39%	41%	41%	46%	48%	44%	49%	51%	49%

Note: Beginning in 2010 data was restated due to changes in weighing methodologies.

Appendix B: Methodology

Study Design and Methodology

The U.S. Postal Service Household Diary Study (HDS), conducted by NuStats on behalf of the Volume and Revenue Forecasting division of the Postal Service's Finance Department, is a continuously fielded study that measures household mail volumes, mail usage, and attitudes about the mail and advertising.

The HDS uses a two-stage survey design: Stage 1 is an online and interviewer-mediated household recruitment interview. Stage 2 is a self-completion mail diary [Appendix C contains the survey instruments]. The HDS uses a multi-mode approach to minimize response bias, to improve data accuracy through efficient data checking and household re-contacts, and to provide immediate telephone assistance to participants during their diary week.

Household Recruitment Interview

The **household recruitment interview** collects information on household and individual demographics, recall of mail sent and received, adoption and use of communications technologies, bill payment behavior, and attitudes towards advertising.

Mail Diary

The **mail diary** covers a seven-day period (Monday to Sunday) and collects information on the number of mail pieces received and sent, industry source, mail characteristics, and attitudes regarding mail received.

Sample Design

This section describes the household selection process for participation in the HDS. A sample is the representative subset of the survey population used to gain information about the entire population. The population of inference for the HDS is all U.S. households. The probability design ensures each household has an equal chance of selection.

The sample design allows projections of results to all U.S. households. The Postal Service provided an address sample that NuStats matched for known telephone listings. Generally, the study was conducted using telephone and online sampling for household selection and screening, followed by diaries and/or instructional materials mailed to eligible households and completed by each household unit. Households without telephones were contacted via U.S. Mail. The sample design involves a systematic sample stratified by strata (or urban/rural location) and Census regions, ensuring even coverage across the United States.

A master national sample was specified and drawn by in-house sampling statisticians. The Postal Service drew the household probability sample from the national address database following NuStats specifications. The master list, sorted by ZIP code, was used to draw a systematic stratified sample, which was then tagged with variables indicating each housing unit's geographic location in terms of Census region and stratum. Starting in FY 2018, flags were added to indicate if a housing unit was likely to belong to a population group that has historically shown low response rates - Hispanic or young households (age of the household head < 35 years old).

Sample was drawn for each of the four quarters based on known proportions of households within a Census region and urban or rural location. Census regions are defined by state. Urban and rural location is defined by county and metropolitan status as defined by the U.S. Census Bureau. The strata are defined by county as follows:

- **Stratum 1**: Counties that are part of the 30 largest metropolitan areas in the United States, as defined by population, according to 100 percent counts of the Census 2010.
- **Stratum 2:** Counties that are part of metropolitan areas but are not in Stratum 1.
- **Stratum 3**: Counties that are not part of a metropolitan area.

Quarterly sample frames were then derived based on the amount of sample needed for each quarter, and sample was allocated to region and strata cells based on known proportions as indicated by Census 2010 counts of households. Likely Hispanic or young households are oversampled.

The sample was continuously "fielded" throughout all 52 weeks of the year. Sample was released in a manner

designed to recruit equal sample sizes for each diary week, resulting in a sample file of at least 5,200 households. Table B.1 shows the distribution of recruited and completed households.

Table B.1:
Sample by Postal Quarter

Quarter	Required Sample	Recruited Households	Completed Households
Quarter 1	1,300	1,945	1,163
Quarter 2	1,300	2,267	1,445
Quarter 3	1,300	2,219	1,360
Quarter 4	1,300	2,242	1,489
Total	**5,200**	**8,673**	**5,457**

Data Collection Method

The study uses a two-stage design in which households are recruited to participate in the diary study by choosing to use a household interview or an online survey (Stage 1) and recruited households complete a seven-day diary of mail received and sent (Stage 2).

Stage 1: Household Recruitment Interview

The main function of the household recruitment interview is to recruit households to participate in the diary study. In addition, the interview collects information on household and person demographics, recall of mail sent and received, adoption and use of communication technologies, bill payment behavior, and attitudes towards advertising.

Households completed the recruitment interview via computer-assisted telephone interviewing (CATI) technology or by using an online survey. The FY 2018 household interview consisted of 6,171 online surveys and 2,502 phone interviews completed with an adult member (age 18 or older) in the household. Table B.2 below shows the distribution of recruited households by recruitment type.

Table B.2:
Sample by Recruitment Type

Recruitment Interview	Completed	Sample Percent
Phone	2,502	28.8%
Web	6,171	71.2%
Total	8,673	100%

These respondents represented a cross-section of U.S. households by geography. The household interview can contain between 80 and 125 data items, depending on the responses provided, and took an average of 26 minutes to administer. The flow of the interview included the following elements:

- **Introduction.** Each interview began with an introduction and purpose of the interview. The interviewer also verified the respondent's address.
- **Technology adoption and use**. Questions were asked about ownership and use of personal computers, Internet, and other electronic communication.
- **Mail volume recall**. The respondent was asked to summarize how many bills, statements, and packages all members of the household have sent in a particular time period.
- **Use of postal services**. The use of post offices, post office boxes, and private mailing services was explored.
- **Bill payments**. Bill payment volumes, methods, and timing were explored in depth.
- **Periodicals**. A summary of magazine and newspaper volumes received by the household were collected.
- **Advertising**. Descriptions of advertising received by the household as well as attitudes about the advertising, and orders placed because of it, were elicited.
- **Online shopping.** Respondents were asked about their online shopping habits, including questions about shipping methods.
- **Financial accounts and credit cards**. Respondents were asked to summarize the total accounts and credit cards held by the household.
- **Household and person demographics**. Demographic items included gender, age, marital status, employment status, educational attainment, race/ethnicity, household income, household wage earners, home ownership, residence tenure, and dwelling type.

The completion rate for the FY 2018 study (defined as the proportion of respondents who completed the diary portion relative to all recruited respondents) was 62.9 percent compared to 62.2 percent in FY 2017. Most recruitment refusals took place prior to hearing who NuStats was and why the firm was calling. Refusal

households that were later re-contacted cited time constraints and privacy concerns as reasons for not participating.

Stage 2: Mail Diary Package

Recruited households were sent mail diaries, instructions, and a toll-free "help" telephone number. The night before the beginning of an assigned diary week, NuStats made reminder calls to households to confirm receipt of the diary package and to answer any questions. If the diary package was not received by this time, NuStats re-confirmed the address, assigned a new diary week, and re-sent the diary package.

The diary package contains a Certificate of Appreciation, Instruction Booklet, and a photo-based "Quick Start" sheet. The Instruction Booklet provided information about the study, answers to frequently asked questions, instructions for filling out the diary, guidelines for sorting mail, and examples of mail markings. The diary instrument was composed of two parts:

- **The Question sheets**. The Question sheets are color-coded by mail classification (First-Class Mail received, First-Class Mail sent, Marketing Mail, Nonprofit, etc.). Information collected about each mail classification included: type of mail piece (i.e., envelope, postcard, catalog, etc.), mail classification, mail type, sender type, information about advertising enclosed, and receiver reaction or responses to the mail piece.
- **Seven answer booklets, each specific to a day of the week**. Each booklet was arranged by mail classification and color-coded to correspond to the question sheets.

Households were instructed to enclose pertinent information from each mail piece received to enable NuStats editors to verify or clarify quantity and classes of mail recorded in the diaries. NuStats used a three-stage editing process to check the accuracy of the diary information recorded by each household. First, returned diary packages were culled for those that represented a reasonable attempt to complete the diary. Second, the diary information recorded for each day were checked to ensure sufficient and logical answers, as well as to verify recorded information against the mail markings returned in the package. The diaries were then scanned using Optical Character Recognition (OCR) software. In stage three, a verifier re-checked the diary information recorded in the OCR software for each day. This second edit functions as a quality control check to ensure data accuracy.

During the editing process, a small number of correction callbacks were made to households to clarify information or to fill-in missing information.

Overall, about three percent of returned diaries did not pass the edit checking process.

Of the 8,673 households recruited to receive a diary package 5,457 actually returned acceptable completed diaries (defined as containing data suitable for analysis) to NuStats, for a completion rate of 62.9 percent.

Data Processing

Data Management

Data management entails processing the information resulting from the Household Interview and Mail Diaries, making it available for analysis, storing it, and documenting it. Household interviews were conducted using CATI technology, where the questionnaire and relevant data checks were programmed into a master questionnaire that was used by all interviewers to administer the survey. Recorded data was extracted from the CATI software into a database management file.

Returned diary information was recorded (entered) through optical scanning technology. The diary data, once scanned using Teleform software, was captured in a database management file.

After completion of data collection, editing and entry tasks, the survey data were contained in 9 data files. One data file contained the Household Interview data. The Mail Diary data were in 8 files—one for each mail classification (First-Class Mail received, First-Class Mail sent, etc.). These files were all developed in SAS-PC.

The file variables were identified by variable name. For each file variable, the File Information contains:

- Label, which is a brief description of the variable;
- Measurement level, which specifies the level of measurement as scale (numeric data on an interval or ratio scale), ordinal, or nominal. Nominal and ordinal data can be either string (alphanumeric) or numeric;
- Value formats, which identify the response codes; and
- Column width and alignment.

Several SAS programming operations were necessary to put the Mail Diary data in the desired form for analysis. The structure for these programs was contained in a separate File Information document that accompanied the data delivery.

Various edit routines were used to check the consistency of the reported data and to identify reporting or entry errors. Routine edit checks were conducted to examine questionnaire responses for reasonableness and consistency across items. Routine checks included such items as:

- Response code range checks;
- Checks for proper data skips and patterns of answering questions consistent with prior answers;
- Checks for realistic responses (e.g., number of online purchases possible in one month); and
- Checks for high frequency of item non-response (missing data from question refusals).

When conducting these checks, data were compared against the actual survey forms. NuStats identified extreme values that were impossible or unlikely, and corrected inconsistent data when possible. For example, extremely high numbers of computers owned by a household were examined to determine whether or not they were legitimate.

Some extreme/inconsistent data values unable to be corrected or verified were edited to missing values.

In addition, NuStats performed in-depth customized data checks to ensure data within each record of the Household Interview were logically consistent. For example, a respondent should have reported paying bills online only if he/she also reported having Internet access. Customized checks were also used to ensure consistency between the Household Interview and Mail Diary data. For example, an addressee was identified as a child (under 18) in the diary only if the household also reported having a child in the Household Interview.

Raw variables, derived variables, and analytical programs were documented in a data documentation binder that accompanied the data delivery. Any information that could be directly or indirectly used to identify individual respondents, such as respondent names, addresses, or telephone numbers, were removed to protect respondent confidentiality and privacy. Such information is stored in a locked archival file.

Sample Demographic Profile (All Counts Unweighted), Government Fiscal Year 2018

Table B.3:
Annual Household Income by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Annual Household Income	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
$0 - $24,999	480	490	970	8.8%	20.2%
$25,000 - $34,999	407	350	757	7.5%	9.2%
$35,000 - $49,999	546	339	885	10.0%	12.3%
$50,000 - $64,999	573	287	860	10.5%	10.3%
$65,000 - $79,999	542	256	798	9.9%	9.0%
$80,000 - $99,999	556	272	828	10.2%	9.6%
$100,000 or more	1,393	642	2,035	25.5%	29.3%
Don't Know	164	160	324	3.0%	N/A
Refused	796	420	1,216	14.6%	N/A
Total	**5,457**	**3,216**	**8,673**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households that provided a response to the Household Income question.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2018).

Table B.4:
Number of Adults in Household by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Number of Adults in Household	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
One	1,228	874	2,102	22.5%	28.0%
Two	2,454	1,163	3,617	45.0%	34.5%
Three	797	477	1,274	14.6%	15.2%
Four	592	413	1,005	10.8%	12.9%
Five or More	386	289	675	7.1%	9.4%
Total	**5,457**	**3,216**	**8,673**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2018).

Table B.5:
Geographic Region by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Geographic Region	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
Northeast	795	464	1,259	14.6%	16.0%
Midwest	1,407	669	2,076	25.8%	23.2%
South	1,980	1,324	3,304	36.3%	38.1%
West	1,275	759	2,034	23.4%	22.6%
Total	**5,457**	**3,216**	**8,673**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Census 2010, Summary File 3, Table H6 (Occupied Housing Units).

Table B.6:
Urban/Rural Location by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Urban/Rural Location	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
30 Largest Metro Areas	2,537	1,539	4,076	46.5%	46.5%
Other Metro Areas	2,375	1,335	3,710	43.5%	42.4%
Non-Metropolitan Areas	545	342	887	10.0%	11.0%
Total	**5,457**	**3,216**	**8,673**	**100.0%**	**100.0%**

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Census 2010; Strata based on Metro Area Classification by County.

Table B.7:
Age of Head of Household by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Age of Head of Household	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
18 - 24	90	99	189	1.6%	4.7%
25 - 44	1,259	920	2,179	23.1%	32.8%
45 - 64	2,034	1,105	3,139	37.3%	36.5%
65+	1,961	1,029	2,990	35.9%	25.9%
Refused	113	63	176	2.1%	N/A
Total	**5,457**	**3,216**	**8,673**	100.0%	100.0%

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households that provided a valid response.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2018).

Table B.8:
Educational Attainment of Head of Household by Recruitment/Retrieval Status

Educational Attainment of Head of Household	Recruited Households		Total	Sample Percent	Population Percent
	Retrieved	Not Retrieved			
8th grade or less	35	89	124	0.6%	3.3%
Some high school	105	135	240	1.9%	6.2%
High school graduate	850	678	1,528	15.6%	26.8%
Some college	1,065	686	1,751	19.5%	18.2%
Technical school graduate	311	209	520	5.7%	4.5%
College graduate	1,710	866	2,576	31.3%	27.7%
Postgraduate work	1,297	481	1,778	23.8%	13.4%
Refused	84	72	156	1.5%	N/A
Total	**5,457**	**3,216**	**8,673**	100.0%	100.0%

Notes:
Sample Percent based only on retrieved households that provided a valid response.
Population percent based on U.S. Census Bureau, Current Population Survey Annual Demographic File (March 2018).

Data Weighting and Expansion

This section explains the methodology used for creating sampling and expansion weights for the FY 2018 Household Diary Study.

The FY 2018 HDS uses both weighting and expansion factors to 1) adjust the sample data to match population parameters and 2) expand mail volumes exhibited in the diary sample to all U.S. households.

Weighting Procedures, FY 2018 Recruitment Data

Sampling weights were produced separately for the households that participated in the recruitment phase of the FY 2018 HDS, and those that completed and returned a diary. There were four main weighting variables: Geography, Education, Age, and Homeownership. FY 2018 recruitment geographic weights were derived from sample households' strata and region:

Strata: As mentioned previously, there are three strata. A household was classified within strata as residing in the top 30 metropolitan areas nationwide, any other metropolitan area, or a non-metropolitan area.[1] Table B.9 provides unweighted sample counts from FY 2018 recruitment data for strata:

Table B.9:
HDS 2018 Recruitment Data: Urban/Rural Location

Urban/ Rural Location	Household	Percent	Cumulative Percent
30 Largest Metro Areas	4,076	47.0%	47.0%
Other Metro Areas	3,710	42.8%	89.8%
Non-Metro Counties	887	10.2%	100.0%
Total	**8,673**	100.0%	

Regions: Table B.10 provides unweighted sample counts from FY 2018 recruitment data for region. Households were classified by state. There are four mutually exclusive regions as defined by the U.S. Census Bureau (along with respective states):

Four Census Regions:

Northeast: Connecticut, Maine, Massachusetts, New Hampshire, New Jersey, New York, Pennsylvania, Rhode Island, and Vermont.

Midwest: Illinois, Indiana, Iowa, Kansas, Michigan, Minnesota, Missouri, Nebraska, North Dakota, Ohio, South Dakota, and Wisconsin.

South: Alabama, Arkansas, Delaware, District of Columbia, Florida, Georgia, Kentucky, Louisiana, Maryland, Mississippi, North Carolina, Oklahoma, South Carolina, Tennessee, Texas, Virginia, and West Virginia.

West: Arizona, Alaska, California, Colorado, Hawaii, Idaho, Montana, Nevada, New Mexico, Oregon, Utah, Washington, and Wyoming.

Table B.10:
HDS 2018 Recruitment Data: Geographic Region

Geographic Region	Households	Percent	Cumulative Percent
Northeast	1,259	14.5%	14.5%
Midwest	2,076	23.9%	38.5%
South	3,304	38.1%	76.5%
West	2,034	23.5%	100.0%
Total	**8,673**	100.0%	

Strata/Regions: Table B.11 indicates the distribution of households from the FY 2018 recruitment sample within strata and regions.

Population parameters for the intersection of the three strata and four regions were based on 2010 Census counts of households by county. As Table B.12 shows, each county was grouped according to its location within these 12 mutually exclusive and collectively exhaustive geographic categories.

To calculate the weight for each strata/region interval, the population percentage was divided by the sample percentage. Geography weights appear in the last column to the right in Table B.12.

[1] Metropolitan area is defined within the sample according to the official definition used by the U.S. Census Bureau, commonly referred to as Metropolitan Statistical Areas (MSAs). Metropolitan areas are defined as single- or multi-county areas. Non-metropolitan areas are counties that do not belong to a metropolitan area. Each sample county was assigned to a stratum according to its metropolitan status.

Table B.11:
Distribution of Households within Strata and Region

Geographic Region	Stratum *(Urban/Rural Location)*			Total
	30 Largest Metro Areas	Other Metro Areas	Non-Metro Areas	
Northeast	642	499	118	**1,259**
Midwest	994	832	250	**2,076**
South	1,302	1,619	383	**3,304**
West	1,138	760	136	**2,034**
Total	**4,076**	**3,710**	**887**	**8,673**

Table B.12:
HDS 2018 Recruitment Data: Construction of Geographic Weight

Stratum	Geographic Region	Households *(Population)*	Percent	Households *(Sample)*	Percent	Weight
30 Largest Metro Areas	Northeast	8,679,534	7.96%	642	7.4%	1.08
	Midwest	11,759,871	10.79%	994	11.5%	.94
	South	16,492,511	15.13%	1,302	15.0%	1.01
	West	13,800,893	12.66%	1,138	13.1%	.97
Other Metro Areas	Northeast	7,316,645	6.71%	499	5.8%	1.17
	Midwest	9,982,770	9.16%	832	9.6%	.95
	South	19,849,344	18.21%	1,619	18.7%	.98
	West	9,074,069	8.33%	760	8.8%	.95
Non-Metro Areas	Northeast	1,485,685	1.36%	118	1.4%	1.00
	Midwest	3,551,875	3.26%	250	2.9%	1.13
	South	5,200,840	4.77%	383	4.4%	1.08
	West	1,796,099	1.65%	136	1.6%	1.05
Totals		**108,990,136**	100.0%	**8,673**	100.0%	1.00

Source: Household Population Estimates based on U.S. Census Bureau, 2010 Census.

Education: In addition to weighting for differences in geography between the sample and the population, an additional weight was created based on differences in the educational attainment of the head of household. For those households in which either more than one person was identified as the head of household or no individual was identified as the head of household, one was chosen based on the following sequence of criteria: 1) oldest male or 2) oldest female (if no male exists). For cases in which two candidates for the head of the household were of the same age, the respondent on the phone was chosen. Known population parameters were based on weighted proportions derived from the U.S. Census Bureau's Current Population Survey annual demographic file for March 2018. For cases in which the head of household refused to provide his/her education level, an educational level was imputed based on the average educational level of like cases. There were 156 such cases in 2018; mean levels of educational attainment were based on geography (strata and regions), as well as age and income level, if provided.

Table B.13:
HDS 2018 Recruitment Data: Construction of Educational Attainment Weight

Educational Attainment	Households *(Population)*	Percent	Households *(Sample)*	Percent	Weight
Less than high school diploma	12,059,376	9.5%	364	4.2%	2.25
High school graduate	34,177,169	26.8%	1,528	17.6%	1.52
Some college	23,168,147	18.2%	1,763	20.3%	0.89
Technical school graduate	5,746,798	4.5%	654	7.5%	0.60
College graduate	35,370,070	27.7%	2,586	29.8%	0.93
Postgraduate work	17,064,593	13.4%	1,778	20.5%	0.65
Totals	127,586,152	100.0%	8,673	100.0%	1.00

Note: Education responses include imputed Don't Know/Refused answers.

Age: Additional weight was also created based on differences in the age of the head of household. Known population parameters were based on weighted proportions derived from the U.S. Census Bureau's Current Population Survey annual demographic file for March 2018. For cases in which the head of household refused to provide his/her age, an age level was imputed based on the average age level of like cases. There were 176 such cases in 2018; mean levels of age were based on geography (strata and regions), as well as education level, if provided.

Table B.14:
HDS 2018 Recruitment Data: Construction of Age Weight

Educational Attainment	Households *(Population)*	Percent	Households *(Sample)*	Percent	Weight
18-24	6,059,833	4.7%	189	2.2%	2.18
25-34	20,292,553	15.9%	991	11.4%	1.39
35-44	21,601,699	16.9%	1,194	13.8%	1.23
45-54	22,568,872	17.7%	1,424	16.4%	1.08
55-64	24,049,375	18.8%	1,862	21.5%	0.88
65-74	19,029,928	14.9%	1,746	20.1%	0.74
75+	13,983,891	11.0%	1,267	14.6%	0.75
Total	127,586,152	100.0%	8,673	100.0%	1.00

Note: Age responses include imputed Don't Know/Refused answers.

Homeownership: In addition to weighing for differences in education and geography between the sample and the population, data was weighed to account for homeownership rates for U.S. Households. For those households in which homeownership was unknown, one was imputed based on the average income level and geography of like cases. There were 194 such cases in 2018; mean levels of income attainment were based on geography (strata and regions). Known population parameters were based on weighted proportions derived from the U.S. Census Bureau's Current Population Survey quarterly Housing Vacancies and Homeownership file for October 2018. The average Homeownership rate in 2018 is 64.3 percent.

Weighting Procedures, FY 2018 Diary Data

As mentioned above, 8,673 households participated in the recruitment phase of the FY 2018 HDS, and 5,457 households completed usable diaries. Balancing weights for the FY 2018 HDS diary data were developed in the same way as for the recruitment data. An additional age weight was derived based on the age of the head of household using the following categories: 18–24, 25–34, 35–44, 45–54, 55–64, 65–74, and over 75 years old.

Other adjustments to weights used in the diary data included a quarterly adjustment, which accounted for variances in sampling across postal quarters.

All component weights were multiplied together and normalized to ensure that the total number of weighted cases equals the number of unweighted cases.

A final adjustment in the form of expansion factors was made to expand the sample to the level of total households in the United States at the time of data collection, which was 127.6 million. The number of households in the United States was divided into the number of households that participated in the diary portion of the survey. The resultant factor was applied to each household in the survey. The expansion factor was multiplied by the sampling weight and then multiplied by 52 (the number of calendar weeks in one year) to derive nationwide annual volume estimates from the sample data.

Expansion Factor

127,586,152/ 5,457 = 23,380.3

Component Weight:

$$\omega = \frac{Ps / Pt}{Ss / St},$$

Where Ps = population count in cohort and
Pt = total population count
Ss = sample count in cohort
St = total sample count

Appendix C: Survey Instruments

Appendix C1: Recruitment Questionnaire

Acronym Dictionary
DK = Don't Know
RF = Refusal
NA = Not applicable

1. [INT01] Hello, my name is _____, and I'm calling on behalf of the U.S. Postal Service. Are you the head of the household? IF NOT May I speak with him or her, please?

OK.....Continue =>GO TO LETTR
NA.....No Answer =>GO TO END
BZ.....Busy =>GO TO END
AM .....Answering Machine =>GO TO END
ID .....Disconnect =>GO TO END
IM .....Computer/Fax Machine =>GO TO END
IG .....Business/Government =>GO TO END
IL .....Language Barrier =>GO TO END
R1.....1st Refusal =>GO TO REFU1
KB.....Call Back, Specific =>GO TO CB
KH.....Call Back, General =>GO TO CB
KR.....Spanish Callback, General =>GO TO CB
LM.....Left Message
SA .....Spanish Answering Machine
KS .....Spanish Callback, Specific =>GO TO CB
RH.....Hang Up =>GO TO END
PM .....Caller ID =>GO TO END
RF .....Strong Refusal =>GO TO REFUS
QA.....No ASSN Dates Available (ONLY USED AT END OF QTR) =>GO TO END
SN .....Spanish No Answer
SB .....Spanish busy
QD.....Non-qualified, Special (Permission only) =>GO TO END
WC .....WILL COMPLETE ON WEB=>GO TO END
KN.....NEW NUMBER=>GO TO Tel01
IH.....LANGUAGE BARRIER, DEAF/TTY=>GO TO END

2. [LETTR] The U.S. Postal Service is conducting a study to better understand the type and amount of mail households like yours receive and send. The information will be used to make better decisions about postage rates and staffing needs to ensure an efficient national mail system and keep costs at a minimum. We recently sent a letter explaining the study and to let you know we would contact you. Did you receive our letter?

1 .....Yes CONTINUE WITH INT05

2.....No

3. [INT05] For this study, your household will use diaries to answer detailed questions about the mail you receive and send for one week. You will receive your choice of either 100 Forever Stamps or a $40 check. You can expect your gift to arrive in about 10 - 12 weeks after we receive your completed information. Before I can get your diaries out to you, I need to get some information about your household.

END OF A QUARTER ONLY: Your household was selected to participate in the diary study the week of <LASTDATE>.

END OF QUARTER IF RESPONDENT CANNOT DO DIARIES THIS QUARTER: I'm sorry your household is not eligible for another week, but thank you for your time and interest. CODE AS QA.

OK.....Continue

KB ..... Call Back – specific =>GO TO CB
KH ..... Call Back – general =>GO TO CB
KS..... Spanish Call Back – specific =>GO TO CB
KR ..... Spanish Call Back – general =>GO TO CB
QA ..... No available assignment dates (ONLY USED AT END OF QTR) =>GO TO END
R1 ..... 1st Refusal =>GO TO REFU1
RH ..... Hang Up =>GO TO END
RF……..Hard, Final Refusal

4. [VADD] First, I'd like to verify your mailing address. Is it ... ADDR: <MADDR> APT: <MSUIT> CITY: <MCITY> STATE: <MSTAT> ZIP: <MZIP1> <MZIP2> <APTML>

1 YES => CONTINUE WITH VPHONE
2 NO, ENTIRE ADDRESS IS WRONG => SKIP TO INT10 CODE AS QN
3 NO, SUIT IS WRONG (CAN BE ADJUSTED)
9 REFUSE => INT07

4a. [INT07] IF REFUSED VADD, CODE AS RA (REFUSED ADDRESS), THANK AND TERMINATE. I understand not wanting to give out your address, but to participate in the survey and be eligible to receive 100 Forever stamps or $40, I'll need to verify your mailing address.

4b. [MSUIT] What is the new apartment or suite number?

LEAVE BLANK IF NO APT OR SUITE # => VPHONE

5. [VADR2] I'd like to verify your mailing address. Is it . . .
ADDR<MADDR> APT<MSUIT> CITY<MCITY> STATE<MSTAT> ZIP<MZIP1><MZIP2>

1 YES => INT05, THEN => VPHON
2 NO, ENTIRE ADDRESS IS WRONG => SKIP TO INT10 CODE AS QN
3 NO, SUIT IS WRONG (CAN BE ADJUSTED)
9 REFUSE => INT07

5a. [INT07] IF REFUSED VADR2, CODE AS RA (REFUSED ADDRESS), THANK AND TERMINATE. I understand not wanting to give out your address, but to participate in the survey and be eligible to receive 100 Forever stamps or $40, I'll need to verify your mailing address. Your information will remain confidential and used only for research purposes. Your participation is very important. Are you certain you do not wish to continue with the survey?

AFTER VERIFYING ADDRESS IF LETTR=2, READ INT05 BUT THEN SKIP TO VPHON.

5b. [MSUI2] What is the new apartment or suite number? LEAVE BLANK IF NO APT OR SUITE # => INT05, then Skip to VPHON

6. [VPHON] The phone number we have for you is <PHONE>. Is that correct?

7. [HISPANIC] Would you describe the head of your household as Hispanic or Latino? (A person of Cuban, Mexican, Puerto Rican, South or Central American, or other Spanish culture or origin, regardless of race.)

1..... Yes => **CONTINUE**
2..... No => **CONTINUE**

[ASSNC] We want to confirm that you understand we are asking you to record your household´s mail for one week, the week of READ DATE. Is that a good week for you? **IF NOT, THEN OFFER NEXT ASSN WEEK.** IF HISPANIC = 1 - In addition to getting 100 Forever Stamps or a $40 check your household is eligible to receive a $10 Amazon gift card or a WalMart gift card if you complete all phases of the project. ", CONDITION="hispanic=1")

Do you have any questions for me about the diaries?

ANSWER QUESTIONS AS NEEDED AND CONTINUE

IF NEEDED - How long it takes depends on how much mail you receive. The first day of your diary-recording week will take the longest as you become familiar with the survey. After that, on average, it should take about 3-5 mins for each piece of mail. Should you need assistance, we have a USPS survey hotline available to provide you with step-by-step instructions to assist you and to answer any questions you may have. That toll free number is 1-888-441-8777. You may also want to check out the study web site at www.nustats.com/uspsstudy.htm.

IF NEEDED - USE AT END OF QUARTER ONLY: At this time these are the only assignment weeks we have available to participate in this important study. We may call you back at a future date; however, those are all the questions I have for you today. Thank you for your time and have a good day. SELECT ASSN 15999

8. [Q1] RESPONDENT GENDER, DON'T ASK

1 .....Male
2 .....Female

9. [RECV] Do you receive mail at your home address, including cluster boxes near your home? [WE WANT TO KNOW IF THEY RECEIVE MAIL AT THEIR PHYSICAL HOME ADDRESS AND NOT A PAID PO BOX]

1 .....Yes
2 .....No => CONTINUE
8 .....DK => CONTINUE
9 .....RF => CONTINUE

10. [HMBOX] Where is your mailbox located?

1 .....Door slot
2 .....Mailbox installed on a porch or near your front door
3 .....Curbside single/double mailbox (not part of a cluster or group of mailboxes)
4 .....Central mailbox cluster inside an apartment, condominium or other building
5……Central mailbox cluster outside in your neighborhood
[IF 1-5, CONTINUE TO POBOX]
6 .....Picked up mail from a post office box or box at a mailing center **-> [IF 6 THANK AND TERMINATE, AND MARK IT QM (INT04)]**
8 .....DK**-> [IF 8 THANK AND TERMINATE, AND MARK IT QM (INT04)]**
9 .....RF**-> [IF 9 THANK AND TERMINATE, AND MARK IT QM (INT04)]**

11. [INT04] Thank you very much for your time. I'm sorry if we inconvenienced you, but we need households that receive their mail at their home address. Have a nice evening/day. Goodbye.

QM……. DOES NOT RECEIVE MAIL AT HOME ADDRESS => GO TO END

12. [POBOX] Does your household rent a PO Box at either the Post Office or a private mailing service, like Post Office Plus, or Parcel Place? PROBE IF THEY JUST SAY YES: Is that at the Postal Service or private mailing firm?

1..... PO BOX AT USPS
2..... BOX AT PRIVATE MAILING SERVICE
3..... NEITHER – DOES NOT HAVE A PO BOX OR PRIVATE COMPANY
4..... BOTH
7……OTHER, SPECIFY [O_POBOX]
8..... DK
9..... RF

13. [Q9R] Which of the following methods have household members used in the last six months to mail personal packages, not letter mail? Do not include work-related packages. [MARK ALL THAT APPLY]

[PROGRAMMER NOTE: add an extra option. 5, 8, and 9 are exclusive]

0..... Put the package in a blue USPS Mailbox
1..... Took Package inside a US Post Office to the service counter
4..... I left the package for my mail carrier for pick up
6..... Used an Automated Postal Center.
3..... Used a private package shipping company, like UPS, FedEx, etc.
2..... Took it to a private mailing service, like Post Office Plus, Parcel Place, etc.
7..... OTHER, SPECIFY [O_Q9R]
5..... NONE (HAVE NOT MAILED PACKAGES IN THE LAST SIX MONTHS)
8..... DK
9..... RF

14. [Q14B] How many times in an average month do household members go inside a U.S. Post Office to the service counter? VERIFY RESPONSE IF MORE THAN 30, RANGE: 0-60

00..... NONE
98..... DK
99..... RF

15. [Q12] How many times in an average month do household members go to a U.S. Post Office but not to the service counter? IF NEEDED: We mean an outside drop off box, going to your PO Box, or using an automated machine. VERIFY RESPONSE IF MORE THAN 30, RANGE: 0-60

98..... DK
99..... RF

16. [Q13] How many times in an average month do household members go to a private mailing service? [IF NEEDED: For example, Post Office Plus, Parcel Place, etc] RANGE: 0-30

00..... None => GO TO Q15
98..... DK => GO TO Q15
99..... RF => GO TO Q15

17. [Q14] Why does your household use a mailing service rather than the post office? MULTIPLE RESPONSE, ALLOW UP TO 7 ANSWERS

IF THEY SAY "CONVENIENT" OR "EASIER" OR OTHER VAGUE RESPONSE, ASK "Why is it convenient or easier?" SELECT BEST FIT.

01 .....HOURS-LONGER/LATER
02 .....LOCATION
03 .....OFFERS PICK UP SERVICE
04 .....CHEAPER
05 .....FASTER/OVERNIGHT DELIVERY
06 .....OFFERS DROP OFF SERVICE
07 .....PACKAGES IT UP
08 .....SERVICE-BETTER/MORE EFFICIENT/FRIENDLY
09 .....MORE RELIABLE/SEEMS SAFER
11 .....USES ONLY IN SPECIAL CIRCUMSTANCES
12 .....FOR EXTRA SERVICES (COPYING, FAXES, MAIL BOXES, ETC.)
13 .....SHORTER WAIT TIME/LINES, LESS CROWDED
14 .....'SHIP TO' REQUESTED IT
16 .....ACCEPTS ODD-SHAPED/OVERSIZED PACKAGES
18 .....ON-LINE TRACKING SERVICE
20 .....USES ONLY FOR JOB/WORK-RELATED PACKAGES
21 .....TO USE UPS OR FED EX, ETC.
22 …… RETURNING AN ORDER (SENDING BACK USING THE SERVICE THAT COMPANY USED TO SHIP IT)
97 .....OTHER, SPECIFY [O_Q14]
98 .....DK
99 .....RF

18. [Q15]. Approximately how many Forever stamps do you currently have in your household? [numeric input] RANGE 0-200, 998, 999

19. [Q16]. How many Forever stamps has your household purchased within the past 30 days? [numeric input] RANGE 0-200, 998, 999

20. [Q17]. How many Forever stamps has your household USED within the past 30 days? [numeric input] RANGE 0-200, 998, 999

21. [Q18]. Within the past 30 days, how many Forever stamps within your household have been lost or damaged? [numeric input] RANGE 0-200, 998, 999

22. [Q19]. [**IF Q15=0, SKIP Q19**] Of the Forever stamps you currently have in your household, how many of them do you intend to keep (e.g., for stamp collecting) and not ever use for mailing letters, postcards or packages? [numeric input] RANGE 0-200, 998, 999

Thinking about the USPS only…

[Q20] NEW –How many packages did your household receive in the last month? [Range 0-60]
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

[Q21] NEW –How many packages did your household receive in the last 3 months? [Range 0-300]
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

[Q22] NEW –How many packages did your household send in the last month? [Range 0-60]
98 .....Unsure
99 .....Not applicable/Rather not say

[Q22A] NEW –How many packages did your household send in the last 3 months? [Range 0-300]
98..... Unsure
99..... Not applicable/Rather not say

[PROGRAMMER NOTE: Skip Q9R if Q22A=0]

23. [Q22] Many people are now using the Internet to communicate, pay bills and conduct other household activities that were traditionally done by mail. In this next set of questions, we'll be asking about your household's access to and use of the Internet, including accessing the web through a mobile device. How many adults age 18 or older in your household connect to the Internet from home? RANGE: 0-9

98..... DK
99..... RF

IF Q22 = 0, 98 or 99, SKIP TO Q24

24. [Q23] What is the primary type of Internet connection used by the adults in your home?

4..... DSL, Cable Modem, Other Broadband (fiber optic, satellite), Wireless
2..... Mobile Broadband (such as a SmartPhone)
1..... Dial-up modem
10..... WE DON'T HAVE THE INTERNET
7..... OTHER, SPECIFY [O_Q23]
8..... DK
9..... RF

25. [Q24] Do any of the adults in your household regularly access the Internet from any other location, such as work or a library?

1..... Yes
2..... No
8..... DK
9..... RF

NOTE: SKIP TO Q27 IF ((Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24= 2,8,9, or Missing))

26. [Q55A] **How many of each of these devices do adult members of your household use to access the Internet?**

[PROGRAMMING NOTE: RANGE FOR EACH RESONSE SHOULD BE 0-30]

[Q55A1] Desktop Computer
98……..DK
99……..RF
[Q55A2] Laptop
98……..DK
99……..RF
[Q55A3] Tablet (e.g. iPad)
98……..DK
99……..RF
..... [Q55A4] Mobile Phone
98……..DK
99……..RF

[Q55A5] Gaming Device
98……..DK
99……..RF

.....[Q55A6] eReader
98……..DK
99……..RF

.....[Q55A7] iPod (iTouch, etc.)
98……..DK
99……..RF

.....[Q55A8] Other → [Q55A8O]
98……..DK
99……..RF

27. [Q55A8O] [If Q55A8 > 0] What are the other internet devices?
0 .....No Other Devices
1 .....Please Specify
8 .....DK
9 .....RF

NOTE: SKIP TO Q27 IF ((Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24= 2,8,9, or Missing))

28. [Q57A1] How long have adults in your household been using the Internet at any location?

1 .....Less than 1 year
2 .....1 to 2 years
3 .....2 to 5 years
4 .....More than 5 years
8 .....DK
9 .....RF

29. [Q57B1] During the last month, how often did adults in your household use the Internet for non work-related purposes at any location? Would you say…

1 .....Several times a day
2 .....Almost every day
3 .....Several times a week
4 .....Once a week or less
8 .....DK
9 .....RF

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP TO Q27 IF ((Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24= 2,8,9, or Missing))

30. [Q57C2] Are any adults in your household a member of an online social network, such as Twitter, Facebook, or Instagram?
1 .....YES CONTINUE
2 .....NO => Q7
8 .....DK => Q7
9 .....RF => Q7

31. [Q57C3].....During the last month, How often do adults in your household access online social network sites?
1 Several times a day

2 Several times a week
3 Once per week or less
4 Not in the last month
5 Other
8 Don't know
9 Refused

32. [Q7] About how many electronic greeting cards—not e-mail messages—did your household send through the Internet last month? PROBE FOR SPECIFIC NUMBER, RANGE: 0-80

98..... DK
99..... RF

[Q27] [**ASK ALL**] How many bills does your household receive through the mail each month? For example utilities, cable, & credit card bills? **[***RANGE: 0-80*]

00 . None
98 . Unsure
99 . Rather not say

[Q27C] [**ASK ALL**] How many statements does your household receive through the mail each month? Do not include credit card bill statements in this total. **[***RANGE: 0-80*]

00 . None
98 . Unsure
99 . Rather not say

NOTE: SKIP TO Q29 IF ((Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24= 2,8,9, or Missing))

33. [SCRP3] Many banks and other companies now offer to send bills and statements, as well as to receive bill payments, over the Internet and by other methods. First, we will ask you about your bills and then we'll ask you about your statements.

34. [Q28] How many bills does your household receive on-line at a website or through e-mail each month? For example utilities, cable, & credit card bills? **[**RANGE: 0-80]

00..... None GO TO Q28A
98..... DK
99..... RF

35. [Q28B] How many of these <Q28> bills that you receive online at a website or through email do you also receive a bill in the mail?
RANGE: 0-80

00..... None
98..... DK
99..... RF

36. [Q28C] Did you receive any bills online a year ago?

1 Yes
2 No
8..... DK
9..... RF

37. [Q28D] [If Q28 >0] What are the main reasons you receive bills online? MULTIPLE RESPONSE,- UP TO 5 RESPONSES

IF THE RESPONDENT ANSWERS "CONVENIENT" THEN ASK: In what way is it convenient? **PLEASE DO NOT READ THE LIST**

01 .....NO CHOICE
02 .....RECEIVED A FINANCIAL INCENTIVE
06 .....AVOIDED A FINANCIAL PENALTY
07 .....ENVIRONMENTAL
08 .....SECURITY
12 .....PRIVACY
14 .....RECORD KEEPING
21 .....REDUCE CLUTTER
19 .....CONVENIENCE (EASE OF USE/SAVES TIME)
20…..I HAVE ALWAYS DONE IT THIS WAY
97 .....OTHER, SPECIFY [O_Q33A]
98 .....DK
99 .....RF

38. **[Q28A]** How many statements does your household receive on-line at a website or through e-mail each month? Do not include credit card bill statements in this total. RANGE: 0-80

00 .....None GO TO Q29
98 .....DK
99 .....RF

39. **[Q28E]** For how many of these <Q28A> statements that you receive online at a website or through email do you also receive a statement in the mail?
RANGE: 0-80

00 .....None
98 .....DK
99 .....RF

40. **[Q28F]** Did you receive any Statements online a year ago?

1 Yes
2 No
8 DK
9 RF

41. **[Q28G]** [If Q28A >0] **What are the main reasons you** receive Statements online? MULTIPLE RESPONSE,- UP TO 5 RESPONSES

IF THE RESPONDENT ANSWERS "CONVENIENT" THEN ASK: In what way is it convenient?

PLEASE DO NOT READ THE LIST

01 .....NO CHOICE
02 .....RECEIVED A FINANCIAL INCENTIVE
06 .....AVOIDED A FINANCIAL PENALTY
07 .....ENVIRONMENTAL
08 .....SECURITY
12 .....PRIVACY
14 .....RECORD KEEPING
21 .....REDUCE CLUTTER
19 .....CONVENIENCE (EASE OF USE/SAVES TIME)
20…..I HAVE ALWAYS DONE IT THIS WAY

97..... OTHER, SPECIFY [O_Q33A]
98..... DK
99..... RF

42. [Q29] About how many total bills does your household pay, by any method, in an average month? RANGE: 0-80 VERIFY IF MORE THAN 60

98..... DK
99..... RF

43. [Q31] **Of these <Q29> household bills, about how many are paid**…

NOTE: SKIP ALL THE INTERNET QUESTIONS IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing)

[Q31A] By mail RANGE: 0-80

[Q31A1] Did you use this method to pay bills a year ago?

1 Yes
2 No
8 DK
9 RF

[Q31D] By Internet using a computer? RANGE: 0-40

[Q31D1] Did you use this method to pay bills a year ago?

1 Yes
2 No
8 DK
9 RF

[Q31H] By Internet using a mobile phone? RANGE: 0-40

[Q31H1] Did you use this method to pay bills a year ago?

1 Yes
2 No
8 DK
9 RF

[Q31I] By Internet using other device? RANGE: 0-40

[Q31I1] Did you use this method to pay bills a year ago?

1 Yes
2 No
8 DK
9 RF

[Q31B] In Person RANGE: 0-80

[Q31B1] Did you use this method to pay bills a year ago?

1 Yes
2 No
8 DK
9 RF

[Q31C] By telephone call RANGE: 0-20

[Q31C1] Did you use this method to pay bills a year ago?

1 Yes
2 No
8 DK
9 RF

[Q31F] By automatic deduction from bank account, or charge to debit card RANGE: 0-21

[Q31F1] Did you use this method to pay bills a year ago?

1 Yes
2 No
8 DK
9 RF

[Q31G] By automatic charge to credit card RANGE: 0-10

[Q31G1] Did you use this method to pay bills a year ago?

1 Yes
2 No
8 DK
9 RF

ONLY ASK Q32A AND Q33A IF RESPONDENT SAID THEY PAY THAT WAY In Q31A [>0 AND NOT 98,99]

44. [Q32A] What types of bills does your household pay by mail? [MULTIPLE RESPONSE UNLIMITED RESPONSES]

PLEASE READ THE LIST

01 .....Natural Gas/Propane/Fuel Oil/Etc.
02 .....Electric
03 .....Telephone (landline)
04 .....Water/Sewer
05 .....Credit Cards
06 .....Rent/Mortgage
11 .....Car Payment
09 .....Other loan(s)or line of credit
07 .....Cable TV/Satellite TV
08 .....Insurance
10 .....Cell Phone
12 .....Medical or Dental Bills
13 .....Internet Services
14 .....Alimony/child support
15 .....Taxes (e.g., property or income)
16 .....Garbage/Solid Waste Services
17 …… Newspapers & Magazines
18 …… Homeowners Assoc Fees/Condo Assoc Fees
97 .....OTHER SPECIFY [O_Q32A]

45. [Q33A] **What are the main reasons you pay bills by mail**? MULTIPLE RESPONSE,- UP TO 5 RESPONSES

IF THE RESPONDENT ANSWERS "CONVENIENT" THEN ASK: In what way is it convenient?

PLEASE DO NOT READ THE LIST

01 .....NO CHOICE
02 .....RECEIVED A FINANCIAL INCENTIVE
06 .....AVOIDED A FINANCIAL PENALTY
07 .....ENVIRONMENTAL
08 .....SECURITY
12 .....PRIVACY
14 .....RECORD KEEPING
21 .....REDUCE CLUTTER
19 .....CONVENIENCE (EASE OF USE/SAVES TIME
20…..I HAVE ALWAYS DONE IT THIS WAY
97 .....OTHER, SPECIFY [O_Q33A]
98 .....DK
99 .....RF

ONLY ASK Q34 IF RESPONDENT SAID THEY PAY THAT WAY In Q31B-Q31I [>0 AND NOT 98,99]

46. [Q34] What types of bills does your household pay by methods other than the mail? By other methods, we mean by telephone, in person, through the Internet, by automatic bank deduction or by credit card. [MULTIPLE RESPONSE UNLIMITED RESPONSES]

PLEASE READ THE LIST

01..... Natural Gas/Propane/Fuel Oil/Etc.
02..... Electric
03..... Telephone (landline)
04..... Water/Sewer
05..... Credit Cards
06..... Rent/Mortgage
11..... Car Payment
09..... Other loan(s)or line of credit
07..... Cable TV/Satellite TV
08..... Insurance
10..... Cell Phone
12..... Medical or dental Bills
13..... Internet Services
14..... Alimony/child support
15..... Taxes (e.g., property or income)
16..... Garbage/Solid Waste Services
17 …… Newspapers & Magazines
18 …… Homeowners Assoc Fees/Condo Assoc Fees
97..... OTHER SPECIFY [O_Q34]

ONLY ASK Q34A, Q34A1 IF RESPONDENT SAID THEY PAY THAT WAY In Q31C-Q31I [>0 AND NOT 98,99] Exclude Q31B>0 "in person"

47. [Q34A] What are the reasons you pay bills by electronic methods, such as Online, Automatic deduction from your bank, by phone, or Auto Charge to a Credit Card? MULTIPLE RESPONSE,- UP TO 5 RESPONSES

01..... To save postage costs
02..... Convenience (ease of use/saves time)
03..... Received financial incentive
04..... Avoided a financial penalty
05..... Environmental
06..... Reduce paper clutter
07..... Security
08..... Privacy
97..... OTHER, SPECIFY [O_Q34A]
98..... DK
99..... RF

[PROGRAMMER: DISPLAY ONLY THE ANSWERS SELECTED IN Q34A AS THE ANSWER CHOICES IN Q34A1, AND ONLY ALLOW THEM SELECT ONE ANSWER.]

48. [Q34A1] Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason you pay bills by electronic methods, such as Online, Automatic deduction from your bank, by phone, or Auto Charge to a Credit Card? [PROGRAMMING NOTE: ONLY ALLOW ONE RESPONSE]

01..... To save postage costs
02..... Convenience (ease of use/saves time)
03..... Received financial incentive
04..... Avoided a financial penalty
05..... Environmental
06..... Reduce paper clutter
07..... Security
08..... Privacy
97..... OTHER, SPECIFY [O_Q34A1]
98..... DK
99..... RF

ONLY ASK Q34B and Q34B1 IF RESPONDENT SAID THEY PAY THAT WAY In Q31B [>0 AND NOT 98,99]

49. [Q34B] What are the reasons you pay bills in person? MULTIPLE RESPONSE,- UP TO 5 RESPONSES

01 .....To save postage costs
02 .....Convenience (ease of use/saves time)
03 .....Received financial incentive
04 .....Avoided a financial penalty
05 .....Environmental
06 .....Reduce paper clutter
07 .....Security
08 .....Privacy
97 .....OTHER, SPECIFY [O_Q34B]
98 .....DK
99 .....RF

[PROGRAMMER: DISPLAY ONLY THE ANSWERS SELECTED IN Q34B AS THE ANSWER CHOICES IN Q34B1, AND ONLY ALLOW THEM SELECT ONE ANSWER.]

50. [Q34B1] Of those you selected, what is the **main** reason you pay bills in person? [PROGRAMMING NOTE: ONLY ALLOW ONE RESPONSE]

01 .....To save postage costs
02 .....Convenience (ease of use/saves time)
03 .....Received financial incentive
04 .....Avoided a financial penalty
05 .....Environmental
06 .....Reduce paper clutter
07 .....Security
08 .....Privacy
97 .....OTHER, SPECIFY [O_Q34B1]
98 .....DK
99 .....RF

51. [Q36] How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive through the mail? PROBE FOR SPECIFIC NUMBER, RANGE: 0-50

98 .....DK
99 .....RF

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP Q37 IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing))

52. [Q37] How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive online? PROBE FOR SPECIFIC NUMBER, RANGE: 0-50

98 .....DK
99 .....RF

53. [Q38] How many different magazine subscriptions do members of your household receive through another method? PROBE FOR SPECIFIC NUMBER, RANGE: 0-15 VERIFY IF > 10

98 .....DK
99 .....RF

54. [Q40] How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive through the U.S. Mail? PROBE FOR SPECIFIC NUMBER, RANGE: 0-15

98..... DK
99..... RF

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP Q41 IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing))

55. [Q41] How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive online? PROBE FOR SPECIFIC NUMBER, RANGE: 0-32

98..... DK
99..... RF

56. [Q42] How many different newspaper subscriptions do members of your household receive through another method? PROBE FOR SPECIFIC NUMBER, RANGE: 0-32

98..... DK
99..... RF

57. [Q47] When members of your household receive advertising material through the mail, do they . . .

1..... Usually read it
2..... Usually scan it
3..... Read some, don't read others
4..... Usually don't read it
8..... DK
9..... RF

58. [Q53] In the **last month**, did anyone in your household buy anything as a result of receiving advertising, a catalog or other promotional material in the mail, including credit card solicitations?

1..... YES CONTINUE
2..... NO => GO TO Q55R
8..... DK => GO TO Q55R
9..... RF => GO TO Q55R

59. [Q54] How many of those purchases were placed by . .

[Q54A] By mail RANGE: 0-80-Phone
[Q54D] By Internet using a computer? RANGE: 0-40-Some other method
[Q54H] By Internet using a mobile phone? RANGE: 0-40-New
[Q54I] By Internet using other device? RANGE: 0-40-New
[Q54B] In Person RANGE: 0-80 -Mail
[Q54C] By telephone call RANGE: RANGE: 0-40-Internet
[Q54F] Some Other Method RANGE: 0-40

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP Q55R IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing))

60. [Q55R] In the last month, about how many purchases did your household make over the Internet? VERIFY IF OVER 100, RANGE: 0-200

998..... DK

999 .....RF

PROGRAMMER NOTE: IF Q55R = 0, 998, OR 999, SKIP TO Q177B

61. [Q177A] How many of these Internet purchases were shipped and delivered, as opposed to being delivered electronically (such as e-tickets, software, or a gift certificate for an online retailer)? VERIFY IF OVER 100, RANGE 0-200

000 .....NONE
998 .....DK
999 .....RF

PROGRAMMER NOTE: SKIP Q177B IF (Q22=0, 98, 99 or Missing) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing))

62. [Q177B] Thinking about your most recent Internet purchase, was it shipped and/or delivered to …

0 .....No one in my HH has ever purchased anything on the internet
1 .....Your home address
2 .....Your work address
3 .....Your school address
4 .....Another person's address
5 .....Pick up at store / shipped to store
6 .....Delivered electronically
7 .....OTHER, SPECIFY [O_Q177B]
8 .....DK
9 .....RF

63. [Q177F] Do you feel more secure providing and/or receiving personal information through the Internet or through the U.S. Mail, or is it about the same? [IF NEEDED: an example of a situation when personal information is sent is when ordering products. Examples of personal information is received are bills, statements or solicitations.]

1 .....Internet
2 .....US Mail
3 .....About the same
8 .....DK
9 .....RF

Interviewer Note: the choice is between the Internet and the mail. An answer of 'more secure', or 'less secure', etc., is not acceptable. You must clarify.

64. [Q178]. Do you and/or members of your household typically use coupons when you shop?

1 .....Yes
2 .....No
8 .....Unsure
9 .....Rather not say

65. [Q179] How many coupons did you and/or members of your household use during the past month that were received through the mail?

[If =98 → If you're not sure, please provide your best guess of how many.]

[ENTER NUMBER, RANGE 0-50]

98 ..... Unsure
99 ..... Rather not say

66. [Q180] [SKIP IF (Q22=0, ~~98, 99 or Missing~~) AND (Q24 = 2,8,9, or Missing))]

How many coupons did you and/or members of your household use during the past month that were received online on your computer, cell phone, or other internet device?

[If =98 → If you're not sure, please provide your best guess of how many.]
[ENTER NUMBER RANGE 0-50]
98 ..... Unsure
99 ..... Rather not say

67. [Q181] During the past month, how many coupons did you and/or members of your household use that were received by another method – such as newspaper, magazine, door-hanger, or in-store promotion?

[If =98 → If you're not sure, please provide your best guess of how many.]

[ENTER NUMBER RANGE 0-50]
98..... DK
99..... RF

68. [Q50] Currently, the law does not allow anyone other than a U.S. Postal employee to place material in your mailbox or slot. How would you feel about changing the law to allow anyone to place material in your mailbox or slot? Do you… .

1..... Prefer it
2..... Oppose it
3..... Not care one way or the other
8..... DK
9..... RF

69. [SCRP5] The Postal Service is interested in learning more about what makes up its mail volume. Account statements from banks and other financial companies represent a large portion of the mail. I'll be asking you some questions about the types of financial statements you receive, but nothing about the accounts themselves. As with everything in this survey, your answers are completely confidential.

1..... Continue

70. [Q57] How many total financial accounts do household members have such as Bank or Credit Union, Loans, Stocks, mutual funds, or retirement accounts, etc.? (RANGE: 0-80)

98..... DK
99..... RF

IF NEEDED: Please be assured we are not collecting any specific financial information and your answers will remain completely confidential.

71. [Q58] How many total insurance policies do household members have such as Property, Life, Health, Automobile, etc? Please exclude any policies held through their jobs. [Range: 100]

98..... DK
99..... RF

72. [Q59] How many total credit cards do household members have such as Bank, Gasoline, and Retail store cards, etc.? [Range: 100]

98 DK
99 .....RF

73. [Q60] The next set of questions are for classification purposes only. The answers allow us to compare your household to other households with similar characteristics. Including yourself, how many people live in your household? RANGE 1-16

01 .....ONE => GO TO AGE
98 .....DK
99 .....RF

74. [Q65] How many are 18 years of age or older? RANGE 1-10

98 .....DK
99 .....RF

IF Q65 = Q60 BUT NOT 99, SKIP TO SCRP6

75. [Q61] How many of are under age 6? RANGE 0-9

98 .....DK
99 .....RF

76. [Q62] How many are between the ages of 6 and 12? RANGE 0-6

98 .....DK
99 .....RF

77. [Q63] How many are between the ages of 13 and 17? RANGE 0-5

98 .....DK
99 .....RF

Only ask SCRP6 if more than 1 adult in HH (Q65>1)

78. [SCRP6] The next questions concern the <Q65> person/people, that are 18 years and older that is/are in your household. Let's begin with you.

1 .....CONTINUE

79. [AGE] What is <your/their> age?

01 18-21
02 22-24
03 25-34
04 35-44
05 45-54
06 55-64
07 65-69
08 70-74
09 .....75+
98 .....DK
99 .....RF

Only ask RESTG if more than 1 adult in HH (Q65>1)

80. [RESTG] And how about the next person 18 years of age or older. What is their gender?

1..... Male
2..... Female
8..... DK
9..... RF

81. [Q68] What is <your/their> marital status?

1..... Married
2..... Living as married
3..... Single, never been married
4..... Divorced
5..... Separated
6..... Widowed
8..... DK
9..... RF

82. [Q69] Are <you/they> currently . . .

1..... Employed full-time => GO TO Q79
2..... Employed part-time => GO TO Q79
3..... Retired, or
4..... Not employed
5 ..... Self employed
8..... DK
9..... RF

83. [Q70] Have <you/they> been employed within the last 12-months?

1..... Yes => GO TO Q79
2..... No IF Q69=3 AND Q70=2 SKIP TO Q79
8..... DK
9..... RF

84. [Q71] Are <you/they> currently . . .

1..... A student => GO TO Q79
2..... A homemaker => GO TO Q79
3..... Disabled => GO TO Q79
4..... Temporarily laid off => GO TO Q79
5..... Retired => GO TO Q79
6..... Other, specify [O_Q71] => GO TO Q79
8..... DK => GO TO Q79
9..... RF => GO TO Q79

85. [Q79] What is the highest level of education <YOU/THEY> have obtained?

1..... 8th grade or less
2..... Some high school
3..... High school graduate
4..... Some college
5..... Technical school graduate
6..... College graduate
7..... Post graduate work
8..... DK
9..... RF

86. [Q81A] Would you describe the head of your household as Hispanic or Latino? (A person of Cuban, Mexican, Puerto Rican, South or Central American, or other Spanish culture or origin, regardless of race.)

1 .....YES
2 .....NO
8 .....DK
9 .....RF

87. [Q81B] Which of the following do you consider yourself/this household member to be?

1 .....White/Caucasian
2 .....Black/African American
3 .....Asian
4 .....American Indian and Alaska Native
5 .....Native Hawaiian and Other Pacific Islander
7 .....OTHER, SPEFICY
8 .....DK
9 .....RF

88. [Q82] Would you/they say you/they are one of the heads of the household?

1 .....Yes
2 .....No
8 .....DK
9 .....RF

[PREND] END OF THE PERSON ROSTER YOU HAVE FINISHED <PERNO>
IN A <Q65> PERSON HOUSEHOLD (18 OR OLDER)
YOU MUST COLLECT INFO FOR ALL <Q65> ADULTS.

1 .....GO TO NEXT PERSON
2 .....DONE WITH HH MEMBERS

89. [Q84] For statistical purposes, was your total household income last year, before taxes and including all household members, above or below $50,000?

1 .....Under $50,000 a year
2 .....Over $50,000 a year
8 .....DK
9 .....RF

IF NEEDED or IF Q84 = 9: I understand if you feel uncomfortable answering this question. However, we only ask about income to ensure all households are equally represented in our survey. Your answer is completely confidential and only used as part of this research study in combination with other households across the country. Was your household income last year above or below $50,000?

IF RF A 2ND TIME, CONTINUE WITH THE SURVEY

IF THEY PROVIDE AN ANSWER, BE SURE TO SAY THANK YOU!

90. [Q85] IF UNDER $50K Stop me when I say an income category that best matches your household income…

01 .....Under $7,000 a year
02 .....$7,000 - $9,999 a year
03 .....$10,000 - $14,999 a year
04 .....$15,000 - $19,999 a year
05 .....$20,000 - $24,999 a year
06 .....$25,000 - $34,999 a year
07 .....$35,000 - $49,999 a year
98 .....DK
99 .....RF

IF Q85 = 99: IF NEEDED: This more specific detail is used to analyze the data and will not be used for any purpose outside this study.

IF RF A 2ND TIME, CONTINUE WITH THE SURVEY

IF THEY PROVIDE AN ANSWER, BE SURE TO SAY THANK YOU!

91. [Q86] IF OVER $50K Stop me when I say an income category that best matches your household income…

08..... $50,000 - $64,999 a year
09..... $65,000 - $79,999 a year
10..... $80,000 - $99,999 a year
11..... $100,000 - $119,999 a year
12..... $120,000 - $149,999 a year
13..... $150,000 and over
98..... DK
99 RF

IF Q86 = 99: IF NEEDED: This more specific detail is used to analyze the data and will not be used for any purpose outside this study.

92. [Q87] Do you own or rent your home?

1..... Own
2..... Rent
8..... DK
9..... RF

93. [Q88] How long have you lived in your present home? RANGE 0-80 IF LESS THEN ONE YEAR, ENTER ZERO

98..... DK
99..... RF

94. [Q89] Which of the following best describes your home?

1..... Single family detached home
2..... Apartment or condominium
3..... Mobile home
6..... Duplex or townhouse
8..... DK
9..... RF

95. [CLPHL] How many mobile or cell phones does your household have? RANGE 0-20

98..... DK
99..... RF

[PHNLNS] Do you have a landline in your household? Please do not include cell phones in this total.

1 Yes
2 No
8 Don't Know
9 Refused

96. [Q92] Do you or any member of your household have a business that is operated from home?

1 .....YES
2 .....NO => GO TO Q97
8 .....DK => GO TO Q97
9 .....RF => GO TO Q97

97. [Q93] About how many pieces of mail does the business receive each week? RANGE 0-75 VERIFY RESPONSE IF ZERO

98 .....DK
99 .....RF

98. [Q94] About how many pieces of mail does the business send each week? RANGE 0-75 VERIFY RESPONSE IF ZERO

98 .....DK
99 .....RF

99. [SCRP7] Remember, when you do your household diary, we are interested only in household mail, so please do not include this business mail in your diary.

89. [Q97]....We just have a few more questions.

As I mentioned earlier in our conversation, the second part of this study involves daily diaries. In them, you answer detailed questions about the mail your household sends and receives for 7 days. Once you complete the diaries, you will receive your choice of either 100 **Forever Stamps** or a $40 check. You can expect your gift to arrive roughly 10 to 12 weeks after we receive your completed diaries.

As a reminder, your household is assigned to fill out the diaries from [ASSN].

IF THEY ASK HOW LONG IT TAKES, SAY: How long it takes depends on how much mail you receive. The first day of your diary-recording week will take the longest as you become more familiar with the survey. After that, on average, it should only take about 3-5 minutes for each piece of mail. Should you need assistance, we have a USPS hotline available to provide you with step-by-step instructions to assist you and to answer any questions you may have.

IF ASKED: That toll free number is 888-441-8777.
1 Continue
9 RF => GO TO OLIST

100. [GIFT] Which gift would you like to receive for completing the diaries?

2 .....100 Forever Stamps
3 .....Forty Dollars

101. [ASSNC] We'd like for you to answer questions about your household's mail for the week of READ DATE. Is that a good week for you? IF NOT, THEN OFFER NEXT ASSN WEEK. So let me confirm that you understand we'll be mailing you a set of household diaries that you'll complete during your assignment week, which is READ DATE. In appreciation for completing those diaries, we will send you the gift you requested which takes about 10-12 weeks once we receive your completed diaries. Do you have any questions for me about the diaries? ANSWER QUESTIONS AS NEEDED AND CONTINUE

1 CONTINUE TO RFNAM

IF NEEDED – TYPICALLY ONLY NEED THIS KIND OF TERMINATION AT END OF A QUARTER; --IF NOT OKAY, SAY: I'm sorry, but your household was selected to participate the week of <LAST ASSN>. I'm sorry your household is not eligible, but thank you very much for your time and participation. GO TO **INT** CODE AS QA

102. [RESPF RESPL]. "Can you please provide me with your first and last name so the materials can be addressed and mailed correctly?"

[RESPONDENT NAME is moved from RESPF RESPL to RFNAM/RLNAM]

PLEASE ENTER ONLY THE FIRST AND LAST NAME OF THE RESPONDENT. PLEASE DO NOT ENTER MIDDLE INITIAL, MR. OR MRS.

FOR PROCESSING PURPOSES, IT IS IMPORTANT THAT WE HAVE ONLY ONE FIRST AND ONE LAST NAME PER HOUSEHOLD. ANY ADDITIONAL INFORMATION WILL DELAY PROCESSING.

103. [MATRL] Would you prefer your diary materials in English or Spanish?

ASK ONLY IF ANY PORTION OF SURVEY WAS CONDUCTED IN SPANISH. (IF ALL OF SURVEY WAS CONDUCTED IN ENGLISH, PICK "ENGLISH.")

1..... ENGLISH
2..... SPANISH

104. [DIFHP] A few days after we mail your diaries, we want to call to make sure you've received them and also to remind you of the dates we need you to track your mail. When we do this, should we call you at this number or is there a different number where you would prefer to be called? READ THE NUMBER TO RESPONDENT

1..... YES, THE NUMBER IS OK ->THANK
2..... NO, CALL DIFFERENT NUMBER ->OTHPH

[OTHPH]- NEED TO COLLECT DIFFERENT NUMBER]

IF OTHPH PROVIDED - NEXT QUESTION => GO TO [THANK]
IF NOT PROVIDED - NEXT QUESTION => GO TO [EMAIL]

[EMAIL] **[IF OTHPH is left blank**] Since no phone was entered, maybe it would be easier for us to contact you via email to remind you about your diary dates. Please enter the email address you prefer we use:

[PHONE1] **[IF EMAIL and OTHPH is left blank**] We understand not wanting to share personal information, like phone numbers and email addresses. It's important that we have a way to reach you to remind you about your diary tracking, and also to answer any questions you have about the study. All information collected in the Household Diary Study is confidential and we do not sell, rent, loan or in any way share personal information with anyone. Please provide the phone number or email address you prefer we use.

1 Provide Phone -> OTHPH
2 Provide email -> EMAIL
9 Will not provide -> INT99 OR THANK (end question)

105. [CB] What would be a good day and time to call you back? => GO TO NAME

106. [NAME] Who should I ask for when I call back? => GO TO END

107. **[THANK]** Thank you very much for your participation. I have a toll free phone number where you can reach us– would you like to write it down? IF RESPONDENT WANTS NUMBER, READ SLOW ENOUGH FOR THEM TO WRITE That number is 1-888-441-8777. Goodbye and have a nice evening/day.

108. [INT03] Although you do not wish to continue with our survey, we appreciate the time you have given us today. Thank you and goodbye.

RF .....Refused to do diaries => GO TO END

109. [INT10] Thank you very much for your time. I'm sorry if we inconvenienced you, but we need to attempt to contact the household currently using the other mailing address. Have a nice evening/day. Goodbye. IF NEEDED: For this survey, the USPS has randomly selected households based on their mailing address. If you have any questions, please call 1-888-441-8777.

QN……Not qualified due to address change => GO TO END (QN=wrong address if street address different from sample file)

110. [OLIST] IF REFUSES TO PARTICIPATE In DIARY STUDY: Would you please tell me why you do not want to participate in our survey? OPEN END => INT03 code as RF

111. [INTRO] Hello, this is _____, calling on behalf of the U.S. Postal Service. May I please speak with<NAME>? We began an interview concerning your household's mail and I would like to complete that interview now.

IF THERE IS NO NAME HERE, THEN THIS IS NOT A PARTIAL SO RESTART

2=CONTINUE WHERE I LEFT OFF

1=RESTART AT THE BEGINNING

112. [INT] ENTER FINAL DISPOSITION.

END OF QUARTER ONLY: IF YOU ARE HERE BECAUSE THE RESPONDENT CANNOT DO THE DIARIES THIS QUARTER THEN LEAVE F8 NOTE AND CODE AS QA.

QUOTA FULL: YOU ARE HERE BECAUSE THE REGION IN WHICH THEY LIVE HAS REACHED IT'S QUOTA. SELECT OQ. I'm sorry if we've inconvenienced you, but we have filled the quota for the region in which you live. For this survey, the USPS has randomly selected households based on their mailing address. If you have any questions, please call 1-888-441-8777. Have a nice evening/day."

CP…….PARITAL COMPLETE => GO TO CB
RP…….PARTIAL REFUSAL => GO TO REFUS
RF…….STRONG REFUSAL => GO TO REFUS
QA…….(INT02) NO ASSN DATES AVAILABLE (ONLY USED AT END OF QTR)
OQ…….OVER QUOTA DUE TO THE REGION WHERE THEY LIVE

113. [INT04] Thank you very much for your time. I'm sorry if we inconvenienced you, but we need households that receive their mail at their home address. Have a nice evening/day. Goodbye.

QM……. DOES NOT RECEIVE MAIL AT HOME ADDRESS => GO TO END

114. [INT99] SURVEY COMPLETE

CM…….COMPLETE

115. [REFU1] ENTER THE REASON THIS RESPONDENT IS REFUSING

1=TIME ISSUES
2=NOT INTERESTED IN TOPIC

3=INTERVIEW TOO LONG
4=SUSPICIOUS OF NUSTATS OR SURVEY
5=DON'T FEEL THEIR INFO IS VALUABLE
7=OTHER, SPECIFY
8=DK

116. [REFUS] ENTER THE REASON THIS RESPONDENT IS REFUSING

1=RESPONDENT YELLING
2=RESPONDENT USING PROFANITY
3=RESPONDENT THREATENING
4=INBOUND REFUSAL
5=RESPONDENT ASKED TO BE TAKEN OF LIST
7=OTHER, SPECIFY
8=DK

Appendix C2: Diary Package - Advance Letter – Extra Incentive

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE

March 12, 2019

«SAMPN»-«REPLICATE»
Postal Resident
«ADDRESS» «HSUIT»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP»
«»

The U.S. Postal Service is guided by one principle: we exist to serve our customers. This vision is our commitment to ensuring a vital Postal Service for future generations.

To assist us in meeting that commitment, your household, along with others in your area, has been selected to be included in our 31st annual Household Diary Study for 2018. This is a two-part study where we would like you to answer questions about your household's mail, and to record information about the mail your household sends and receives for a one-week period. Ultimately, your responses will help us make important decisions about performance improvements and investments in new equipment, facilities, programs, and technologies to better serve you.

We will make your participation as convenient as possible in being part of the Household Diary Study:

Online – This is the simplest and most convenient; you can complete the initial questionnaire about your household and the mail you send and receive any time you want by going to: **http://surveys.nustats.com/USPSWEB.htm** and enter **PIN #: «SAMPN».**

Phone – Within the next few days, we will call you to answer any questions you might have and conduct the initial interview, or make an appointment to do the interview when convenient to you.

All information collected is strictly confidential in order to protect your privacy.

The second part of the study involves recording information about your household's mail for one week. We will provide your household with diaries in which to record this information, along with easy-to-read instructions on how to complete them. Or you can record your mail information online.

As a thank you for your time and participation, once we have received your completed mail information, you will have a choice of ONE of the following:

- **Forty dollars**
- **100 First-Class stamps**

Your household may also have the opportunity to receive an <u>additional</u> incentive of your choice of either a $10 electronic Amazon.com gift card or a $10 electronic Wal-Mart gift card that will be sent to you upon receipt of your diary packet!

For any questions about the project or to give us the best phone number and time for reaching you, please visit **www.nustats.com/uspsstudy.htm** anytime, or call our hotline at **1-888-441-8777** between 9am and 9pm Central Standard time Monday through Friday.

Thank you for joining us in the Household Diary Study!

Sincerely,

John F. Mazzone
Manager, USPS Household Diary Study

Voltee para Español →

475 L'Enfant Plaza SW
Washington DC 20260-0010

12 de marzo de 2019

Residente Postal
«ADDRESS» «HSUIT»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP» «SAMPN»-«REPLICATE»

El Servicio Postal de los Estados Unidos se conduce bajo un principio: existimos para servir a nuestros clientes. Esta visión es nuestro compromiso para asegurar un Servicio Postal vital para las futuras generaciones.

Para ayudarnos a alcanzar este compromiso, estamos realizando nuestro 31ª Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios anual. Este es un estudio de dos partes donde quisiéramos que respondieran preguntas sobre el correo de su hogar, y para registrar información sobre el correo que su hogar envía y recibe por un period de una semana. Esta es la razón por la cual su hogar, junto con otros en su área, fue seleccionado para responder preguntas acerca del correo de su hogar y registrar la información acerca de la correspondencia enviada y recibida por su hogar en un período de una semana.

Le proporcionaremos a su hogar unos diarios postales en los cuales podrá registrar esta información, junto con instrucciones de fácil lectura acerca de cómo completarlos. Esta información nos ayudará a entender mejor tendencias actuales en el volumen y tipos de correo que los hogares manejan de forma diaria. Por último, su respuesta nos ayudará a tomar decisiones importantes acerca de mejoras en nuestro desempeño e inversiones en nuevos equipos, instalaciones, programas y tecnologías para servirle mejor.

Como muestra de agradecimiento por su tiempo y participación, una vez que hayamos recibido su información acerca de su correo completado, usted tendrá la opción de recibir uno de los siguientes:

- **Cuarenta dólares**
- **100 Estampillas de primera clase (First-Class)**

Su hogar tambíen puede tener la oportunidad para recibir un incentive adicional de su elección de una tarjeta de regalo electronica de $10 de Amazon.com o una tajeta de relago electronica de $10 de Wal-Mart que se le enviará al recibir sus diarios completados.

Haremos todo lo posible para que su participación se realice de la manera más conveniente para usted. Tiene usted dos opciones para ser parte del Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios:

Internet – Participar por Internet es la opción más fácil y conveniente. En cualquier momento, usted puede completar la primera parte del estudio en la que se le hacen preguntas sobre su hogar y el correo que envía y recibe. Sólo visite **http://surveys.nustats.com/usps/study_info-spanish.htm** e ingrese el **número de PIN: «SAMPN»**.

Teléfono – Dentro de los próximos días, le llamaremos para contestar cualquier pregunta que tenga e iniciar la primera parte del estudio o programar una hora que sea conveniente para usted.

Toda la información recopilada es estrictamente confidencial para proteger su privacidad.

Si tiene cualquier pregunta sobre el estudio o desea proporcionarnos un número telefónico y la hora más conveniente para comunicarnos con usted, por favor visite **http://surveys.nustats.com/usps/study_info-spanish.htm** en cualquier momento, o llame gratis a nuestra línea de asistencia del proyecto al **1-888-441-8777** de lunes a viernes de 9am a 9pm hora central.

¡Agradecemos su participación en el Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios!

Atentamente,

John F. Mazzone
Director, Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios de USPS

Appendix C2: Diary Package - Advance Letter

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March 12, 2019

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Postal Resident
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Toda la información recopilada es estrictamente confidencial para proteger su privacidad.

Si tiene cualquier pregunta sobre el estudio o desea proporcionarnos un número telefónico y la hora más conveniente para comunicarnos con usted, por favor visite **http://surveys.nustats.com/usps/study_info-spanish.htm** en cualquier momento, o llame gratis a nuestra línea de asistencia del proyecto al **1-888-441-8777** de lunes a viernes de 9 am a 9pm hora central.

¡Agradecemos su participación en el Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios!

Atentamente,

John F. Mazzone
Director, Estudio Domiciliario en Diarios de USPS

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Diary Package Cover Letter

USPS Household Diary Study

Dear «LASTNAME» Family,

What is the Household Diary Study?

The Household Diary Study is a national research effort sponsored by the U.S. Postal Service. The information collected from households like yours will be used to help us design systems to use our resources most effectively, develop strategies for making wise decisions, and monitor the effects of electronic technology on regular mail service. Ultimately, the data will be used to find ways of keeping the cost of service at a minimum.

The study is conducted on our behalf by NuStats, a professional research firm in Austin, Texas. NuStats ensures all information collected is strictly confidential and is used for our research purposes only. The information from your household will be used only in combination with data from other participating households.

What are we asking of you?

Answer questions about all the mail and packages your household receives and sends for seven days. We are only interested in the mail you send and receive for the week of **«TDAYS».**

There two ways to participate:

- **You can go online at:**
  - ***http://uspsmailsurvey.com*** *and enter in the pin number* ***«SAMPN»*** *to get started.*
  - *If you have any questions regarding the diaries or the study, you can visit the Survey Website:* ***USPS Diary Study*** *that is located on the online study website.*
  - ***Place your Mail Pieces in the Daily Envelopes*** *(5)* **with the Gift Selection Form** *(6)* **and return using the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope** *(8) and drop in any public U.S. Postal Service mailbox or post office.*

- **Or you can enter your information in this package that is provided for you**. *(Each item is numbered in the top right-hand corner.)*
  - **Read Steps 1-7 in the Instruction Booklet** *(1)* **first** – this is important because it explains how to correctly fill out the Answer Booklets and provides visual examples.
  - **Review the Photo Quick Start** *(2).*
  - **Answer questions from the Question Booklet** *(3)* **by recording the codes in the Answer Booklets**. Do this for all the mail and packages your household receives and sends each day.
  - **Return all completed Answer Booklets** *(4a-4g)* **in the Daily Envelopes** *(5a-5g)***, Mail Pieces, and the Gift Selection Form** *(6)***, stated on the "I'm done…." Postcard** *(7)***, in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope** *(8)* – drop in any public U.S. Postal Service mailbox or post office.

If you have any questions about how to complete the survey, call the USPS Hotline at **1-888-441-USPS (8777)** available 9am-9pm CST (Monday-Friday). You can also email us at: usps@nustats.com.

I would like to thank you again for your participation and willingness to do the research that will help us improve our performance at your local post office.

Sincerely,

John F. Mazzone

John F. Mazzone
Manager, USPS Household Diary Study

(Please allow 10-12 weeks for processing of your gift.)

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Instruction Booklet

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE.

1

Instruction Booklet

PLEASE READ THIS FIRST!

Includes instructions for completing the Answer Booklets and examples of postage and mail markings for each type of mail, behind the color-coded tabs

Common Terms & Questions

Here are definitions of some of the terms that we use throughout the Household Diary materials and the most frequently asked question.

Common Terms

- **Mail Pieces** are the different pieces of mail that you receive and send – letters, bills, postcards, magazines, advertisements, packages, etc.
- **Mail Type** is the category of mail that we ask you to sort your mail into. *(See the list of 6 mail types on page 1 of this booklet.)*
- **Postage** is how the piece of mail was paid for when it was sent. There are three different types of postage: Stamps, Meter, or Permit. *(See the visual examples under the color-coded tabs for each mail type.)*
- **Mail Markings** are markings that are printed on a mail piece either by the U.S. Postal Service or the mailing house. These markings indicate the postage paid and the type of mail. The Postage and Mail Markings are typically located in:
  a) the top right-hand corner of the mail piece,
  b) above or below the address, or
  c) inside the window of an envelope.

What is the difference between First-Class Mail and Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail?

These are the two most common mail types. Here are some ways to help distinguish between them:

- **First-Class Mail** from businesses are often marked "First-Class" or "Presorted First-Class," especially when they don't have stamps. If the mail piece just has a stamp or metered strip without any of these markings, it is likely First-Class Mail.
  Hint: Most letter size envelopes will have postage of 49¢ or more, either in First-Class stamps, a metered strip, or a "Forever Stamp."
  If it is **Presorted First-Class**, it may have less postage but it will say "Presorted First-Class."
  (See pages 5-8 in this booklet for descriptions & more visual examples.)

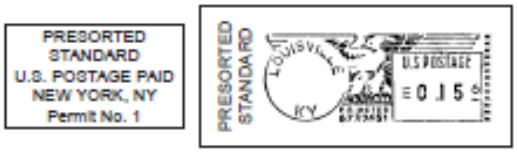
Examples

Presorted First-Class Mail Markings



- **Presorted Standard or Marketing** Mail pieces are always marked "Presorted Standard," or "PRSRT STD," or "Standard," or "STD," or "MKTG," or "PRST MKTG" usually in the upper-right corner of the mail pieces close to the stamp or meter strip.
  (See pages 9-13 in this booklet for descriptions & more visual examples.)

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Markings



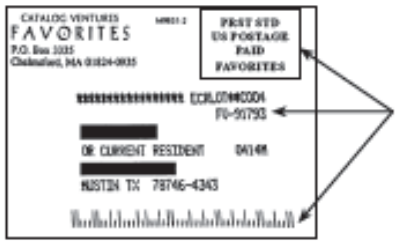
How to fill out the Answer Booklets.

1 Sort your daily mail into groups by mail type.

The first step is to sort your mail each day into groups of mail types by looking at the postage and other markings on your mail (we call these "mail markings"). All the mail you receive can be classified as one of the following 6 types*:

1. **First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail** (Purple pages)
2. **Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail (PRSRT STD or PRSRT MKTG)** (Blue pages)
3. **Nonprofit Organization Mail** (Gray pages)
4. **Packages & Expedited Materials** (Green pages)
5. **Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals** (Yellow pages)
6. **Unaddressed Mail** – Delivered by US Postal Service only (Pink pages)

To Sort: Look at the Postage & Mail Markings



Postage & Mail Markings can be located:

- in the top right-hand corner,
- above or below the address, or
- inside the window of an envelope.

***To help you sort your mail, see the examples of postage and mail markings under the colored tab associated with each mail type.**

We are only interested in your household mail and packages:

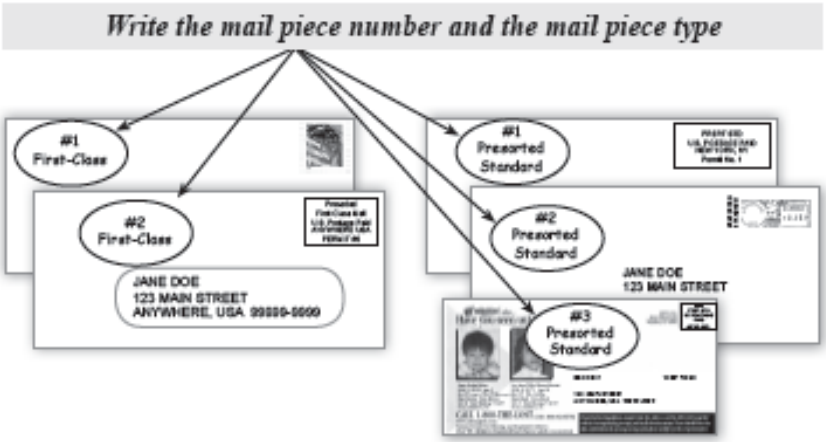
- Please DO NOT include any mail received or sent for a business, club, or association operated from your home.
- DO NOT include any mail sent to your PO Box.
- Please DO include household mail or packages that you send or receive at another location, for instance at work.

Special Circumstances

- If you did not receive or send any mail or packages, or if there was no mail service one day during your assigned week, put an "X" in the box labeled "Did Not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today" on page 1 of the Answer Booklet for that day.
- If household members will be away from home on any day(s) during the diary week, record all mail received in the daily answer booklet for the day on which you return.
- If you forget to pick up your mail for a day, record all mail received on the next day.
- You may not receive mail on Sunday, but you may receive packages and/or send mail out.

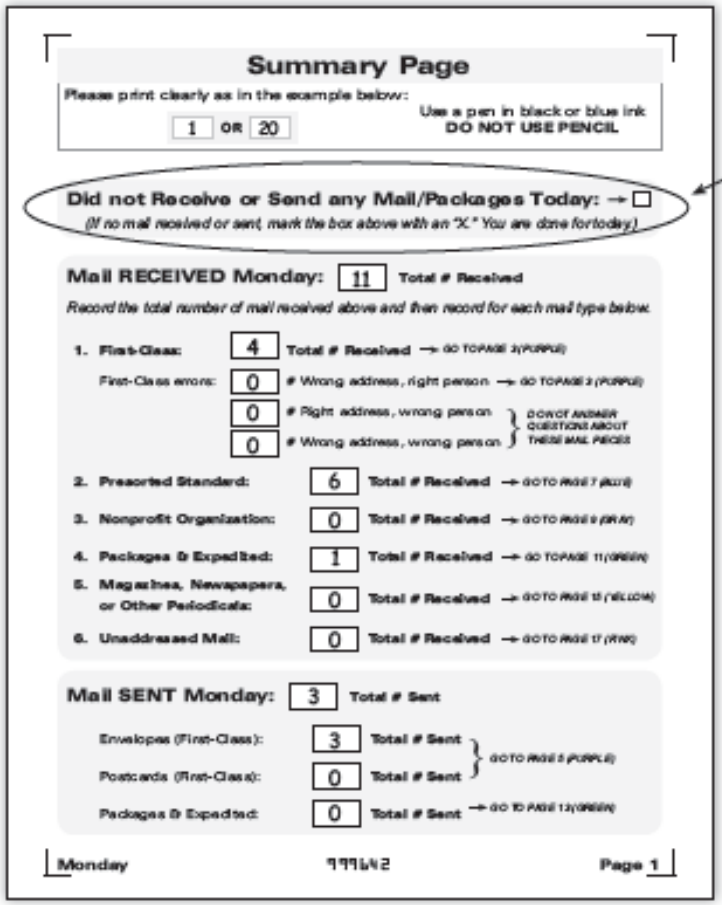
2 Number and label the mail pieces within each mail type.

Once your mail is sorted for that day, write the mail type on each piece of mail and then number the mail pieces within each mail type. For example, the top First-Class mail piece is #1, the next is #2, and so on until you have numbered all First-Class Mail for that day. Next, number all the other types of mail (Presorted Standard, Nonprofit, Packages, etc.) beginning again with #1, and then #2, and so on for each different mail type.



3 Complete the Summary Page (page 1) in the Answer Booklet for each day.

On this page, record the total number of mail pieces of each type that all members of your household received and sent that day. *(See Summary Page example below.)*



Summary Page

Please print clearly as in the example below: 1 OR 20 — Use a pen in black or blue ink. DO NOT USE PENCIL

Did not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today: → ☐
(If no mail received or sent, mark the box above with an "X." You are done for today.)

Mail RECEIVED Monday: 11 Total # Received

Record the total number of mail received above and then record for each mail type below.

1. First-Class: 4 Total # Received → GO TO PAGE 3 (PURPLE)
   First-Class errors: 0 # Wrong address, right person → GO TO PAGE 3 (PURPLE)
   0 # Right address, wrong person
   0 # Wrong address, wrong person
   } DO NOT ANSWER QUESTIONS ABOUT THESE MAIL PIECES
2. Presorted Standard: 6 Total # Received → GO TO PAGE 7 (BLUE)
3. Nonprofit Organization: 0 Total # Received → GO TO PAGE 9 (GRAY)
4. Packages & Expedited: 1 Total # Received → GO TO PAGE 11 (GREEN)
5. Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals: 0 Total # Received → GO TO PAGE 15 (YELLOW)
6. Unaddressed Mail: 0 Total # Received → GO TO PAGE 17 (PINK)

Mail SENT Monday: 3 Total # Sent

Envelopes (First-Class): 3 Total # Sent
Postcards (First-Class): 0 Total # Sent
} GO TO PAGE 5 (PURPLE)
Packages & Expedited: 0 Total # Sent → GO TO PAGE 13 (GREEN)

Monday 99962 Page 1

If you did not receive or send any mail or packages, or if there was no mail service one day during your assigned week:
Put an "X" in the box labeled "Did not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today" on the summary page for that day.

4 Open both the Question Booklet and the Answer Booklet for that day to the colored pages for the type of mail piece you have.

You will use a different Answer Booklet for each day of the week, but you use the same Question Booklet each day. Read the questions from the Question sheet (in the Question Booklet) and find the correct answers (number codes), then write them on the Answer sheet in the Answer Booklet. There are colored pages for each mail type: First-Class Mail is purple, Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail is blue, etc. You can record up to 12 mail pieces for each mail type. **Remember, the postage on the mail piece determines which colored Question and Answer sheets to use.**

1. In the Answer Booklet for that day, write in the answer on the Answer Sheet using the correct number code found in the Question Booklet.
2. Starting with mail piece #1, Question A, write the codes under column #1. Using the Question Booklet, continue down the page to Question B.
3. After you are finished answering questions for mail piece #1, continue on to the questions for mail piece #2 in column #2. Continue in this way for each mail piece within each type.

Question Sheet (in Question Booklet)


Question Sheet

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Purple

For Presorted Standard Mail: Go to Blue page 7

A. FORM: Was the mail piece...

B. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

C. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

E. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece?

More questions on back of page →

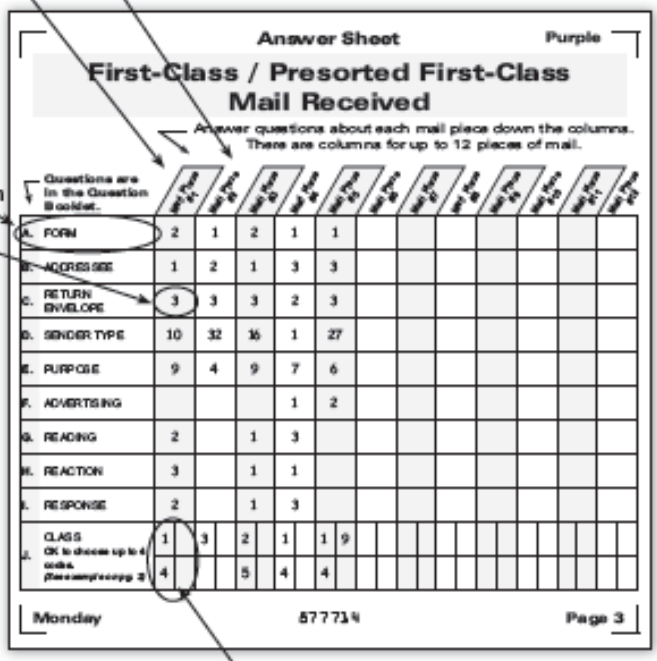
Answer Sheet (in Answer Booklet)

Mail Piece #1

Mail Piece #2

Question

Code


Answer Sheet

Purple

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns. There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM	2	1	2	1	1							
B. ADDRESSEE	1	2	1	3	3							
C. RETURN ENVELOPE	3	3	3	2	3							
D. SENDER TYPE	10	32	16	1	27							
E. PURPOSE	9	4	9	7	6							
F. ADVERTISING				1	2							
G. READING	2		1	3								
H. REACTION	3		1	1								
I. RESPONSE	2		1	3								
J. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes.	1	3	2	1	1	9						
	4		5	4	4							

Monday 87771¼ Page 3

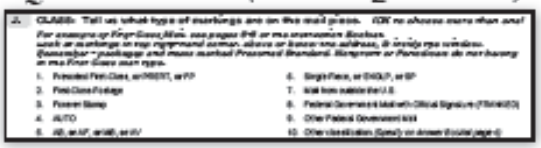
For questions where it is "OK to choose more than one," you can record up to four codes.

Mail Markings are important.

Tell us which mail markings are on the mail piece by answering the "Class" question at the end of each Question sheet (e.g., Question J for First-Class Mail).

To accurately answer this question, you need to record all the mail markings that are on each mail piece – these markings are placed on the mail piece either by the U.S. Postal Service or by a mailing house.

Question J - Class (First-Class Question sheet)



5 Please send us your mail pieces.

We only need the envelope your mail came in, not the contents (unless it's something you don't need).
Please DO NOT CUT OUT the individual mail markings.

- **Remember to label each mail piece with the number and mail type you assigned it in the Answer Booklet** so we are able to match it to your responses.
- **If the mail piece is a catalog, magazine, flyer, or newspaper, just send the page with the mailing label and the postage.** We don't need the entire catalog or newspaper, etc.

Why do we need your mail pieces?

If we have your mail markings for each piece, we can double check that everything is correct. Each packet goes through an editing process that verifies that the mail pieces were recorded under the correct mail type (First-Class, Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail, etc.) and that all the questions were answered. The entire mail piece (i.e., the envelope) provides us with additional survey information, such as sender type.

All information collected is strictly confidential and is used for research purposes only.

6 Place your completed Answer Booklets and mail pieces in the envelopes marked Monday through Sunday.

Your completed Answer Booklets and mail pieces labeled with the mail type and mail piece number should be placed in the corresponding daily envelope.

7 Place the daily envelopes in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope.

The daily envelopes with your completed Answer Booklets and mail pieces should be sent to NuStats in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope.

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received and Sent (Purple)

All First-Class Mail may not say "First-Class" on the envelope or postcard. It is important to look at the postage and mail markings on each mail piece to determine if it is First-Class or not. Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- Include letter size envelopes marked "**First-Class**" or "**Presorted First-Class**."
- Include large envelopes marked "**First-Class**." Check the mail markings carefully; some large envelopes may be marked Presorted Standard or Expedited.
- Most First-Class Mail from businesses are marked "**First-Class**" or "**Presorted First-Class,**" especially when they have a metered strip and NOT a stamp.
- If the mail piece just has a stamp without being marked "**First-Class**" or "**Presorted First-Class,**" (or Presorted Standard or Nonprofit, etc.) it is probably First-Class Mail.
- Most letter size envelopes will have postage of 49¢ or more, either in stamps or on a metered strip (the postage may also be in the form of a "Forever Stamp"). If it is "**Presorted First-Class,**" it may have less postage but it will be marked as "Presorted First-Class."
- Postcards *usually* have 34¢ postage for First-Class. Some postcards are larger in size than a typical picture postcard. However, if it is larger than the postcard dimensions (see page 2 of the Question Booklet), then it is considered a flyer.
- The most common First-Class Mail pieces are letters, bills, postcards, greeting cards, checks, and money orders.
- Include mail *(that is not a package)* sent with special services, such as Certified, Registered, or Insured.
- Include magazines, catalogs, newsletters, or other periodicals that are marked "**First-Class**."

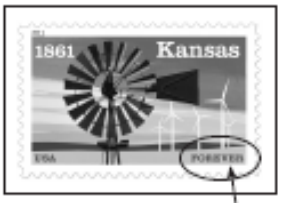
Examples of First-Class Mail postage and markings begin on the next page.

First-Class Mail Examples

First-Class or Forever Stamp

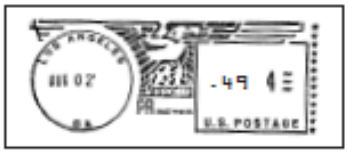


First-Class Stamp



Forever Stamp

Look for "Forever" somewhere on the stamp.



First-Class Metered Strip

FIRST-CLASS MAIL
U.S. POSTAGE PAID
COMPANY NAME
PERMIT #000

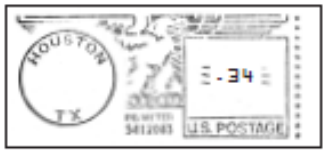
First-Class Permit



First-Class Postcard Stamp

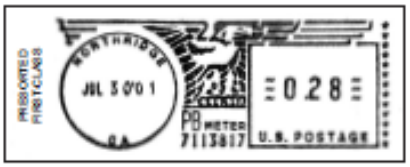


Metered Postcard



Metered Postcard

Presorted First-Class, PRSRT, or FP



"Presorted First-Class" Metered Strip

Presorted
First-Class Mail
U.S. Postage Paid
Mailed from Zip Code 27101
PERMIT #000

"Presorted First-Class" Permit



"Presorted First-Class" Stamp

PRSRT
First-Class Mail
U.S. Postage Paid
PERMIT #000

5698 1 AUTO 0.305

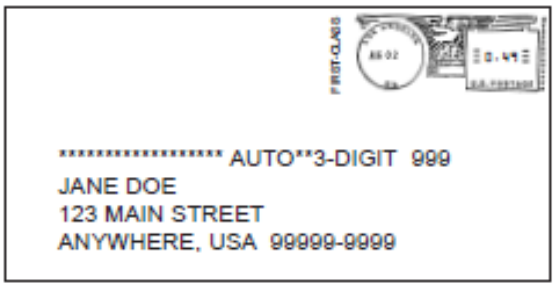
JANE DOE
123 MAIN STREET
ANYWHERE, USA 99999-9999

Look for "Presorted First-Class" on a Permit, a Stamp, or a Metered Strip

Hint: Find closest match

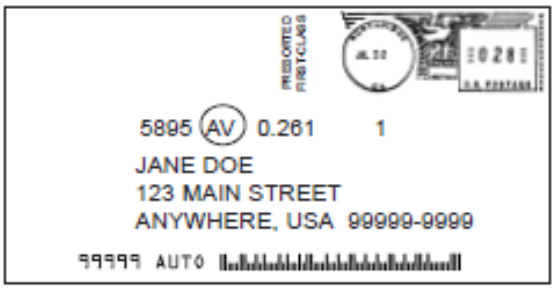
First-Class Mail Examples

AUTO



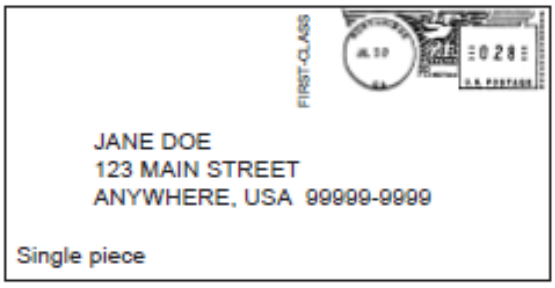
"AUTO" above or below the address

AB, or AF, or MB, or AV

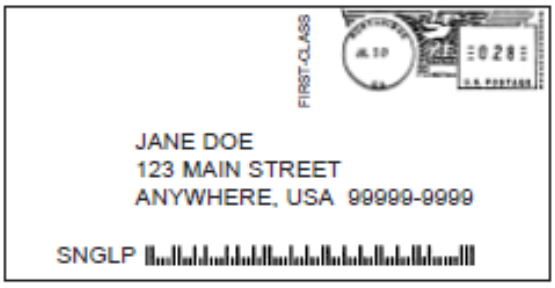


"AB, or AF, or MB, or AV"
above address

Single Piece, or SNGLP, or SP



"First-Class" left of Metered Strip
"Single piece" in lower left corner



"First-Class" left of Metered Strip
"SNGLP" left of Barcode

Note: Many additional mail markings may appear above or below the address, inside the window of an envelope, or near the postage on a mail piece.

Hint: Find closest match

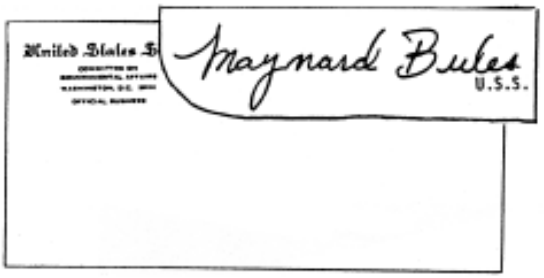
First-Class Mail Examples

Mail from outside the U.S.

AIR MAIL

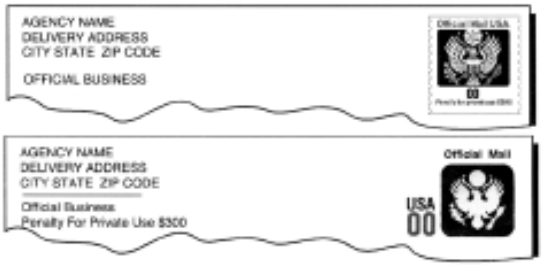
JANE DOE
123 MAIN STREET
ANYWHERE, USA 99999-9999

Federal Government Mail (Franked)



"Official Government Signature" (Franked)

Other Federal Government Mail



FIRST-CLASS MAIL
POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
AGENCY NAME
PERMIT NO.G-999

PRESORTED
FIRST-CLASS MAIL
POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
AGENCY NAME
PERMIT NO.G-99

Marked "Official Mail" or Government Permit Number

Hint: Find closest match

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail (Blue)

Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- Include mail ***(that is not a package)*** that is marked "**Presorted Standard**," or "**PRSRT STD**," or "**Standard**," or "**STD**," or "**MKTG**," or "**PRST MKTG**" whether it is a letter, postcard, large envelope, magazine, catalog, circular, or flyer, etc.
- Most **catalogs** are sent Presorted Standard. However, check to make sure it is marked "Presorted Standard," or "PRSRT STD," or "Standard," or "STD," or "MKTG," or "PRST MKTG." Catalogs that are in envelopes marked "Bound Printed Matter" or items marked "Media Mail" or "Library Mail" should be recorded under "Packages & Expedited Materials" (Green pages).

Advertising often comes as a group of flyers, circulars, coupons, or other pieces that are not in an envelope.* These types of advertisements can be delivered in two different ways:

1. Your address may be printed on a **detached label card** that is delivered with separate advertising pieces that are grouped or folded together.

   If you get a detached label card, please record it under "**Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail**," and then record the group of advertising pieces as ONE mail piece (regardless of how many flyers or circulars, etc.) under "**Unaddressed Mail**" on the Pink pages.



2. Your address may be printed directly on the group of advertising pieces.

   Please record the whole group as ONE mail piece under "**Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail**." Record code #7 for Question B and code #2 for Question C.



**Usually from more than one company or advertiser*

Examples of Presorted Standard or Marketing mail markings begin on the next page.

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Examples

Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Marketing, or MKTG



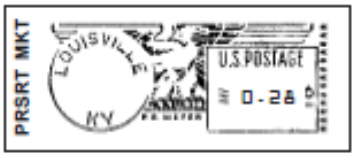
"Presorted Standard"
on Metered Strip



"PRSRT STD"
on Metered Strip



"Standard"
on Metered Strip



"PRSRT MKT"
on Metered Strip



"Presorted Std"
on Stamp

PRESORTED STANDARD
U.S. POSTAGE PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"Presorted Standard"
on Permit

PRSRT STD
U.S. POSTAGE
PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"PRSRT STD"
on Permit

PRESORTED MKTG
U.S. POSTAGE PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"PRESORTED MKTG"
on Permit

PRSRT MKT
U.S. POSTAGE
PAID
NEW YORK, NY
Permit No. 1

"PRSRT MKT"
on Permit

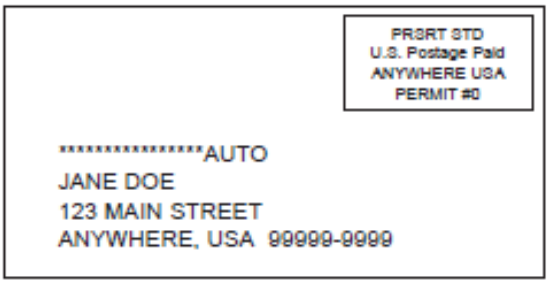
Hint: Find closest match

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Examples

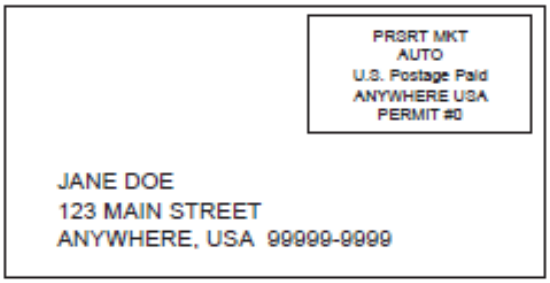
Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., AUTO may appear with a Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Marketing, or MKTG permit or meter strip).

Also, AUTO, Carrier Route Presort, or CAR-RT SORT may appear in the permit area in the top right-hand corner of the mail piece.

AUTO

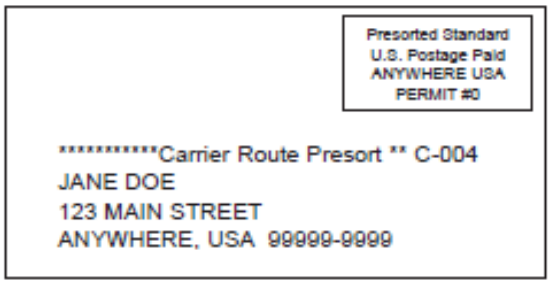


"AUTO" above address

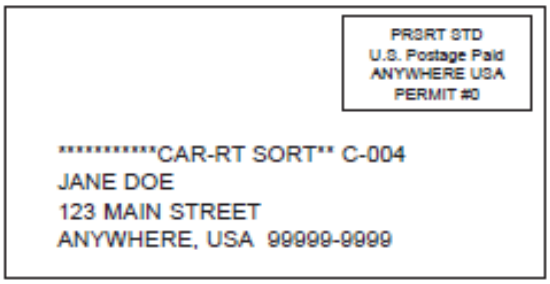


"AUTO" inside permit

Carrier Route Presort, or CAR-RT SORT



"Carrier Route Presort"



"CAR-RT SORT"

Hint: Find closest match

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Examples

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., ECR may appear with a Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Marketing, or MKTG permit or meter strip).

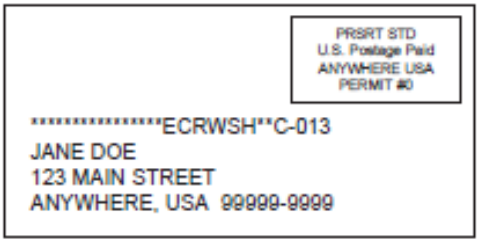
ECR with LOT, WSS, or WSH



"ECRLOT" above address



"ECRWSS" above address



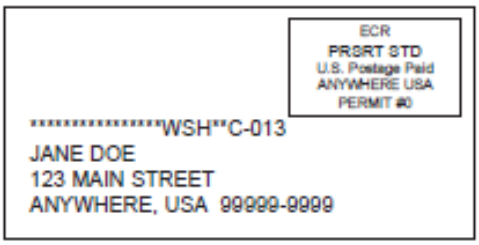
"ECRWSH" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "LOT" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSS" above address



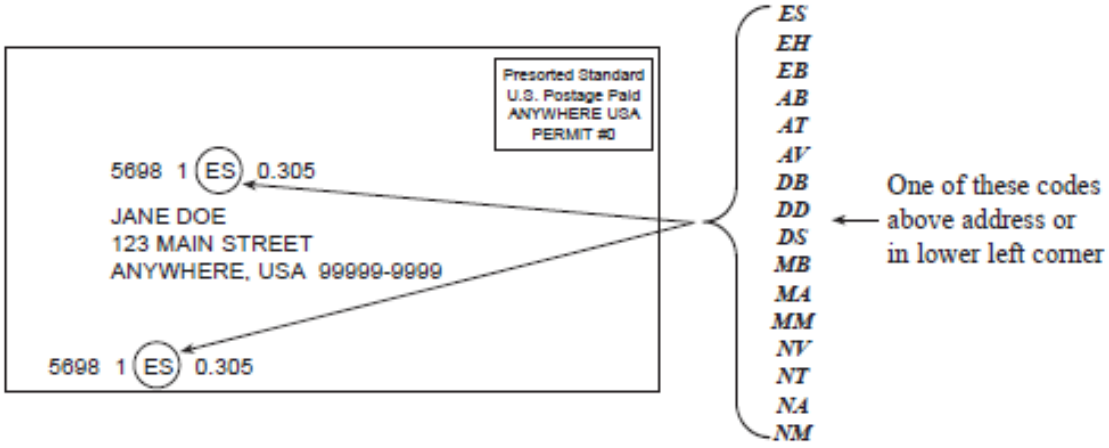
"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSH" above address

Hint: Find closest match

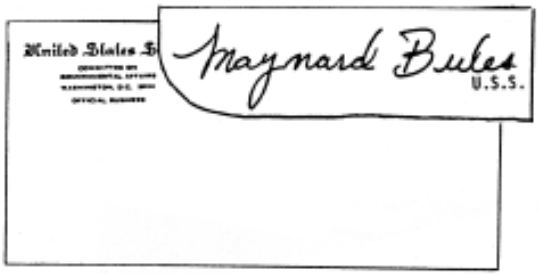
Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Examples

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., ES may appear with a Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Marketing, or MKTG permit or meter strip).

ES, EH, EB, AB, AT, AV, DB, DD, DS, MB, MA, MM, NV, NT, NA, NM

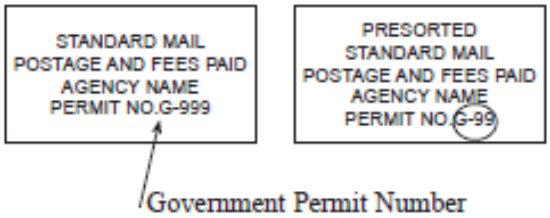


Federal Government Mail (Franked)



"Official Government Signature" (Franked)

Other Federal Government Mail



Government Permit Number

Hint: Find closest match

Nonprofit Organization Mail (Gray)

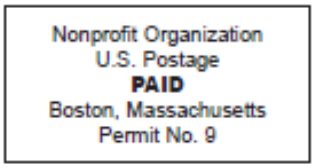
Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- All Nonprofit Mail (that is not a package) must be marked "**Nonprofit Organization**," "**Nonprofit Org.**," or "**Nonprofit.**"
- A few examples of Nonprofit Organizations are charities, schools, hospitals, churches, etc.
- Nonprofit Organization Mail may include requests for donations of money, your time, or other items, or they may be asking you to purchase an item or service.
- **Do not include** packages that are marked Nonprofit Organization. These should be recorded under "**Packages & Expedited Materials**" (Green pages).

Examples of Nonprofit postage & mail markings begin on the next page.

Nonprofit Organization Mail Examples

Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit



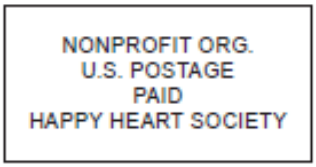
"Nonprofit Organization" on Permit



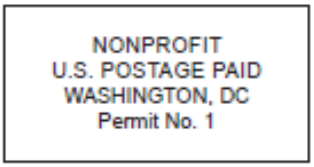
"Nonprofit Org." on Metered Strip



"Nonprofit Org." on Stamp



"Nonprofit Org." on Permit

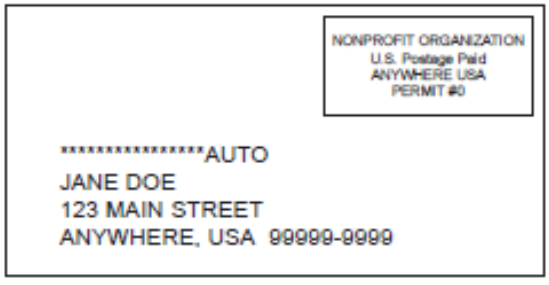


"Nonprofit" on Permit

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., AUTO may appear with a Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit permit or meter strip.)

Also, AUTO may appear in the permit area in the top right-hand corner of the mail piece.

AUTO



"AUTO" above address

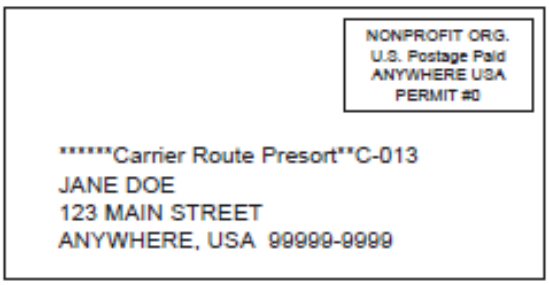
Hint: Find closest match

Nonprofit Organization Mail Examples

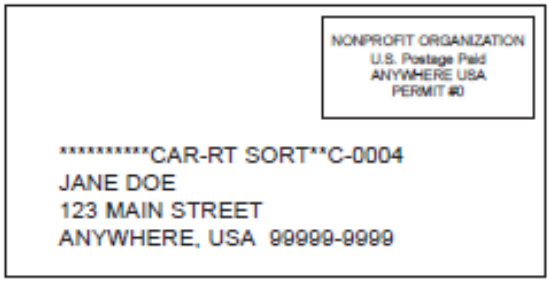
Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., CAR-RT SORT may appear with a Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit permit or meter strip).

Also, Carrier Route Presort or CAR-RT SORT may appear in the permit area in the top right-hand corner of the mail piece.

Carrier Route Presort or CAR-RT SORT



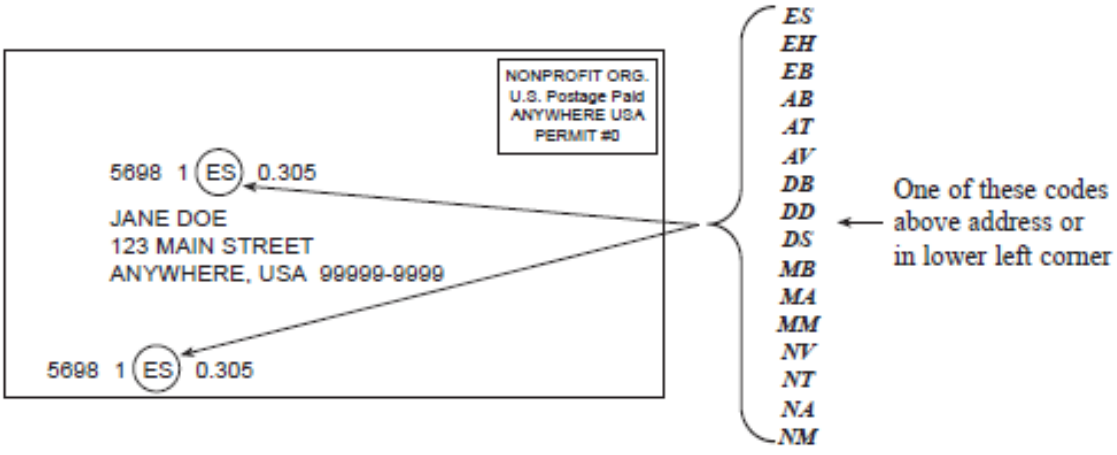
"Carrier Route Presort" above address



"CAR-RT SORT" above address

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., ES may appear with a Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit permit or meter strip).

ES, EH, EB, AB, AT, AV, DB, DD, DS, MB, MA, MM, NV, NT, NA, NM



Hint: Find closest match

Nonprofit Organization Mail Examples

Note: Many of the markings may appear with any of the permit types (i.e., ECR may appear with a Nonprofit Organization, Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit permit or meter strip).

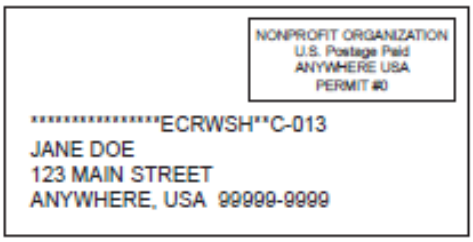
ECR with LOT, WSS, or WSH



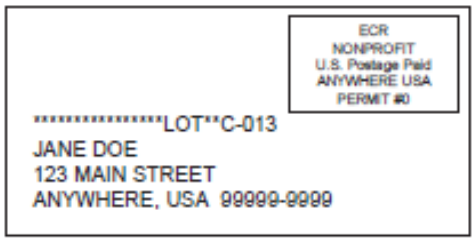
"ECRLOT" above address



"ECRWSS" above address



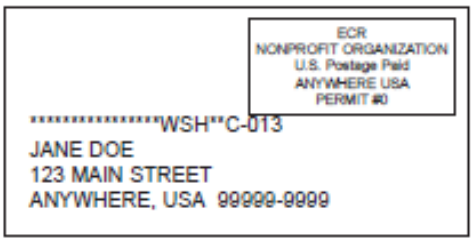
"ECRWSH" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "LOT" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSS" above address



"ECR" on Permit *and* "WSH" above address

Hint: Find closest match

Packages & Expedited Materials Received & Sent (Green)

Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

Packages (even if marked First-Class, Presorted Standard, etc.):

- Include ALL packages or boxes received or sent via the U.S. Postal Service (USPS) as well as packages delivered by any other organization, such as the United Parcel Service (UPS), FedEx, etc. Be careful to distinguish between packages delivered by the U.S. Postal Service (USPS) whose markings include an Eagle, and those delivered by the United Parcel Service (UPS) whose markings have a shield.

- Include all **packages and parcels** even if marked "First-Class", "PRSRT STD", or "Non-Profit".

- Include catalogs that are marked "**Bound Printed Matter**" or "**PRSRT BPM**", or other packages marked "**Parcel Select**", "**PS Lightweight**", "**Media Mail**", or "**Standard Post**".

- Record all personal packages received and sent at home and other locations such as work, or at the U.S. Post Office, etc. (Do not include packages sent and received on behalf of a household members place of employment or a business.)

Packages from Amazon:

- You may receive packages ordered from Amazon.com, but please be sure to look closely at the shipping label, as most times they are marked with U.S. Postal Service postage, such as Parcel Select or PS Lightweight, or marked with another carrier's shipping label such as FedEx. In these cases Amazon was not the delivery company. In some cases, Amazon does use their own shipping label and postage.

Expedited Letters, Packages, and Boxes:

- Include letters, packages, and boxes that were delivered by any expedited mail carrier (**see examples on the next page**), which include the U.S. Postal Service (USPS), United Parcel Service (UPS), or FedEx.

- You may see terms such as Priority Mail Express, Priority Mail, Overnight, 2-day, 3-day, Next Day Air, 2nd Day Air, etc.

Package & Expedited Examples

Priority Mail Express



PS Lightweight



Marked "PS Lightweight"
or "Parcel Select Lightweight"

Parcel Select



Marked "Parcel Select"

Priority Mail



Bound Printed Matter



Marked "BPM" or "Bound Printed Matter"





Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals (Yellow)

Use the following to help you determine if a Magazine, Newspaper, or other Periodical should be recorded under this type:

- Examples include daily, weekly, and monthly magazines; alumni or fraternal magazines; and newspapers or other publications that household members may subscribe to.
- Include magazines, newspapers, or other periodicals marked "**Periodicals Postage Paid.**"
- **Only** include magazines, newspapers, or other periodicals that are delivered by the U.S. Postal Service (USPS) and that are NOT marked First-Class, Presorted Standard, or Nonprofit Organization. If they are marked with any of these other postage types, record them under the section for that mail type.

Do not include the following items under this section:

- Newspapers delivered by your local news carrier. (Do not include these in the diary study.)
- Magazines and newspapers you bought at the store or a newsstand. (Do not include these in the diary study.)
- Catalogs, which are typically sent "Presorted Standard (PRSRT STD)." (Check the postage type; these will likely be recorded in the Presorted Standard section.)
- Catalogs marked "PRSRT BPM" or "Presorted Bound Printed Matter" will be recorded in the Packages and Expedited Materials (Green pages).

Unaddressed Mail
(Pink)

Use the following to help you determine if your mail piece should be recorded under this type:

- Only include mail delivered by the U.S. Postal Service (USPS). **Do not include** advertising material that has been left at your door, or material hung on your doorknob or left on your car.

- Include mail pieces that don't have any postage or an address label. If a mail piece is labeled "Occupant" or "Resident," do not include it in this section because it most likely is marked "PRST STD" or "Presorted Standard," or "Presorted Marketing," or "MKTG."

- Typically, Unaddressed Mail will only be weekly advertising flyers/circulars that are folded or grouped together and do not have an address label or postage on each piece. Simply record the whole group as ONE mail piece. They are usually accompanied by a detached label card marked "PRST STD" or "Presorted Standard," or "PRST MKTG."

(Please refer to page 9 in this booklet for additional information on recording unaddressed mail that comes along with a detached label card.)

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Photo Quick Start

PHOTO QUICK START







Postage & Mail Markings can be:

- in the top right-hand corner,
- above or below the address, or
- inside the window of an envelope.

Use the Postage & Mail Markings on your mail to help you sort!



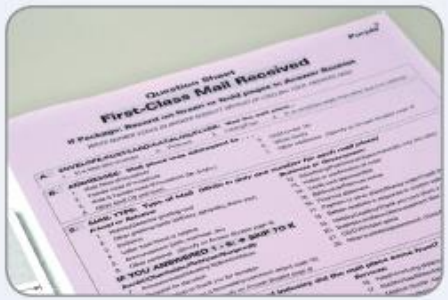
1 Sort your mail each day into the 6 types of mail listed on page 1 of the **Instruction Booklet.**

2 Label and number each mail piece within the 6 types of mail. (Photo shows First-Class only).



3 Open the **Answer Booklet** for Monday (or first mail day) to page 1 - Summary Page.

Record the total number of mail pieces you received that day for each mail type.



4 Open the **Question Booklet** to page 3 - First-Class Mail Received.

If you didn't receive any First-Class Mail that day, skip to page 5: First-Class Mail Sent, or page 7: Presorted Standard Mail, or other pages for mail types you did receive.



5 Write your answers to the questions from the Question Booklet in the **Answer Booklet**.

Be sure to record mail for each mail type you receive (Monday-Sunday) on the color-coded pages for that mail type.

Questions? **Visit the project web page: www.nustats.com/uspsstudy.htm, call our USPS Hotline at: 1-888-441-USPS (8777), or e-mail your question to USPS@nustats.com**

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Question Booklet

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE.

3

Question Booklet

Use with Answer Booklets (Monday-Sunday)

Questions? Call our toll-free hotline at:

1-888-441-USPS (8777)

Available 11am - 9pm Central Standard Time (Mon - Wed)
11am - 5pm Central Standard Time (Thu & Fri)
12pm - 5pm Central Standard Time (Sat & Sun)

OR

e-mail your question to:

USPS@nustats.com

OR

visit the project web page at:

www.nustats.com/uspsstudy.htm

Table of Contents

	Color	Page
Example	White	1
Mail Piece Size Template	White	2
Question Sheets:		
First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received	Purple	3
First-Class Mail Sent	Purple	5
Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Received	Blue	7
Nonprofit Organization Mail Received	Gray	9
Packages & Expedited Materials Received	Green	11
Packages & Expedited Materials Sent	Green	13
Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals	Yellow	15
Unaddressed Mail Received	Pink	17

Example

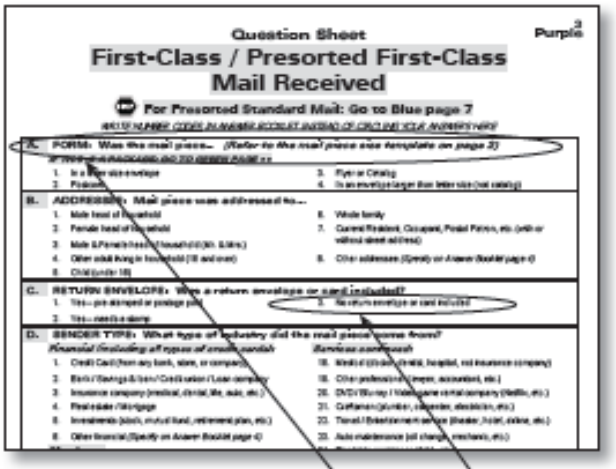
Once you've sorted and numbered your mail pieces, you are ready to begin recording information. Remember to use the postage and the mail markings on the mail piece to help you determine the mail type ***(see page 1 of the Instruction Booklet for how to sort and number your mail)***.

You need both this Question Booklet and the Answer Booklet. Open both this Question Booklet and the Answer Booklet to the color-coded pages for the type of mail you have (e.g., purple pages are First-Class Mail, blue pages are Standard or Marketing Mail, etc.).

Each question sheet contains both questions (letters A, B, C, etc.) and answer codes (numbers 1, 2, 3, etc.). **Don't record your answers in this Question Booklet; instead, use the corresponding daily Answer Booklet.** Record the number that best matches your response.

Answer the questions about each mail piece down the answer sheet. For example, if you receive four (4) First-Class mail pieces on Monday, you will record answers to all questions about mail piece #1 in the first column, and about mail piece #2 in the second column, mail piece #3 in the third column, and #4 in the fourth column.

Question Sheet (in Question Booklet)

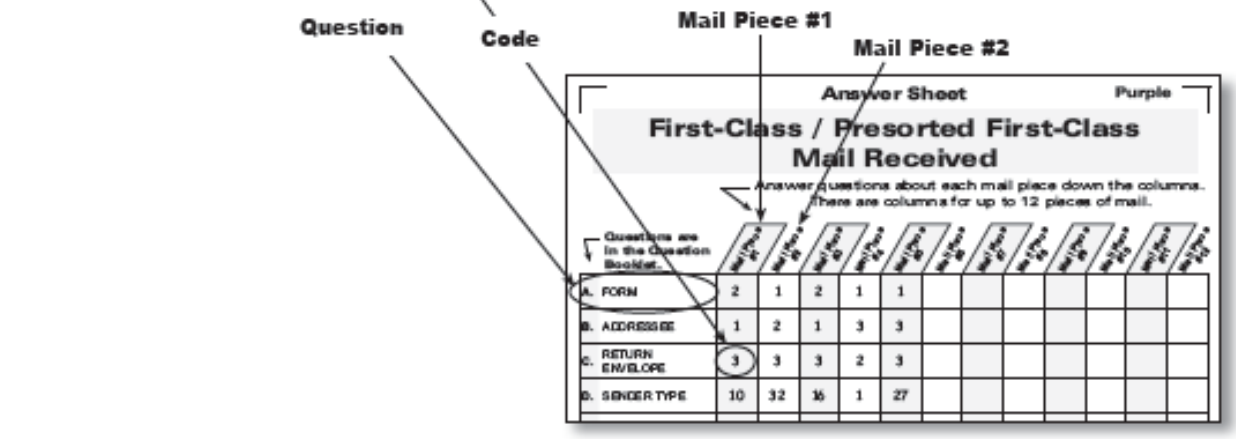


When completing your Answer Booklet, please print clearly as in the example:

1 OR 20

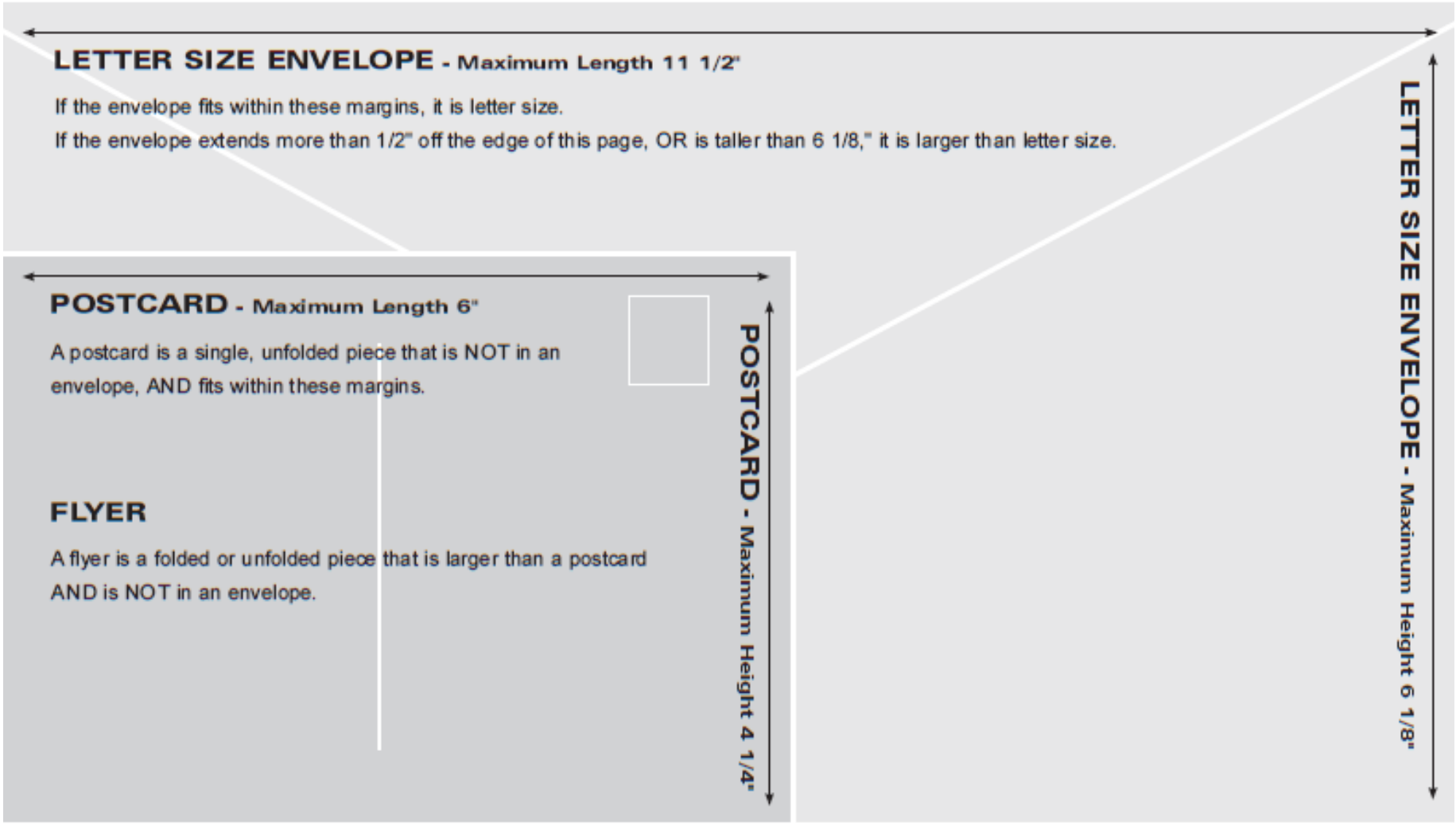
Use a pen in black or blue ink
DO NOT USE PENCIL

Answer Sheet (in Answer Booklet)



Mail Piece Size Template

Use the guide below to help you determine the size of your mail piece. This will help answer the FORM question.



Question Sheet

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received



For Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail: Go to Blue page 7

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 11

1. In a letter size envelope
2. Postcard
3. Flyer or Catalog
4. In an envelope larger than letter size (not catalog)

B. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Male head of household
2. Female head of household
3. More than one head of household
4. Other adult living in household (18 and over)
5. Child (under 18)
6. Whole family
7. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
8. Other addressee *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

C. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, drug store / pharmacy etc.) (*Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 4*)
10. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, L.L. Bean, etc.)
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company

Services continued:

18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. All other nonprofit organizations

Friend or Relative:

32. Friend or Relative (not from a business)

More questions on back of page →

4

First-Class Mail Received *cont.* — Purple

E. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Holiday / Seasons greeting card
2. Other greeting cards (birthday, sympathy, thank you)
3. Invitation or announcement from friend or relative ➔ **SKIP TO J**
4. Letter from friend or relative ➔ **SKIP TO J**
5. Bill / Invoice / Premium (not for a credit card)
6. Financial statement (not for a credit card)
7. Credit card bill / Credit card statement
8. Notice / Announcement / Business invitation (no bills, no ads)
9. Advertising / Promotional / Sales only (no bills) ➔ **SKIP TO G**
10. Insurance explanation of benefits
11. Tax related (information, forms, etc.)
12. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental
13. Request for donation (money, time, blood drive, goods, etc.)
14. Confirmation or thank you for donation
15. Rebate received in response to coupon submitted
16. Direct deposit receipts or check stub (not a payment)
17. New or replacement credit or debit card
18. Payment or other check / Money order / Credit (no rebate)
19. Survey / Questionnaire
20. Sweepstakes / Contest promotion
21. Newsletter
22. Prospectus
23. Social Security related (information, statement, etc.)
24. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

STOP **IF THIS MAIL PIECE WAS FROM A FRIEND OR RELATIVE, SKIP TO J**

F. ADVERTISING: Did this mail piece contain any advertising or promotional material?

1. Yes
2. No ➔ **SKIP TO J**

G. READING: Was the advertising... ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of the household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

H. REACTION: Would this advertising be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

I. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the advertisement?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

J. CLASS: Tell us what type of markings are on the mail piece. ***(OK to choose more than one)***

For example of First-Class Mail, see pages 5-8 of the Instruction Booklet.
Look at markings in top right-hand corner, above or below the address, & inside the window.

1. Presorted First-Class, or PRSRT, or FP
2. First-Class Postage
3. Forever Stamp
4. AUTO
5. AB, or AF, or MB, or AV
6. Single Piece, or SNGLP, or SP
7. Mail from outside the U.S.
8. Federal Government Mail with Official Signature (FRANKED)
9. Other Federal Government Mail
10. Other classification *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 4)*

Remember – packages and pieces marked Presorted Standard, Marketing, Nonprofit, or Periodicals do not belong in the First Class mail type.

Please mark all mail pieces for this day & place in the daily envelope.

Question Sheet

First-Class Mail Sent

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 13

1. In a letter size envelope
2. Postcard
3. In an envelope larger than letter size
4. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

B. ADDRESSEE TYPE: What type of industry did you send the mail piece to?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, drug store / pharmacy, etc.) *(Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 6)*
10. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, L.L. Bean, etc.)
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company

Services continued:

18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. All other nonprofit organizations

Friend or Relative:

32. Friend or Relative (not to a business)

C. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Holiday / Seasons greeting card
2. Other greeting cards (birthday, sympathy, thank you)
3. Invitation / Announcement (birth, marriage, etc.)
4. Letter / Correspondence (written by you – not a form)
5. Order
6. Inquiry
7. Payment (bill payment, dues, membership fees, etc.)
8. Donation
9. Survey / Questionnaire response
10. Sweepstakes / Contest entry
11. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game return
12. Proxy vote response
13. Election materials (absentee ballot, registration, etc.)
14. Rebate request
15. Tax related
16. Completed form / Application / Paperwork (not a tax form)
17. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

STOP IF THIS MAIL PIECE WAS TO A FRIEND OR RELATIVE, SKIP TO G

D. AD RESPONSE: Was the mail piece sent in response to advertising or solicitation for funds?

1. Yes
2. No → **SKIP TO F**

E. AD MATERIAL: Was the advertising / promotional / solicitation material...

1. Received in mail (not in magazine)
2. Seen in magazine
3. Seen in newspaper
4. Seen on television
5. Heard on radio
6. Received over telephone
7. Seen on the Internet
8. Other advertising *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

More questions on back of page →

6

First-Class Mail Sent *cont.* — Purple

F. RETURN ENVELOPE: Did you use your own envelope or card?

1. Yes
2. No – a return envelope or card **with postage** was provided
3. No – a return envelope or card **without postage** was provided

G. SPECIAL SVCS: Did the mail piece have any of the following special services? ***(OK to choose more than one)***

1. Certified
2. Registered
3. Insured
4. Return Receipt Requested
5. Certificate of Mailing
6. Restricted Delivery
7. COD
8. No special services
9. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

H. PO BOX: Was this mail piece sent to a PO Box?

1. Yes
2. No

I. POSTAGE TYPE: What type of postage was used? ***(Either postage that you put on yourself or postage that was already on the envelope or card)***

1. Business Reply Mail (no postage necessary)
2. Permit Reply Mail (no postage necessary)
3. Forever Stamp
4. Regular postage stamp
5. Meter stamp
6. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 6)*

Question Sheet

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Received

STOP **For Presorted First-Class Mail: Go to Purple page 3**

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Specific member(s) of the household
2. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
3. Someone not living at this address

B. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 11

1. In a letter size envelope
2. In an envelope larger than letter size (not catalog)
3. Catalog in envelope
4. Catalog not in envelope
5. Detached label card
6. Postcard
7. Addressed flyers / Circulars / Folded piece (no envelope)
8. Newspapers / Magazines / Newsletters
9. Can't classify type *(Please describe on Answer Booklet pg. 8)*

C. MULTIPLE: Did the mail piece contain...

1. Material from one organization only
2. Material from several organizations → **SKIP TO F**

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, drug store / pharmacy, etc.) (*Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 8*)
10. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, L.L. Bean, etc.)
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company
18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)

Services continued:

19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. Union or professional organization
32. Church / Religious organization
33. Veterans (VFW, American Legion, DAV, etc.)
34. Charity
35. AARP (for AARP insurance plans, record code 3)
36. Other nonprofit, etc. *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

E. FAMILIARITY: Was this mail piece from an organization someone in household...

1. Does or has done business with
2. Knows, but no one does business with
3. Organization no one in household knows

F. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

More questions on back of page →

8

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Received *cont.* — Blue

G. READING: Was the mail piece... *(Write in one number only)*

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of the household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

H. REACTION: Would this mail piece be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

I. COUPONS: Did this mail piece contain coupons?

1. Yes
2. No

J. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? *(Write in one number only)*

1. Advertisement for item(s) or service(s) to be purchased (credit card offers, etc.)
2. Request for donation (money, time, blood drive, goods, etc.)
3. Political materials
4. Newsletter / Newspaper / Magazine
5. Subscription renewal notice (for a publication)
6. Financial materials (report, proxy vote, prospectus, privacy or terms notice, etc.) NOTE: for credit card offers, record code 1
7. Invitation / Announcement / Schedule
8. General information
9. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 8)*

K. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the mail piece?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

L. CLASS: Tell us what markings are on the mail piece. *(OK to choose more than one)*

For examples of Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail, see pages 9 – 13 of the Instruction Booklet. Look at markings in top right-hand corner, above or below the address, & inside the window.

1. Presorted Standard, or PRSRT STD, or Standard, or STD, or Marketing, or MKTG, or MKT, or Presorted USPS Marketing, or PRSRT MKTG, or PRSRT MKT
2. AUTO
3. Carrier Route Presort, or CAR–RT SORT
4. ECR with LOT, or WSS, or WSH
5. ES, or EH, or EB, or AB, or AT, or AV, or DB, or DD, or DS, or MB, or MA, or MM, or NV, or NT, or NA, or NM
6. CUSTOMIZED MARKETMAIL, or CUST MKTMAIL, or CMM
7. Not Flat-Machinable, or NFM
8. Federal Government Mail with Official Signature (FRANKED)
9. Other Federal Government Mail
10. Can't classify type *(Please mark & place in envelope along with other mail pieces for this day)*

Question Sheet

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. ADDRESSEE: Mail piece was addressed to...

1. Specific member(s) of the household
2. Current Resident, Occupant, Postal Patron, etc. (with or without street address)
3. Someone not living at this address

B. FORM: Was the mail piece... ***(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)***

IF THIS IS A PACKAGE: GO TO GREEN PAGE 11

1. In a letter size envelope
2. In an envelope larger than letter size (not catalog)
3. Catalog in envelope
4. Catalog not in envelope
5. Detached label card
6. Postcard
7. Addressed flyers / Circulars / Folded piece (no envelope)
8. Newspapers / Magazines / Newsletters
9. Can't classify type *(Please describe on Answer Booklet pg. 10)*

C. MULTIPLE: Did the mail piece contain...

1. Material from one organization only
2. Material from several organizations → **SKIP TO F**

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

1. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
2. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
3. Union or professional organization
4. Church / Religious organization
5. Veterans (VFW, American Legion, DAV, etc.)
6. Charity
7. AARP
8. Animal welfare organization (ASPCA, Humane Society, etc.)
9. Environmental / Wildlife organization (WWF, Sierra Club, etc.)
10. Public broadcasting
11. YMCA / YWCA
12. Museum
13. Other nonprofit, etc. *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

Merchants:

14. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

Services:

16. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)
17. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
18. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
19. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

Government:

20. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
21. State and Local

E. FAMILIARITY: Was this mail piece from an organization someone in household...

1. Does or has done business with
2. Knows, but no one does business with
3. Organization no one in household knows

F. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return envelope or card included?

1. Yes – pre-stamped or postage paid
2. Yes – needs a stamp
3. No return envelope or card included

G. READING: Was the mail piece... ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of the household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

H. REACTION: Would this mail piece be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

I. COUPONS: Did this mail piece contain coupons?

1. Yes
2. No

More questions on back of page →

10

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received *cont.* — Gray

J. PURPOSE: What was the MAIN purpose of the mail piece? ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Advertisement for item(s) or service(s) to be purchased
2. Request for donation (money, time, blood drive, goods, etc.)
3. Political materials
4. Newsletter / Newspaper / Magazine
5. Subscription renewal notice (for a publication)
6. Course catalog (college classes, etc.)
7. Invitation / Announcement / Schedule
8. General information
9. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 10)*

K. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the mail piece?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

L. CLASS: Tell us what markings are on the mail piece. ***(OK to choose more than one)***

For examples of Nonprofit Mail see pages 14 – 17 of the Instruction Booklet.
Look at markings in top right-hand corner, above or below the address, & inside the window.

1. Nonprofit Organization, or Nonprofit Org., or Nonprofit
2. AUTO
3. Carrier Route Presort, or CAR–RT SORT
4. ECR with LOT, or WSS, or WSH
5. ES, or EH, or EB, or AB, or AT, or AV, or DB, or DD, or DS, or MB, or MA, or MM, or NV, or NT, or NA, or NM
6. CUSTOMIZED MARKETMAIL, or CUST MKTMAIL, or CMM
7. Not Flat-Machinable, or NFM
8. Federal Government Mail with Official Signature (FRANKED)
9. Other Federal Government Mail
10. Can't classify type *(Please mark & place in envelope along with other mail pieces for this day)*

Packages & Expedited Materials Received

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... *(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)*

1. SMALL envelope or padded mailer (11 ½" X 6 1/8" or smaller)
2. LARGE envelope or padded mailer (larger than 11 ½" X 6 1/8")
3. Box or other 3 dimensional packaging
4. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

B. ADDRESSEE: Package / mail piece was addressed to...

1. Male head of household
2. Female head of household
3. More than one head of household
4. Other adult living in household (18 and over)
5. Child (under 18)
6. Whole family
7. Other addressee *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

C. CONTENTS: Did this package / mail piece contain... *(OK to choose more than one)*

1. Clothing / Footwear / Shoes / Jewelry / Accessories
2. Travel products or information
3. Computer hardware, software, or accessories
4. Electronic equipment
5. Household / Kitchen / Lawn and garden products
6. Book(s) (include telephone books)
7. CD / DVD / Blu-ray / Video game
8. Toys
9. Food products
10. Checkbooks
11. Health / Medical / Dental / Vision products
12. Cosmetics / Beauty products / Toiletries
13. Photos / Film
14. Credit card (new, replacement, or return of lost card)
15. Notice / Announcement / Business invitation
16. Letter
17. Advertising / Promotional materials
18. Other contents *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

D. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the package content / mail piece originate from?

1. Friend or Relative (not from a business)
2. Financial (credit card, bank, stockbroker, insurance, mortgage, etc.)
3. Supermarket / Grocery store
4. Department / Discount store
5. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, drug store / pharmacy, etc.) (*Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 12*)
6. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, Oriental Trading Co., etc.)
7. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
8. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
9. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
10. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
11. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12*
12. Service (telephone, cable TV, Internet, medical, travel, Netflix, etc.)
13. Manufacturer (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)
14. Government (local or federal government, including Medicare, IRS, USPS, Social Security, VA, etc.)
15. Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political (all schools, charities, political candidates, religious and social organizations, etc.)
16. Other Industry *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

E. WHO ORDERED: Was the package / mail piece...

1. Ordered by a household member
2. Ordered by a friend or relative for a household member
3. An unsolicited sample → **SKIP TO G**
4. Not ordered / Delivered for some other reason → **SKIP TO G**

E2. HOW ORDERED: If ordered, how was the package / mail piece ordered?

1. Online – from Amazon
2. Online – from a store's website (e.g.: Wal-Mart, Target)
3. Online - from an individual seller (e.g.: eBay, craigslist)
4. Online – from any other website
5. Ordered in store
6. Ordered by telephone call
7. Ordered by mail
8. Other: *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

More questions on back of page →

Packages & Expedited Materials Received *cont.* — Green

F. AD RESPONSE: Was this package ordered in response to advertising?

1. Yes, in response to a catalog I received in the mail
2. Yes, in response to direct mail advertising (not a catalog)
3. Yes, in response to advertising I saw online
4. Yes, in response to some other kind of advertising
5. No - was not in response to advertising

G. RETURN ENVELOPE: Was a return shipping label or envelope included?

1. Yes – postage paid
2. Yes – not postage paid / needs postage
3. No return shipping label or envelope included

H. ADVERTISING: Was any advertising or promotional material enclosed?

1. Yes
2. No → **SKIP TO L**

I. READING: Was the advertising... *(Write in one number only)*

1. Read by a member of the household
2. Read by more than one member of the household
3. Looked at but not read by any member of household
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

J. REACTION: Would this advertising be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

K. RESPONSE: Is anyone in your household considering responding to the advertisement?

1. Yes
2. No
3. Maybe

L. SPECIAL SVCS: Did the package / mail piece have any of the following special services? *(OK to choose more than one)*

1. Return Receipt Requested
2. Delivery Confirmation
3. Signature Confirmation
4. Insured
5. COD
6. Stamped "Special Handling"
7. Certificate of Mailing
8. Restricted Delivery
9. No special services
10. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

M. SHIPPING & DELIVERY COMPANY: *(OK to choose more than one)*

1. U.S. Postal Service (USPS)
2. UPS
3. FedEx
4. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

N. CLASS: Package / Mail Classification *(OK to choose more than one)*

USPS Ground Packages:

1. First-Class (Package or Parcel) (up to 13 oz.)
2. Standard or Presorted Standard (PRSRT STD)
3. Standard Post
4. Nonprofit
5. Parcel Select
6. PS Lightweight / Parcel Select Lightweight
7. Bound Printed Matter or BPM
8. Media Mail
9. Package received from outside the U.S.

Non-USPS Ground Packages:

10. UPS (Ground, 3 Day Select)
11. FedEx (Ground, Express Saver, SmartPost)

USPS Expedited Mail & Packages:

12. Express Mail/Priority Mail Express (delivered by USPS)
13. Priority Mail (delivered by USPS)

Non-USPS Expedited Mail & Packages:

14. UPS Next Day Air
15. UPS 2nd Day Air
16. FedEx Overnight
17. FedEx 2Day

Other:

18. Other classification *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12)*

Question Sheet

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. FORM: Was the mail piece... *(Refer to the mail piece size template on page 2)*

1. SMALL envelope or padded mailer (11 ½" X 6 1/8" or smaller)
2. LARGE envelope or padded mailer (larger than 11 ½" X 6 1/8")
3. Box or other 3 dimensional packaging
4. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

B. CONTENTS: Did this package / mail piece contain... *(OK to choose more than one)*

1. Clothing / Footwear / Shoes / Jewelry / Accessories
2. Travel products or information
3. Computer hardware, software, or accessories
4. Electronic equipment
5. Household / Kitchen / Lawn and garden products
6. Book(s) (include telephone books)
7. CD / DVD / Blu-ray / Video game
8. Toys
9. Food products
10. Checkbooks
11. Health / Medical / Dental / Vision products
12. Cosmetics / Beauty products / Toiletries
13. Photos / Film
14. Greeting card (holiday, birthday, thank you, etc.)
15. Invitation
16. Letter
17. Completed forms (insurance forms, proxy vote, etc.)
18. Other contents *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

C. ADDRESSEE TYPE: What type of industry did you send the package / mail piece to?

1. Friend or Relative (not to a business) → **SKIP TO F**
2. Financial (credit card, bank, stockbroker, insurance, mortgage, etc.)
3. Supermarket / Grocery store
4. Department / Discount store
5. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, drug store / pharmacy, etc.) (*Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 14*)
6. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, Oriental Trading Co., etc.)
7. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
8. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
9. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
10. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
11. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 12*
12. Service (telephone, cable TV, Internet, medical, travel, Netflix, etc.)
13. Manufacturer (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)
14. Government (local or federal government, including Medicare, IRS, USPS, Social Security, VA, etc.)
15. Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political (all schools, charities, political candidates, religious and social organizations, etc.)
16. Other Industry *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

D. AD RESPONSE: Was the package / mail piece sent in response to advertising or solicitation for funds?

1. Yes
2. No → **SKIP TO F**

E. AD MATERIAL: Was the advertising / promotional / solicitation material...

1. Received in mail (not in magazine)
2. Seen in magazine
3. Seen in newspaper
4. Seen on television
5. Heard on radio
6. Received over telephone
7. Seen on the Internet
8. Other advertising *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

F. DISTANCE: How far away did you send this package / mail piece?

Local:

1. Local

Out of town:

2. 50 miles or less
3. 51 to 150 miles
4. 151 to 300 miles
5. 301 to 600 miles
6. 601 to 1,000 miles
7. 1,001 to 1,400 miles
8. 1,401 to 1,800 miles
9. More than 1,800 miles
10. Out of the United States

More questions on back of page →

14

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent *cont.* — Green

G. REASON: Why did you send this package / mail piece?

1. Gift or other item sent to friend or relative
2. Returning merchandise ordered
3. Returning unsolicited merchandise
4. Sending item sold on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site
5. Other reason *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

H. SPECIAL SVCS: Did you send this package / mail piece with any of the following special services? *(OK to choose more than one)*

1. Return Receipt Requested
2. Delivery Confirmation
3. Signature Confirmation
4. Insured
5. COD
6. Stamped "Special Handling"
7. Certificate of Mailing
8. Restricted Delivery
9. No special services
10. Other *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

I. CLASS: Package / Mail Classification *(OK to choose more than one)*

USPS Ground Packages:

1. First-Class (Package or Parcel) (up to 13 oz.)
2. Standard Post
3. Bound Printed Matter or BPM
4. Media Mail
5. Mail sent outside the U.S.

Non-USPS Ground Packages:

6. UPS (Ground, 3 Day Select)
7. FedEx (Ground, Express Saver, SmartPost)

USPS Expedited Mail & Packages:

8. Express Mail/Priority Mail Express (sent by USPS)
9. Priority Mail (sent by USPS)

Non-USPS Expedited Mail & Packages:

10. UPS Next Day Air
11. UPS 2nd Day Air
12. FedEx Overnight
13. FedEx 2Day

Other:

14. Other classification *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 14)*

Question Sheet

Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals Received

Periodicals do not have First-Class, Presorted Standard, Marketing Mail, or Nonprofit postage markings.

Record only if delivered by the U.S. Postal Service.

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. TYPE: This periodical is...

1. Daily newspaper
2. Weekly newspaper
3. Other newspaper
4. Weekly magazine
5. Monthly magazine
6. Other magazine
7. Newsletter
8. Other periodical *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 16)*

B. SENDER TYPE: Was the periodical from...

1. Union
2. Religious organization
3. Veterans' organization
4. Charitable organization
5. Educational organization
6. Professional organization – someone in household is member
7. Any other organization
8. Any other publisher

C. SUBSCRIPTION: Type of subscription?

1. Paid - ordered by household member
2. Free - ordered by household member
3. Free - not ordered by household member
4. Free - came with membership
5. Gift subscription from a friend or relative
6. Other subscription *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 16)*

D. ARRIVAL TIME: This periodical...

1. Arrived earlier than expected
2. Arrived on day expected
3. Arrived later than expected
4. Was not expected to arrive on any special day

E. DELIVERY: This periodical...

1. Could arrive later and not cause difficulty/inconvenience
2. Comes on the proper day and shouldn't come any later
3. Doesn't have a regular delivery day
4. Arrives so late that it causes difficulty/inconvenience
5. Delivery date is not important
6. Other delivery need *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 16)*

Question Sheet

Unaddressed Mail Received

STOP **Unaddressed mail has no postage markings and no address information.**

Packets of advertisements that are folded together are considered a single mail piece.

WRITE NUMBER CODES IN ANSWER BOOKLET INSTEAD OF CIRCLING YOUR ANSWERS HERE

A. CONTENTS: Did the mail piece contain...

1. Coupons from a single organization
2. Coupons from multiple organizations → **SKIP TO D**
3. Advertising from a single organization
4. Advertising from multiple organizations → **SKIP TO D**
5. Both coupons and advertising from a single organization
6. Both coupons and advertising from multiple organizations → **SKIP TO D**
7. Political materials
8. Product samples (with or without coupons)

B. SENDER TYPE: What type of industry did the mail piece come from?

Financial (including all types of credit cards):

1. Credit Card (from any bank, store, or company)
2. Bank / Savings & loan / Credit union / Loan company
3. Insurance company (medical, dental, life, auto, etc.)
4. Real estate / Mortgage
5. Investments (stock, mutual fund, retirement plan, etc.)
6. Other financial *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

Merchants:

7. Supermarket / Grocery store
8. Department / Discount store
9. Other store (electronics, shoes, clothes, hardware, drug store / pharmacy, etc.) *(Specify store type on Answer Booklet page 18)*
10. Mail order company (Lands End, Blair, L.L. Bean, etc.)
11. Restaurant (incl. fast food, pizza delivery, etc.)
12. Publisher (newspapers, books, magazines)
13. Auto dealership (not manufacturer or service department)
14. Individual seller (on eBay, craigslist, or other online sales site)
15. Other merchants *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

Services:

16. Telephone / Cell / Cable / Satellite / Internet
17. Electric / Gas / Water / Utility company
18. Medical (doctor, dentist, hospital, not insurance company)

Services continued:

19. Other professional (lawyer, accountant, etc.)
20. DVD / Blu-ray / Video game rental company (Netflix, etc.)
21. Craftsman (plumber, carpenter, electrician, etc.)
22. Travel / Entertainment service (theater, hotel, airline, etc.)
23. Auto maintenance (oil change, mechanic, etc.)
24. Roadside assistance (AAA, etc.)
25. Other services *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

Manufacturers:

26. All manufacturers (makers of automobiles, computers, etc.)

Government:

27. Federal (Social Security, VA, IRS, Medicare, etc.)
28. State and Local (not a utility company)

Nonprofit / Charitable / Social / Political:

29. Educational (public & private schools, universities, etc.)
30. Political (campaign, political action committee, political party, etc.)
31. Union or professional organization
32. Church / Religious Organization
33. Veterans (VFW, American Legion, DAV, etc.)
34. Charity
35. AARP (for AARP insurance plans, record code 3)
36. Other nonprofit, etc. *(Specify on Answer Booklet page 18)*

C. FAMILIARITY: Was this mail piece from an organization someone in household...

1. Does or has done business with
2. Knows, but no one does business with
3. Organization no one in household knows

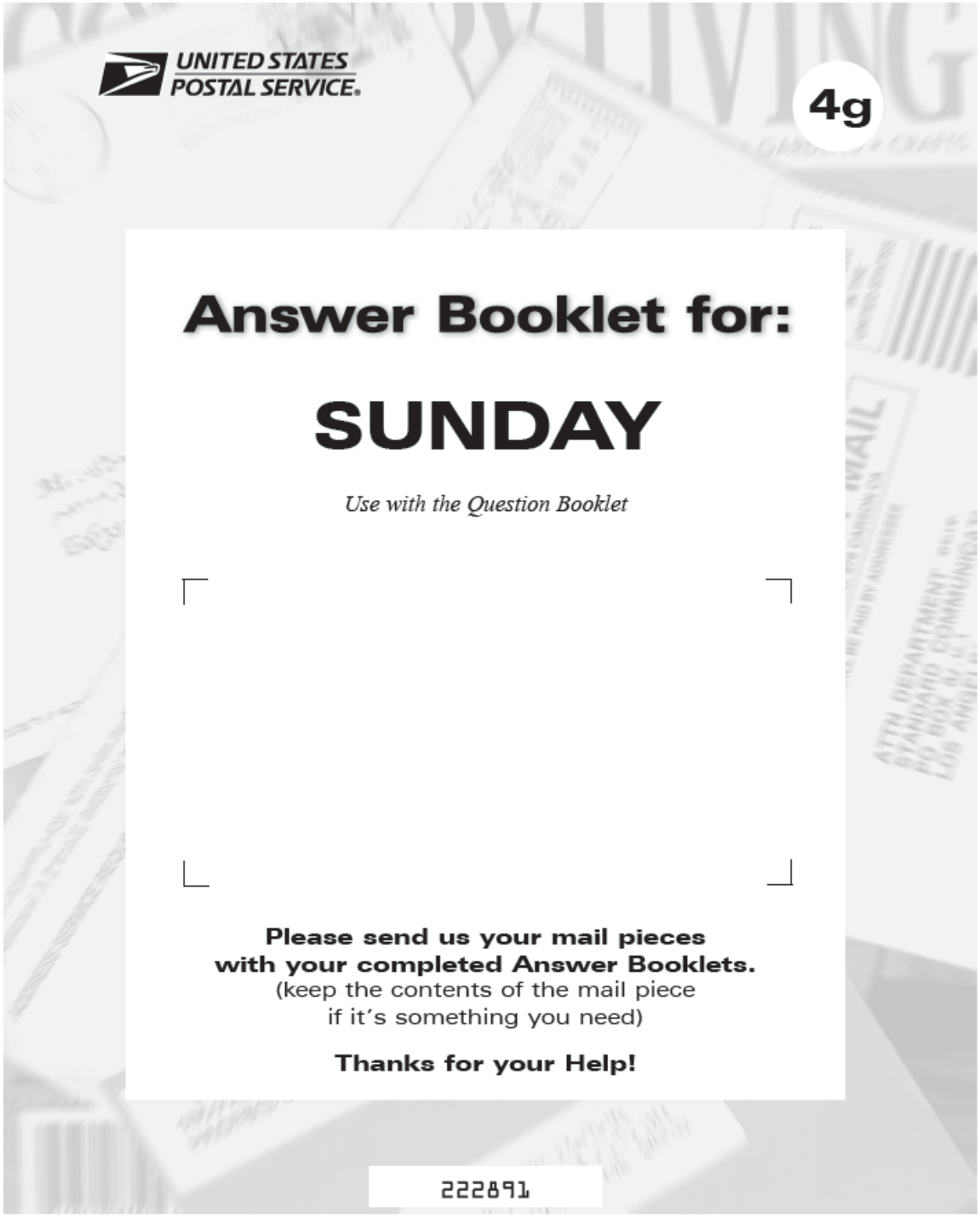
D. READING: Was the mail piece... ***(Write in one number only)***

1. Read by a household member
2. Read by more than one household member
3. Looked at but not read by any household member
4. Discarded without being read
5. Set aside for reading later

E. REACTION: Would this mail piece be described as...

1. Useful information we like to receive
2. Interesting or enjoyable, but not useful
3. Neither interesting, enjoyable, nor useful
4. Objectionable or offensive

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Answer Booklet


UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE
4g
Answer Booklet for:
SUNDAY
Use with the Question Booklet
Please send us your mail pieces
with your completed Answer Booklets.
(keep the contents of the mail piece
if it's something you need)
Thanks for your Help!
222891

Summary Page

Please print clearly as in the example below:

1 OR 20

Use a pen in black or blue ink
DO NOT USE PENCIL

Did not Receive or Send any Mail/Packages Today: → ☐

(If no mail received or sent, mark the box above with an "X." You are done for today.)

Mail RECEIVED Sunday: ☐ **Total # Received**

Record the total number of mail received above and then record for each mail type below.

1. **First-Class:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 3 (PURPLE)*
2. **Presorted Standard, or Marketing Mail:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 7 (BLUE)*
3. **Nonprofit Organization:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 9 (GRAY)*
4. **Packages & Expedited:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 11 (GREEN)*
5. **Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 15 (YELLOW)*
6. **Unaddressed Mail:** ☐ **Total # Received** → *GO TO PAGE 17 (PINK)*

Mail SENT Sunday: ☐ **Total # Sent**

Envelopes (First-Class): ☐ **Total # Sent**

Postcards (First-Class): ☐ **Total # Sent**

} *GO TO PAGE 5 (PURPLE)*

Packages & Expedited: ☐ **Total # Sent** → *GO TO PAGE 13 (GREEN)*

- Total number of **Bill Payments** made today (include by Mail, Online, Automatic Deduction, etc.) : ☐
- Total number of **Bills Received** today (include bills received by Mail and Online) : ☐
- Total number of **Statements Received** today (include statements received by Mail and Online) : ☐

Note: Credit Card Statements received should be counted under bills only

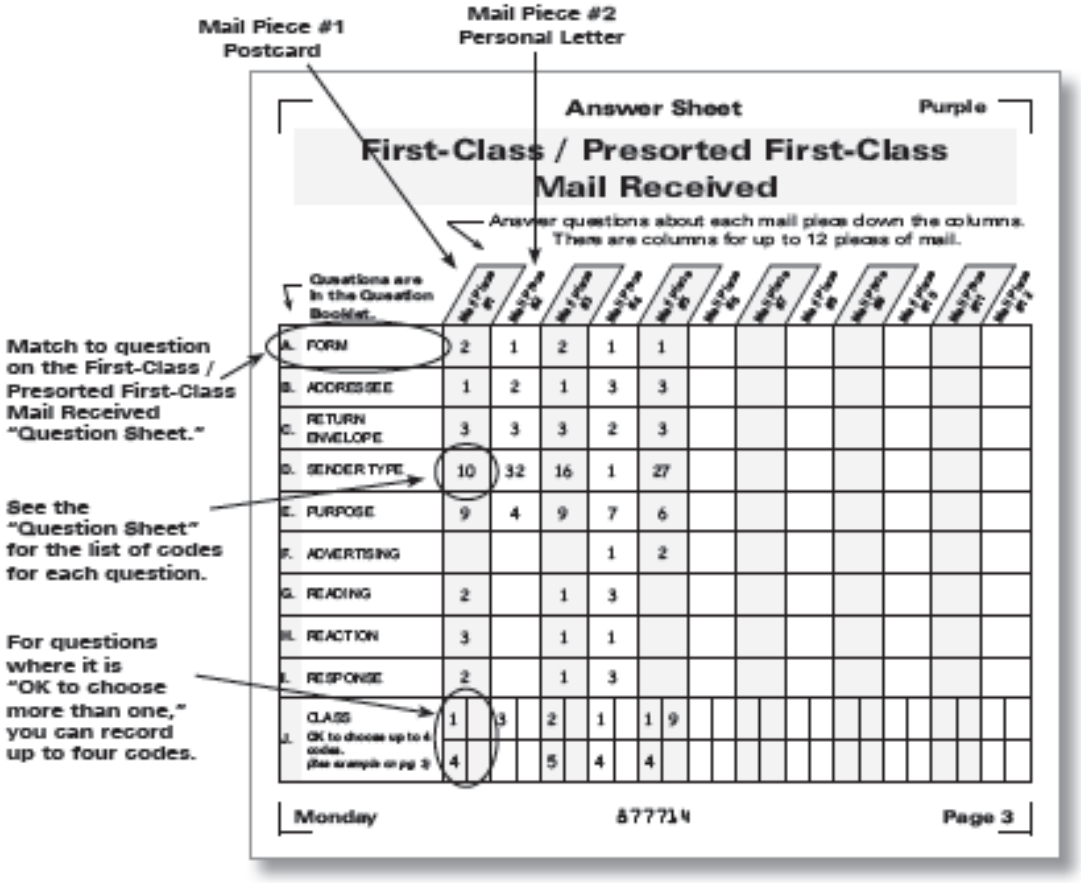
Answer Sheet Example

Please print clearly as in the example: 1 OR 20

Use a pen in black or blue ink
DO NOT USE PENCIL

As an example, let's say you received four First-Class mail pieces on Monday. Mail Piece #1 is a First-Class postcard from a mail order company, and Mail Piece #2 is a personal letter.

1. Open the **Question Booklet** to purple page 3, **First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received**.
2. For question A, your number code is either: 1 (envelope), 2 (postcard), 3 (flyer or catalog), or 4 (envelope larger than letter size) as shown on the question sheet.
3. Write a "2" for a postcard in the first column under Mail Piece #1 (see below).
4. Finish answering the remaining questions (B-J) about the postcard.
5. Answer the same questions about Mail Piece #2, the letter from a friend, on the same page in the column under Mail Piece #2, then continue to record Mail Pieces #3 and #4.



Sunday 777483 Page 2

Answer Sheet Purple

First-Class / Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns. There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM												
B. ADDRESSEE												
C. RETURN ENVELOPE												
D. SENDER TYPE												
E. PURPOSE												
F. ADVERTISING												
G. READING												
H. REACTION												
I. RESPONSE												
J. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												

Sunday 877714 Page 3

First-Class /Presorted First-Class Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

First-Class Mail Sent

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM												
B. ADDRESSEE TYPE												
C. PURPOSE												
D. AD RESPONSE												
E. AD MATERIAL												
F. RETURN ENVELOPE												
G. SPECIAL SVCS OK to choose up to 2 codes.												
H. PO BOX												
I. POSTAGE TYPE												

First-Class Mail Sent

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Answer Sheet

Blue

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. ADDRESSEE												
B. FORM												
C. MULTIPLE												
D. SENDER TYPE												
E. FAMILIARITY												
F. RETURN ENVELOPE												
G. READING												
H. REACTION												
I. COUPONS												
J. PURPOSE												
K. RESPONSE												
L. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												

Presorted Standard or Marketing Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. ADDRESSEE												
B. FORM												
C. MULTIPLE												
D. SENDER TYPE												
E. FAMILIARITY												
F. RETURN ENVELOPE												
G. READING												
H. REACTION												
I. COUPONS												
J. PURPOSE												
K. RESPONSE												
L. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												

Nonprofit Organization Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Answer Sheet Green

Packages & Expedited Materials Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 packages.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.		Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A.	FORM												
B.	ADDRESSEE												
C.	CONTENTS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												
D.	SENDER TYPE												
E.	WHO ORDERED												
E2.	HOW ORDERED												
F.	AD RESPONSE												
G.	RETURN ENVELOPE												
H.	ADVERTISING												
I.	READING												
J.	REACTION												
K.	RESPONSE												
L.	SPECIAL SVCS OK to choose up to 2 codes.												
M.	SHIP & DELIV OK to choose up to 2 codes.												
N.	CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												

Sunday 884751 Page 11

Packages & Expedited Materials Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. FORM												
B. CONTENTS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												
C. ADDRESSEETYPE												
D. AD RESPONSE												
E. AD MATERIAL												
F. DISTANCE												
G. REASON												
H. SPECIAL SVCS OK to choose up to 2 codes.												
I. CLASS OK to choose up to 4 codes. *(See example on pg. 2)*												

Packages & Expedited Materials Sent

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns. There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. TYPE												
B. SENDER TYPE												
C. SUBSCRIPTION												
D. ARRIVAL TIME												
E. DELIVERY												

Magazines, Newspapers, or Other Periodicals Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Answer Sheet **Pink**

Unaddressed Mail Received

Answer questions about each mail piece down the columns.
There are columns for up to 12 pieces of mail.

Questions are in the Question Booklet.	Mail Piece #1	Mail Piece #2	Mail Piece #3	Mail Piece #4	Mail Piece #5	Mail Piece #6	Mail Piece #7	Mail Piece #8	Mail Piece #9	Mail Piece #10	Mail Piece #11	Mail Piece #12
A. CONTENTS												
B. SENDER TYPE												
C. FAMILIARITY												
D. READING												
E. REACTION												

Sunday 211344 **Page 17**

Unaddressed Mail Received

Specify other answers and/or provide comments here

Mail Piece #	Question Letter	Specify Other Answers or Comments

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Diary Envelope

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE®

5a

MONDAY

Insert your Mail Pieces and completed Answer Booklet for Monday in this envelope.
At the end of your recording week, please send all your Daily envelopes *(with the completed Answer Booklets and Mail Pieces in each),* in the postage-paid Priority Mail envelope provided.
Thanks for your Help!

Appendix C2: Diary Package – Gift Selection Forms

Gift Selection Form for households eligible for the additional $10 incentive.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE.

Gift Selection Form

6

In appreciation for your participation, choose ONE of the following gifts*:

- ◯ Forty dollars
- ◯ 100 First-Class stamps

* Please allow 10-12 weeks for processing

Make any changes to your name and address below (please print clearly):

Households eligible for the additional incentive, please select one:

- ◯ Wal-Mart
- ◯ Amazon.com

«SAMPN»-«ASSIGN»

«FIRSTNAME» «LASTNAME»
«ADDRESS»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP»

_____
Name

_____ _____
Street number Street name (include apt. or unit #)

_____
City, State, and Zip

(_____) _____ - _____
Telephone number

Mail this form back with your Mail Pieces and completed Answer Booklets!

Gift Selection Form for all other households.

UNITED STATES POSTAL SERVICE.

Gift Selection Form

6

In appreciation for your participation, choose ONE of the following gifts*:

- ⬭ Forty dollars
- ⬭ 100 First-Class stamps

* Please allow 10-12 weeks for processing

Make any changes to your name and address below (please print clearly):

«SAMPN»-«ASSIGN»

«FIRSTNAME» «LASTNAME»
«ADDRESS»
«CITY», «STATE» «ZIP»

_____
Name

_____ _____
Street number **Street name** (include apt. or unit #)

_____
City, State, and Zip

(_____) _____ - _____
Telephone number

Mail this form back with your Mail Pieces and completed Answer Booklets!

Appendix C2: Diary Package – "I'm Done…" Card

I'm done, what do I send back? 7

1. Completed **Answer Booklets** & **Mail Pieces** for each day in the corresponding Daily envelope.



Mail Pieces



Answer Booklets



Daily Envelopes

2. **Gift Selection form** with your choice of gift selected.



3. Place Daily envelopes and Gift Form in the **postage-paid Priority Mail envelope.** Drop in any public U.S. Postal Service mail box or at your local post office.

